

Herald — Specification V3

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Field	Value
Revision	7
Created	2026-05-20
Last modified	2026-05-20
Status	active
Status summary	V3 r7 — §44 Foundation implementation contract lands. Locks the three-milestone (M1/M2/M3) Approach B vertical-slice delivery for Sub-project 1 of 8. Records the Catalogue-Check verdict (9 of 12 caps extend existing <code>digital.vasic.*</code> modules; 3 no-match bespoke). Per Universal §11.4.73 secondary bump (Revision 6 → 7); §44 is additive. M1 evidence captured in §44.9 (<code>commons_constitution</code> package, 14 files, all tests PASS under <code>-race</code>).
Issues	none
Issues summary	—
Fixed	V3-R3-01..V3-R3-03 (r3 parent-doc spec-path sync); V3-R2-01..V3-R2-09 (r2); V3-R1-01..V3-R1-14 (r1); inherits closed V2 + V1 lineage.
Fixed summary	r7 lands §44 Foundation contract + records M1 as-built evidence (<code>commons_constitution</code> 14-file scaffold, in-process EventBus/Registry/Captureer/Ladder/Store/Runner all green under <code>-race</code> ; full workspace inheritance gate 12 PASS / 0 FAIL).
Continuation	M2: <code>commons_storage</code> live-wire via <code>digital.vasic.database</code> (<code>pgx</code> + migrations) + <code>digital.vasic.background</code> (Postgres queue) — integration tests against testcontainers Postgres. Then M3: Gin REST via <code>digital.vasic.middleware+auth+observability</code> composition + <code>digital.vasic.cache</code> for the mode-ladder read-cache. Each milestone followed by multi-mirror push. Then codegraph integration per https://github.com/colbymchenry/codegraph .

The **bi-directional event fan-out** system: Herald ingests events from heterogeneous sources and reliably fans them out to multiple notification channels so every alert reaches the right destination without confusion, and processes inbound replies/commands back from subscribers in a structured, security-validated way.

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-

§1. Upstreams

All existing project upstreams:

- **GitHub** (main repository): `git@github.com:vasic-digital/Herald.git`
- **GitLab**: `git@gitlab.com:vasic-digital/herald.git`
- **GitFlic**: `git@gitflic.ru:vasic-digital/herald.git`
- **GitVerse**: `git@gitverse.ru:vasic-digital/Herald.git`

The local origin remote is a fan-out (one fetch URL + four push URLs). A single `git push origin <branch>` propagates to all four hosts (Helix Constitution §2.1 / Herald Constitution §103).

§2. Mission and scope

2.1 What Herald is

Herald is the **bi-directional event fan-out mechanism**. It receives input from one or more **sources** and dispatches the resulting content to one or more **destinations** (channels). Depending on the implementation (Flavor) of Herald, sources and destinations are heterogeneous: a single input type or many; a single output channel or many.

For example, the input may be the result of a CI pipeline execution (a build report, a test summary, a security-scan finding). Herald enriches, normalizes, routes, and dispatches that input to messaging channels (Telegram, Slack, Max, Email, Markdown diary, etc.) so that human and machine subscribers can be informed and can interact back.

The possibilities are not limited. The structure of the system **MUST** be **hierarchical**: shared abstractions live in the **commons** layers (closest to the root); flavor-specific implementations live in `flavors/<flavor>/.`

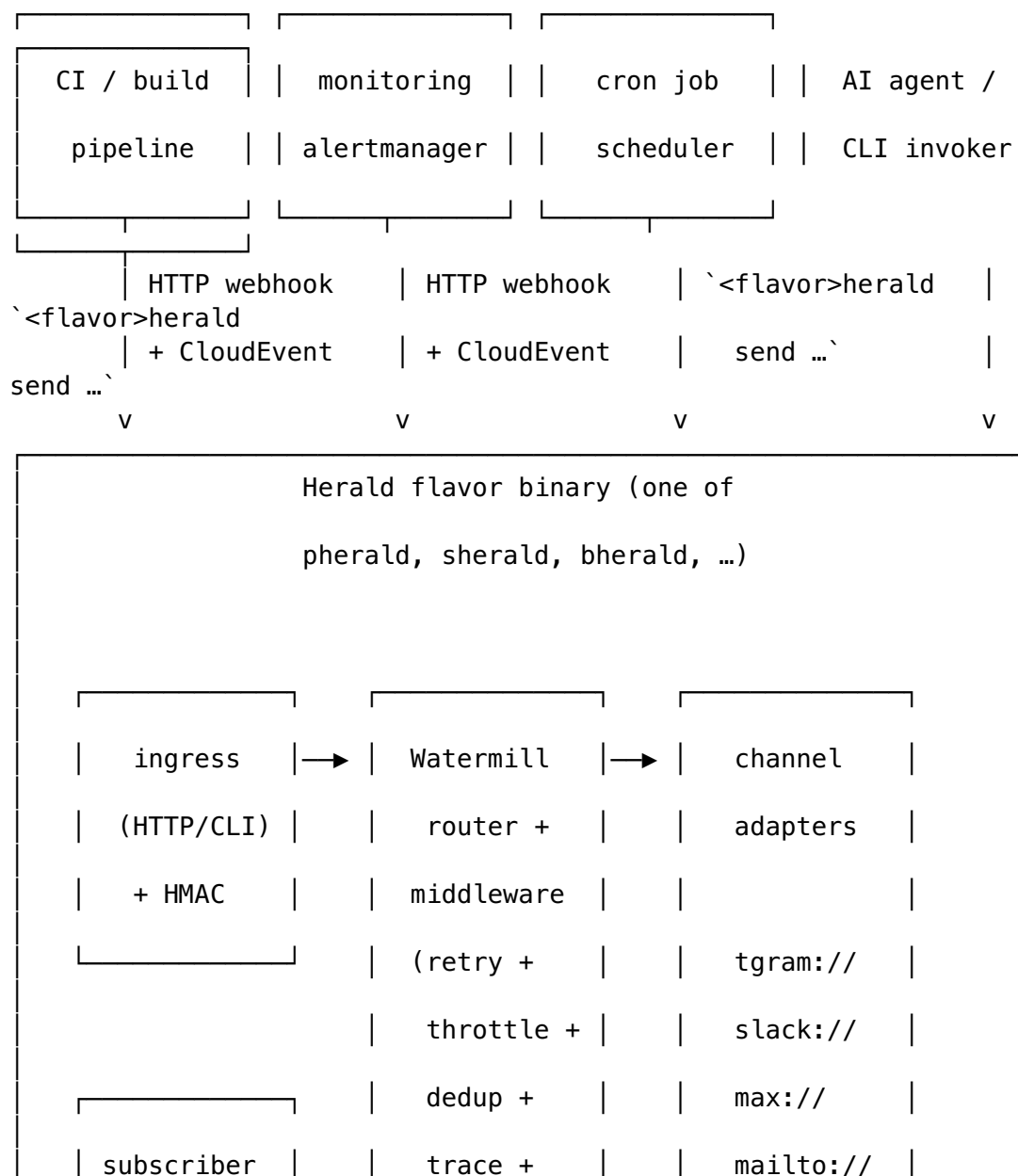
Note: We **MUST NOT** be obligated to follow this hierarchical structure rigidly when a parent project's specific custom flavor must exist privately or in a different location. Flexibility is mandatory and fully supported.

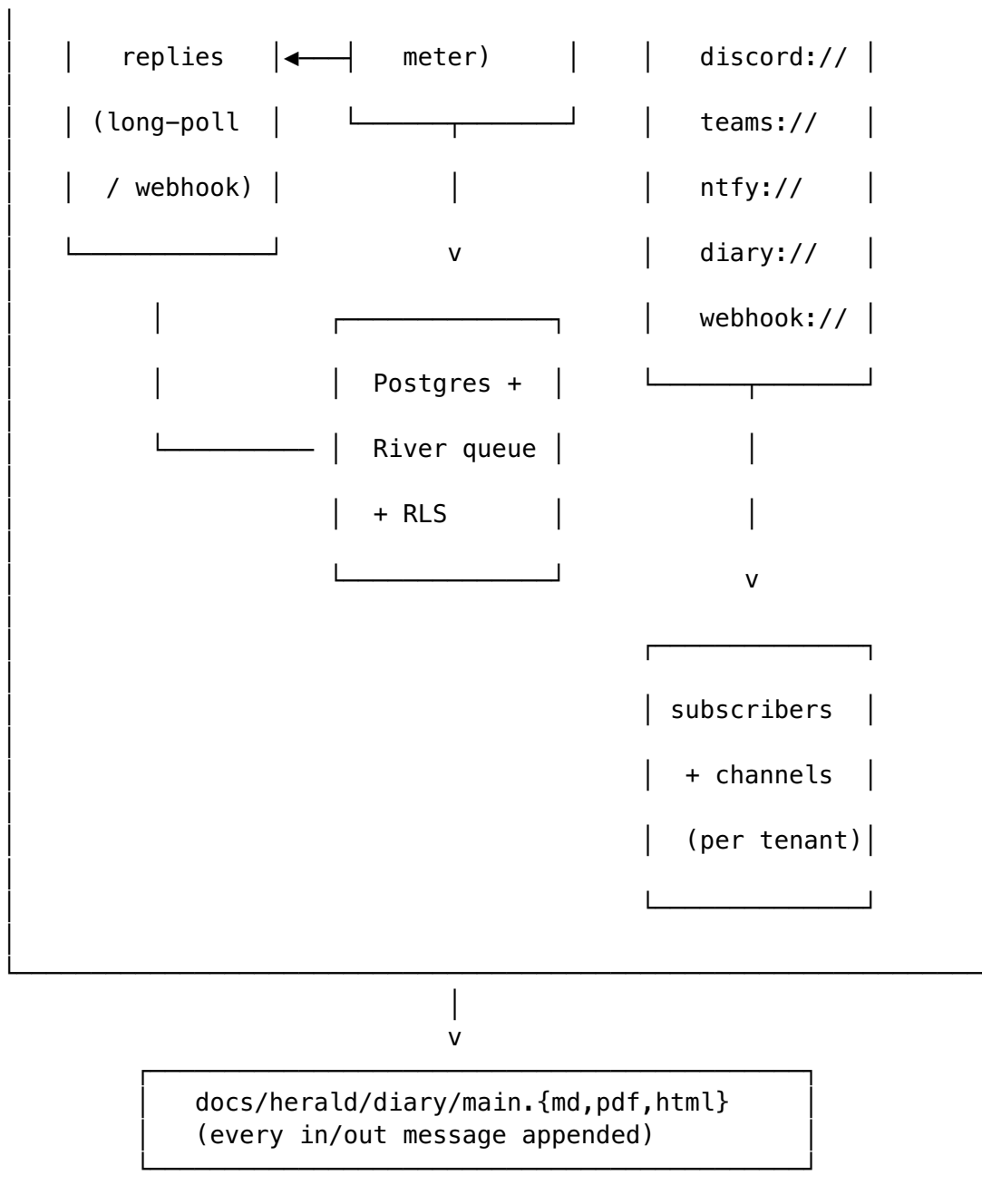
2.2 What Herald is NOT

To bound scope (§102 Herald Constitution — mission boundary):

- Herald is **not** a general-purpose chat application; it is an event-driven fan-out + inbound-reply processor.
- Herald is **not** a general-purpose monitoring/observability platform — it integrates *with* them via webhook ingestion (Prometheus Alertmanager, Grafana, Datadog, PagerDuty, OpsGenie) but does not replace them.
- Herald is **not** a transactional/marketing email service provider in itself — it integrates *with* ESPs (SendGrid, Resend, Postmark) as one of its delivery transports.
- Herald is **not** a workflow orchestration platform — Temporal/Argo/Step Functions remain the right tool for that; Herald can be triggered by them and can dispatch notifications about them.

2.3 Architecture diagram





§3. Execution model

3.1 Single binary, two modes

Every Herald flavor is a **single statically-linked Go binary** with **Cobra-style subcommands** (per R-02 — cleanest fit, lowest deployment footprint, no duplicate auth/config plumbing). The same binary serves both runtime modes:

- **One-shot mode** — `<flavor>herald send ...`: connects, transmits a single event, awaits delivery acknowledgement with a configurable deadline, exits non-zero on failure. Designed for CI integration, cron jobs, AI-agent invocation, pipeline steps.
- **Daemon mode** — `<flavor>herald serve`: long-running listener; blocks on (a) the HTTP ingress for webhook events, (b) per-channel subscriber-reply loops

(Telegram long-poll, Slack Socket Mode, Email IMAP, Discord gateway, etc.),
(c) scheduled jobs from the River queue.

Both modes share the same configuration loader, channel adapters, storage layer, and observability stack — only the entry point and process lifecycle differ.

Graceful shutdown semantics. Both modes **MUST**:

1. Trap SIGTERM and SIGINT.
2. Stop accepting new ingress requests immediately (/readyz returns 503).
3. Drain in-flight work with a configurable grace period (default 30 s, env HERALD_SHUTDOWN_GRACE).
4. Refuse Send() calls that arrive after grace begins (returning context.Canceled).
5. Flush the OpenTelemetry exporter (tracerProvider.Shutdown(ctx) with its own 5 s sub-deadline).
6. Close() the Postgres pool and Redis client.
7. Exit with code 0 if drain completed cleanly, 1 if grace expired with work still in flight.

A second SIGTERM within the grace window forces immediate exit. SIGKILL is uncatchable by definition; operators **MUST** size the grace period for their workload's tail latency.

Additional subcommands:

- `<flavor>herald doctor` — verifies environment health (Postgres ping, Redis ping, channel-credential validity, DKIM/SPF/DMARC records, port availability).
- `<flavor>herald migrate` — applies database migrations (idempotent).
- `<flavor>herald deadletter [list | replay <id> | purge]` — operate on the dead-letter table.
- `<flavor>herald subscriber [list | add | verify <token>]` — manage subscribers.
- `<flavor>herald digest ...` — generate scheduled summaries (digests, weekly reports).

3.2 Distribution + invocation surfaces

Herald applications are CLI binaries primarily designed for:

- **CI integration** — invoked from GitHub Actions / GitLab CI / Jenkins / CircleCI / Drone steps.
- **Pipelines** — invoked from build/deploy scripts.
- **AI CLI agents** — invoked by Claude Code, OpenCode, Cursor, Aider, etc., as a structured way to surface progress and accept human feedback.
- **cron** — scheduled checks and digests.
- **Webhook recipients** — running in daemon mode behind a reverse proxy.

Some Herald application names (illustrative — flavors are fully enumerated in §18):

- pherald for **Project Herald** (development-lifecycle events).
- sherald for **System Herald** (OS/host/service events).
- bherald for **Build Herald** (CI/CD build events).
- dherald for **Deploy Herald** (release/deploy events).

- aherald for **Alert Herald** (monitoring alert routing).
- scherald for **Schedule Herald** (cron/scheduled-task notifications).
- iherald for **Incident Herald** (incident management).
- rherald for **Release Herald** (release lifecycle).
- cherald for **Compliance Herald** (audit/compliance events).

3.3 Configuration & credentials

Configuration precedence (12-factor aligned, per R-04):

1. Explicit CLI flag (highest precedence).
2. Shell-exported environment variable (from `.bashrc` / `.zshrc` / `k8s env` / `Docker -e`).
3. Value from `.env` (fallback only — does NOT override exported shell vars).
4. Compiled default (lowest).

`.env` MUST BE git-ignored. `.env.example` is the documented template, committed. An opt-in `--env-file-override` flag maps to `godotenv.Overload()` for the rare case operators want the file to win (one-off rescues, debugging).

Configuration file layout (`config.toml`, optional, loaded after `.env`):

```
[herald]
flavor      = "pherald"
tenant_id   = "00000000-0000-0000-0000-000000000001" # default
              if multi-tenancy disabled
locale      = "en-US"
diary_root  = "" # blank →
              discover via parent-walk
admin_port  = 24090 # /
              livez, /readyz, /metrics, pprof
http_port   = 24091 # webhook
              ingress + reply webhooks

[postgres]
dsn         = "${HERALD_POSTGRES_DSN}" # env
              interpolation
max_conns   = 20
rls_enforced = true

[redis]
addr        = "${HERALD_REDIS_ADDR}"
acl_user    = "${HERALD_REDIS_USER}"
acl_password = "${HERALD_REDIS_PASSWORD}"

[channels]
# Apprise-style URLs (see §6.1)
default = [
  "tgram://${TELEGRAM_BOT_TOKEN}/${TELEGRAM_CHAT_ID}?
    tags=oncall,prod",
  "slack://${SLACK_TOKEN}/${SLACK_CHANNEL}?tags=oncall",
  "mailto://herald@example.com?tags=audit",
  "diary://?tags=*" # always log to diary
]
```

[observability]

```
otlp_endpoint = "http://otel-collector:4317"
log_level     = "info"
```

3.4 Worker pools, concurrency, and hot-reload

Worker pool sizing. `herald serve` runs three independently-sized worker pools:

Pool	Default size	Configurable	Workload
HTTP ingress	2 × NumCPU	[server].http_workers	accepts inbound CloudEvents + webhook deliveries; CPU-bound on signature verification + JSON parsing
Router/dispatch	4 × NumCPU	[router].workers	template render + preference filter + tag matching; mostly CPU + small Postgres lookups
River channel-delivery	8 × NumCPU (capped at [river].max_workers, default 64)	[river].workers	I/O-bound HTTP calls to channel APIs (Telegram, Slack, ...); bottlenecked by upstream rate limits

Operators tune via env vars (`HERALD_HTTP_WORKERS`, `HERALD_ROUTER_WORKERS`, `HERALD_RIVER_WORKERS`) or `config.toml`. Sizing guidance:

- **Single-tenant small** (≤ 1 alert/sec): defaults (~16 workers total on a 2-vCPU host).
- **Multi-tenant production** (~50 alerts/sec sustained): bump [river].max_workers to $\min(256, 8 \times \text{tenants})$; tune [postgres].max_conns to [router].workers + [river].workers + 4 (admin connections reserved).
- **High-burst CI fanout** (~500 alerts/min in 10-sec spikes): rely on River's backpressure rather than over-provisioning workers; River queues durably in Postgres and drains as channels free up.

Hot-reload via SIGHUP. `herald serve` traps SIGHUP and re-reads `config.toml + .env + channel_addresses` (database-backed) without dropping in-flight work. Reload is constrained to **safe-to-change** sections:

Reloadable on SIGHUP	NOT reloadable (require process restart)
<code>[channels].*</code> (channel addresses + tags)	<code>[server].http_port</code> / admin port
<code>[router].workers</code> (resized live)	<code>[postgres].dsn</code> (connection identity)
<code>[river].workers / max_workers</code>	<code>[redis].addr</code>
<code>[observability].log_level</code>	<code>[observability].otlp_endpoint</code> (exporter identity)
<code>[security].allowlists.*</code>	binary version / migrations
<code>[rate_limits].*</code> (token bucket caps)	RLS policy changes (DB-side)

Reload semantics:

1. Compute the diff between in-memory config and freshly-loaded config.
2. Reject if any "NOT reloadable" key changed — log `ERROR config reload rejected: <key> requires restart`; old config remains active.
3. For reloadable keys, apply atomically (worker pools resize via a lockless swap; channel adapters re-initialize against new addresses; rate-limit buckets refresh with new caps; in-flight work continues against the live config snapshot it captured).
4. Emit `digital.vasic.herald.system.config.reloaded` event with the diff for audit.

No hot-reload in one-shot mode: `herald send` reads config once at startup and exits; SIGHUP is ignored.

3.5 Time / clock abstraction

Herald never calls `time.Now()` directly outside of `commons/clock`. The clock abstraction lets tests fast-forward time (essential for quiet-hours, batching windows, retry backoff, idempotency TTLs, escalation chains).

```
package commons // L0

// Clock is the time-source abstraction. Production uses
//   RealClock;
// tests use FakeClock with controllable Now()/After()/NewTimer().
type Clock interface {
    Now() time.Time
    Since(t time.Time) time.Duration
    Sleep(d time.Duration)
    After(d time.Duration) <-chan time.Time
    NewTimer(d time.Duration) Timer
    NewTicker(d time.Duration) Ticker
}

// RealClock wraps the stdlib time package. Used in production.
```

```

type RealClock struct{}

// FakeClock is the test implementation. Advance(d) moves the
// clock
// forward by d and fires any pending timers/tickers whose
// deadlines
// the advance crosses. Available in commons/clock/clocktest.
type FakeClock struct {
    // unexported state
}

// Default exports a process-global Clock – Herald's CLI bootstrap
// sets it to RealClock; tests swap it in TestMain.
var Default Clock = RealClock{}

```

Rationale: this is the same pattern that github.com/benbjohnson/clock popularised; `commons/clock` ships a minimal in-tree implementation rather than depending on a third-party module that has no maintainer activity since 2022. The interface surface is intentionally small — only what Herald needs.

Discipline: anyone calling `time.Now()` outside `commons/clock` is a bug — the lint rule `herald-no-direct-time-now` (custom `golangci-lint` analyzer, planned) flags violations.

§4. Event model & wire format

4.1 CloudEvents v1.0 as canonical envelope

Herald speaks **CloudEvents v1.0** (CNCF graduated, Jan 2024) natively on every external boundary — ingress, internal transport, audit/diary record. Inside the binary, events are passed as `cloudevents.Event` values from github.com/cloudevents/sdk-go/v2.

Required CloudEvents attributes for every Herald event:

Attribute	Source	Example
specversion	constant "1.0"	"1.0"
id	UUIDv7 (natural ordering by time)	"01931a7c-3f4e-7000-9abc- def012345678"
source	URI of the emitter	"https://ci.example.com/ pipelines/4231"
type	reverse-DNS event type	"digital.vasic.herald.ci.failed"
time	RFC 3339 timestamp	"2026-05-19T17:30:00Z"
datacontenttype		"application/json"

Attribute	Source	Example
subject	media type of data	
	target hint (channel address, tag, route key)	"tag:oncall,prod" or "channel:slack-incidents"

Two wire modes accepted on HTTP ingress:

- **Structured mode** — single JSON object: `{"specversion":"1.0","id":"...","type":"...","data":{"..."}}`.
- **Binary mode** — HTTP headers carry attributes (ce-id, ce-type, ce-source, ...), body is the raw data payload.

Herald-specific extension attributes:

- `heraldtenant` — tenant UUID (overrides default).
- `heraldidempotencykey` — explicit dedup key (overrides `id` if present).
- `heraldpriority` — low / normal / high / urgent (ntfy-style 1–5 mapping).

4.2 Herald event-type taxonomy

CloudEvents type is a reverse-DNS string. Herald's namespace is `digital.vasic.herald.*`.

Subtree	Used by	Examples
<code>digital.vasic.herald.ci.*</code>	bherald	<code>.build.queued</code> , <code>.build.started</code> , <code>.build.succeeded</code>
<code>digital.vasic.herald.project.*</code>	pherald	<code>.task.opened</code> , <code>.task.assigned</code> , <code>.task.closed</code>
<code>digital.vasic.herald.system.*</code>	sherald	<code>.host.cpu_high</code> , <code>.host.disk_full</code> , <code>.service.restart</code>
<code>digital.vasic.herald.deploy.*</code>	dherald	<code>.deploy.started</code> , <code>.deploy.succeeded</code> , <code>.deploy.failed</code>
<code>digital.vasic.herald.alert.*</code>	aherald	<code>.alert.firing</code> , <code>.alert.resolved</code> , <code>.alert.acknowledged</code>
<code>digital.vasic.herald.schedule.*</code>	scherald	<code>.job.started</code> , <code>.job.succeeded</code> , <code>.job.failed</code>
<code>digital.vasic.herald.incident.*</code>	iherald	<code>.incident.opened</code> , <code>.incident.escalated</code> , <code>.incident.resolved</code>
<code>digital.vasic.herald.release.*</code>	rherald	<code>.release.tagged</code> , <code>.release.published</code> , <code>.release.retracted</code>
<code>digital.vasic.herald.compliance.*</code>	cherald	<code>.audit.access</code> , <code>.policy.violation</code> , <code>.certificate.expired</code>
<code>digital.vasic.herald.reply.*</code>	all	<code>.reply.received</code> , <code>.command.parsed</code> , <code>.command.failed</code>
<code>digital.vasic.herald.delivery.*</code>	internal	<code>.delivery.accepted</code> , <code>.delivery.routed</code> , <code>.delivery.failed</code>

4.3 Idempotency keys

Per R-05 + research Topic 4: **at-least-once delivery with deterministic dedup**.

- Every ingress accepts an Herald-Idempotency-Key HTTP header (or `heraldidempotencykey` CE extension, or CLI flag `--idempotency-key`).
- If absent, Herald falls back to the CloudEvents `id`.
- Dedup is enforced via a Postgres `idempotency_keys` table:

```
CREATE TABLE idempotency_keys (
  tenant_id      UUID NOT NULL,
  idempotency_key TEXT NOT NULL,
  request_hash   BYTEA NOT NULL,           -- SHA-256 of
  canonical request body
  response_id    UUID,                     -- pointer to
  first response
  locked_at      TIMESTAMPTZ NOT NULL DEFAULT now(),
  expires_at     TIMESTAMPTZ NOT NULL DEFAULT (now() +
  interval '24 hours'),
  PRIMARY KEY (tenant_id, idempotency_key)
) WITH (FILLFACTOR = 80);
```

```
ALTER TABLE idempotency_keys ENABLE ROW LEVEL SECURITY;
ALTER TABLE idempotency_keys FORCE ROW LEVEL SECURITY;
CREATE POLICY idem_isolation ON idempotency_keys
  USING (tenant_id = current_setting('app.tenant_id')::uuid);
```

- Dedup INSERT ... ON CONFLICT DO NOTHING is in the **same transaction** as the channel-fanout enqueue. Stripe-pattern (cite: Brandur's writeup).
 - Redis is used as a **fast-path negative cache** (SET NX EX <ttd>) in front of Postgres, never as sole authority.
 - TTL: 24h for synchronous API replies (matches Stripe); 7d for delivery-side dedup (matches reply-queue retention).
 - Replay (same key, same body) returns the cached response; replay (same key, *different* body) returns HTTP 409 Conflict.
-

§5. Architecture overview

5.1 Components

A Herald flavor binary is composed of these in-process components:

1. **Ingress layer** — HTTP server (CloudEvents binding) + CLI command parser. Verifies signatures (§15.5), enforces idempotency (§4.3), and emits a Watermill message.
2. **Watermill router** — central message bus. Channel adapters, evaluators, and middleware (retry, dedup, throttle, trace, meter) are registered as HandlerFuncs on a single router.
3. **Channel adapters** — one per supported channel; implement the Channel interface (§10).
4. **Subscriber-reply consumers** — per-channel inbound loops (Telegram getUpdates long-poll or webhook, Slack Socket Mode / Events API webhook, Email IMAP, Discord gateway, etc.).
5. **Storage layer** — Postgres (durable state, RLS-isolated per tenant) + Redis (rate-limit token buckets, fast-path dedup, transient state).
6. **Queue backend** — Postgres + River as default; NATS JetStream as opt-in for multi-replica fan-out.
7. **Observability layer** — OpenTelemetry SDK (traces + metrics + logs), OTLP exporter, /metrics for Prometheus scrape, /livez / /readyz / /startupz probes.

5.2 Internal routing (Watermill)

Per research Topic 2: **Watermill** (github.com/ThreeDotsLabs/watermill, ~8.5k stars, v1.4+) is the routing kernel inside `commons_messaging`.

- Each channel adapter (Telegram, Slack, ...) is registered on a single `message.Router` as a `HandlerFunc`.
- Cross-cutting concerns (correlation ID, retry, poison-queue, metrics, throttling, tracing) are implemented as **Watermill middlewares** rather than per-channel code — eliminating ~60% of the plumbing the team would otherwise write.
- Pubsub backend is **pluggable**: Postgres adapter (default), NATS adapter (opt-in), in-memory adapter (tests).

5.3 Queue backend (Postgres + River default, NATS opt-in)

Per research Topic 3:

- **Default: Postgres + riverqueue/river** — transactional enqueue (jobs only run if the originating tx commits), built-in retries with backoff, uniqueness constraints. Zero new infrastructure since Postgres is already required.
- **LISTEN/NOTIFY** wakes consumers sub-millisecond between polls.
- **Opt-in alternative: NATS JetStream** — for deployments needing fan-out across multiple Herald instances, edge sites, or sub-millisecond cross-host latency (~200k–400k msg/s with persistence, built-in KV/Object stores).
- **Kafka is intentionally NOT the default** — overkill for Herald's alert-volume profile (dozens to low-thousands of events/sec per tenant). Document as Watermill-pluggable for operators who already run Kafka.

5.4 Retries & dead-lettering

Per research Topic 5 and AWS arch blog "Exponential Backoff and Jitter":

- **Backoff curve: decorrelated jitter** — `sleep = min(cap, random_between(base, prev_sleep * 3))` with `base = 1s`, `cap = 5min`.
- **Max attempts**: 8 per message for transient errors. Empirically: ~30min worst-case retry window, matching what humans expect of an alert system.
- **No retries on 4xx** from upstream channels — `400` / `401` / `403` / `404` from Telegram/Slack/etc. are permanent.
- Implementation: Watermill Retry middleware in front of channel handlers.
- **Dead letter sink: Postgres `dead_letters` table** (NOT a Redis list — operators need to query, triage, replay):

```
CREATE TABLE dead_letters (  
  id                UUID PRIMARY KEY DEFAULT uuidv7(),  
  tenant_id         UUID NOT NULL,  
  original_event_id UUID NOT NULL,  
  channel           TEXT NOT NULL,  
  attempt_count     INTEGER NOT NULL,  
  last_error        TEXT,  
  payload_jsonb     JSONB NOT NULL,  
  created_at        TIMESTAMPTZ NOT NULL DEFAULT now(),  
  triaged_at        TIMESTAMPTZ,
```

```

    triage_status      TEXT  -- new | acknowledged | replayed |
                           discarded
);
ALTER TABLE dead_letters ENABLE ROW LEVEL SECURITY;
ALTER TABLE dead_letters FORCE ROW LEVEL SECURITY;
CREATE POLICY dl_isolation ON dead_letters
    USING (tenant_id = current_setting('app.tenant_id')::uuid);

```

- Every entry into `dead_letters` also emits a `digital.vasic.herald.delivery.dead_lettered` CloudEvent — Herald observes its own failures.
- CLI: `<flavor>herald deadletter list | replay <id> | purge`.

5.4.1 Outbound idempotency (channel-side composition)

The §4.3 idempotency table guards **ingress**: same event id arriving twice produces one logical delivery. It does NOT, however, guard against the case where Herald has already called `Channel.Send` once and the call's *response* was lost (network blip, container OOM, channel-API timeout). Under at-least-once semantics, the retry layer (§5.4) WILL re-call `Channel.Send` — and a naive channel adapter would re-post the message, producing visible duplicates.

Resolution: every `Channel.Send` invocation MUST pass an **outbound-idempotency key** derived deterministically from (`tenant_id`, `EventID`, `ChannelID`, `ChannelAddressID`). Adapters that support upstream idempotency (Slack `idempotency_key` extension, Stripe-style `Idempotency-Key` header on REST channels, Email `Message-ID` header) MUST forward this key. Adapters whose upstream does NOT support idempotency (raw SMTP, Telegram Bot API, Discord) MUST consult a Postgres `outbound_dedup` table inside the same River job transaction:

```

CREATE TABLE outbound_dedup (
    tenant_id          UUID NOT NULL,
    outbound_key       TEXT NOT NULL,          --
                       "<event_id>:<channel>:<channel_address_id>"
    sent_at            TIMESTAMPTZ NOT NULL DEFAULT now(),
    channel_msg_id     TEXT,
                       -- adapter's Receipt.ChannelMsgID
    expires_at         TIMESTAMPTZ NOT NULL DEFAULT (now() +
        interval '24 hours'),
    PRIMARY KEY (tenant_id, outbound_key)
);
ALTER TABLE outbound_dedup ENABLE ROW LEVEL SECURITY;
ALTER TABLE outbound_dedup FORCE ROW LEVEL SECURITY;
CREATE POLICY od_isolation ON outbound_dedup
    USING (tenant_id = current_setting('app.tenant_id')::uuid)
    WITH CHECK (tenant_id =
        current_setting('app.tenant_id')::uuid);

```

The adapter wraps each send in: `INSERT ... ON CONFLICT DO NOTHING`; if row already existed, return cached `Receipt` without re-calling upstream. The window is short (24h) because we only need to cover the retry-storm window — far shorter than ingress idempotency.

5.5 Webhook ingestion

Per R-16 + research Topic 8. Every webhook source registers a per-source signing secret (rotatable) in the `webhook_sources` table.

The ingress handler enforces, in order:

1. **HMAC-SHA256 signature verification** with `crypto/hmac.Equal` (constant-time) against the source-configured header:
 - GitHub: `X-Hub-Signature-256`
 - Stripe: `Stripe-Signature` (sign `timestamp.payload`)
 - Generic CloudEvents source: `Webhook-Signature`
2. **Timestamp window** ≤ 5 min vs. server clock (replay protection).
3. **Delivery-ID dedup** via the idempotency table (GitHub's `X-GitHub-Delivery`, Stripe's event id).
4. **Optional IP allowlist** as L4 defense-in-depth.

Verified payloads are normalized into a `CloudEvent` and handed to the Watermill router.

webhook_sources schema:

```
CREATE TABLE webhook_sources (
  id          UUID PRIMARY KEY DEFAULT uuidv7(),
  tenant_id   UUID NOT NULL,
  name        TEXT NOT NULL,           -- "github-
  push-prod", "stripe-webhook", ...
  signature_kind TEXT NOT NULL,       -- 'hmac-
  sha256' | 'stripe' | 'telegram-secret-token' | 'dkim' |
  'none'
  signature_header TEXT NOT NULL,     -- 'X-Hub-
  Signature-256', 'Stripe-Signature', ...
  secret_encrypted BYTEA NOT NULL,    -- pgcrypto
  pgp_sym_encrypt
  secret_rotated_at TIMESTAMPTZ NOT NULL DEFAULT now(),
  ip_allowlist INET[],               -- optional
  L4 defense-in-depth
  replay_window_s INTEGER NOT NULL DEFAULT 300, -- 5 min
  enabled      BOOLEAN NOT NULL DEFAULT true,
  created_at   TIMESTAMPTZ NOT NULL DEFAULT now(),
  UNIQUE (tenant_id, name)
);
CREATE INDEX webhook_sources_tenant_idx ON webhook_sources
  (tenant_id) WHERE enabled = true;
ALTER TABLE webhook_sources ENABLE ROW LEVEL SECURITY;
ALTER TABLE webhook_sources FORCE ROW LEVEL SECURITY;
CREATE POLICY ws_isolation ON webhook_sources
  USING (tenant_id = current_setting('app.tenant_id')::uuid)
  WITH CHECK (tenant_id =
    current_setting('app.tenant_id')::uuid);
```

Secrets are rotatable: `<flavor>herald webhook rotate <name>` generates a new secret, returns it once, and starts accepting the new signature while continuing to accept the old one for `replay_window_s × 4` (default 20 min) to drain in-flight deliveries.

Dev / behind-NAT support: smee.io and gh webhook forward are documented as supported proxy paths.

5.6 Orchestration of long-running operations (Temporal, opt-in)

Per research Topic 7:

- **Default routing** — Watermill handlers + River jobs cover the vast majority of fan-out cases.
- **Temporal sidecar (opt-in)** — required for operations that genuinely need durable state across hours/days, deterministic replay, and human-friendly timeline UIs:
 - **Incident escalation chains** (page A → wait 5min → escalate to B → wait 10min → page C). Used by iherald.
 - **Scheduled digest builders** with human-in-the-loop acknowledgment.
 - **Multi-channel orchestrated rollouts** (used by dherald / rherald).
- Temporal is explicitly **not** the default — its operational footprint (separate cluster, gRPC, server upgrades) violates Herald's "lightweight CLI" ethos.

5.7 Ingress API URLs (HTTP surface)

Herald's HTTP ingress (port 24091 default per §9.4) exposes a small, stable URL surface. All paths under /v1/ are public; everything under /admin/ is admin-port only (port 24090).

Method	Path	Purpose
POST	/v1/events	Canonical CloudEvents ingest (binary + structured modes). Body MUST be a CloudEvent per §4.1.
POST	/v1/send	Convenience REST ingest for ad-hoc senders that don't speak CloudEvents — JSON body {type, source, data, tags?, idempotency_key?, priority?} is wrapped into a CloudEvent server-side.
POST	/webhooks/{source_id}	Verified webhook receiver — source_id is a UUID matching webhook_sources.id; the handler enforces §5.5 signature + replay + dedup before forwarding.
GET	/v1/events/{id}	Idempotent replay of a previously-accepted event (returns 200 with cached response if id matches, 409 if id matches but body differs).
GET	/v1/deadletters	List dead-lettered messages (RLS-isolated to caller's tenant).
POST	/v1/deadletters/{id}/replay	Replay a dead-lettered message.
GET	/v1/subscribers / POST /v1/subscribers	Subscriber CRUD (operator role required).
POST		GDPR right-to-erasure (§16.1).

Method	Path	Purpose
	/v1/subscribers/{id}/forget	
GET	/v1/subscribers/{id}/export	GDPR right-to-portability — emits JSON bundle.
GET	/v1/channels	List configured channel addresses for the caller's tenant.
GET	/livez	Liveness probe (admin port — §17.5).
GET	/readyz	Readiness probe (admin port).
GET	/startupz	Startup probe (admin port).
GET	/metrics	Prometheus scrape (admin port).
GET	/admin/version	Build info (commit SHA, build time, Go version).
GET	/admin/pprof/*	Go runtime profiling (admin port; loopback-only by default; opt-in [admin].pprof_external=true).

Auth model:

- /v1/events and /v1/send accept either (a) HTTP Basic auth with a per-tenant ingest_token from the tenants table, or (b) signed bearer token in Authorization: Bearer <jwt> (Herald validates against JWKS configured in [auth.oidc]). Self-hosted operators MAY enable mTLS via a reverse proxy.
- /webhooks/{source_id} does its own signature verification (§5.5) — no token required at the HTTP layer.
- /v1/subscribers* requires a JWT with operator-role claim.
- Admin endpoints listen only on the admin port (default loopback or trusted-network only).

Versioning: the /v1/ prefix is the stable contract; breaking changes ship as /v2/ with at least 6 months of /v1/ co-existence. The OpenAPI schema (docs/api/openapi.v1.yaml) is the source of truth — <flavor>herald openapi prints the embedded spec.

Rate limits: per-tenant token bucket (§16, default 1000 req/min per tenant on /v1/events); per-IP secondary bucket for unauthenticated webhook receivers (default 60 req/min/IP).

§6. Channel addressing & routing

6.1 URL-scheme channel addresses (Apprise-style)

Per research Topic 1 (notification-platforms): adopt Apprise's URL-scheme channel model. Each destination is a single string that fully captures credentials + endpoint + targeting:

```

tgram://<bot_token>/<chat_id>?tags=oncall,prod
slack://<token_a>/<token_b>/<token_c>/<channel>?tags=oncall
max://<bot_token>/<chat_id>?tags=ru,prod
mailto://<user>:<pass>@<smtp_host>:<port>?
tags=audit&from=herald@example.com
discord://<webhook_id>/<webhook_token>?tags=community
teams://<incoming_webhook_path>?tags=corp
lark://<app_id>:<app_secret>@<chat_id>?tags=apac
ntfy://<server>/<topic>?priority=high&tags=mobile
gotify://<token>@<server>?priority=5
webhook://<endpoint_url>?secret=<hmac_secret>&format=cloudevent
diary://?tags=*&format=markdown

```

This URL form maps 1:1 to a row in Postgres `channel_addresses` and lets credentials be `.env`-interpolated at config-load time so the URLs themselves stay git-safe in committed `config.toml`.

6.2 Tag-based fan-out

Per Apprise's tag model: every channel address is annotated with one or more **tags**. Senders address tags, not specific channels:

- **OR-union by default:** `--tags=oncall,prod` matches any channel tagged `oncall` OR `prod`.
- **AND-intersection** when explicitly comma-joined inside a single argument: `--tags=oncall+prod` matches channels tagged `oncall` AND `prod`.
- Tag `*` is the wildcard (matches every channel).
- Tag `!oncall` means "exclude `oncall`" (intersect with negation).

Tag→channel mapping lives in the `channel_addresses` table; senders never reference channel addresses directly. This decouples sender code from topology — the same event can fan out to a different mix of channels per environment without code change.

channel_addresses schema:

```

CREATE TABLE channel_addresses (
    id                UUID PRIMARY KEY DEFAULT uuidv7(),
    tenant_id         UUID NOT NULL,
    channel           TEXT NOT NULL,           -- "tgram",
                     "slack", "mailto", ...
    address_url       TEXT NOT NULL,           -- "tgram://$
                     {BOT_TOKEN}/{CHAT_ID}?..." (env-interpolated at load time)
    tags              TEXT[] NOT NULL DEFAULT '{}', --
                     ['oncall','prod']
    priority_floor    INTEGER NOT NULL DEFAULT 1,
                     -- ntfy 1..5; messages below floor are dropped for this
                     address
    enabled           BOOLEAN NOT NULL DEFAULT true,
    last_health_at    TIMESTAMPTZ,
    last_health_ok    BOOLEAN,
    last_health_err   TEXT,
    created_at        TIMESTAMPTZ NOT NULL DEFAULT now(),
    UNIQUE (tenant_id, address_url)

```

```
);
CREATE INDEX ch_addr_tags_idx ON channel_addresses USING gin
    (tags) WHERE enabled = true;
CREATE INDEX ch_addr_tenant_idx ON channel_addresses (tenant_id,
    channel) WHERE enabled = true;
ALTER TABLE channel_addresses ENABLE ROW LEVEL SECURITY;
ALTER TABLE channel_addresses FORCE ROW LEVEL SECURITY;
CREATE POLICY ca_isolation ON channel_addresses
    USING (tenant_id = current_setting('app.tenant_id')::uuid)
    WITH CHECK (tenant_id =
        current_setting('app.tenant_id')::uuid);
```

The address_url MAY contain \${ENV_VAR} placeholders that are interpolated at config load time (so secrets stay out of the row body — only the placeholder is persisted; secrets remain in .env / shell env).

6.3 HeraldBranding (per-flavor visual identity)

Per Apprise's AppriseAsset: a HeraldBranding struct injected per-flavor:

```
type Branding struct {
    AppName      string // "Project Herald"
    BinaryName    string // "pherald"
    IconURL       string // for rich embeds
    AccentColorHex string // "#2C7BE5"
    DefaultFooter string // "Sent by pherald 1.0 · github.com/
        vasic-digital/Herald"
}
```

Channel adapters consult Branding when rendering rich messages (Slack Block Kit headers, Discord embed author, Adaptive Card Container accent color, Email From-name).

§7. Subscriber model

7.1 Identity & reconciliation (per-channel-id + operator alias)

Per R-07 + research Topic 3 (notification-platforms): the **matterbridge model** is the default — per-channel-id is the source of truth. A subscriber on Telegram is identified by (channel:"tgram", chat_id:"42"); the same human on Slack is (channel:"slack", user_id:"U0123"); these are **separate entries** unless explicitly linked.

Schema:

```
CREATE TABLE subscribers (
    id          UUID PRIMARY KEY DEFAULT uuidv7(),
    tenant_id   UUID NOT NULL,
    handle      TEXT,                                -- operator-
        assigned, e.g. "alice"
    display_name TEXT,
```

```

    locale          TEXT DEFAULT 'en-US',
    timezone        TEXT DEFAULT 'UTC',
    roles           TEXT[] NOT NULL DEFAULT '{}',      -- e.g.
                  ['operator','reader','ic']
    metadata        JSONB NOT NULL DEFAULT '{}':::jsonb,
    created_at      TIMESTAMPTZ NOT NULL DEFAULT now(),
    UNIQUE (tenant_id, handle)                        -- handle is
                  unique within a tenant
);
CREATE INDEX subscribers_tenant_idx ON subscribers (tenant_id);
ALTER TABLE subscribers ENABLE ROW LEVEL SECURITY;
ALTER TABLE subscribers FORCE ROW LEVEL SECURITY;
CREATE POLICY sub_isolation ON subscribers
    USING (tenant_id = current_setting('app.tenant_id')::uuid)
    WITH CHECK (tenant_id =
        current_setting('app.tenant_id')::uuid);

CREATE TABLE subscriber_aliases (
    subscriber_id    UUID NOT NULL REFERENCES subscribers(id) ON
                    DELETE CASCADE,
    channel          TEXT NOT NULL,
    channel_user_id  TEXT NOT NULL,
    verified_at      TIMESTAMPTZ,                      -- self-claim
                  verification time
    last_seen_at     TIMESTAMPTZ,
    UNIQUE (channel, channel_user_id)
);
CREATE INDEX subscriber_aliases_sub_idx ON subscriber_aliases
    (subscriber_id);

```

Linking flows:

- **Operator-mapped** (default): operator runs `pherald subscriber link --handle alice --tgram 42 --slack U0123`.
- **Self-claim** (opt-in per tenant): subscriber DMs a one-time token to the bot on each channel; the bot calls `pherald subscriber verify <token>` to record the alias.
- **Never inferred** — Herald does not guess identity across channels.

7.2 Preferences (Knock-style PreferenceSet)

Per research Topic 2 (notification-platforms): a Knock-inspired PreferenceSet JSON per subscriber:

```

{
  "categories": {
    "incidents": { "channels": ["slack","tgram","email"],
    "muted": false },
    "deploys": { "channels": ["slack"], "muted": false },
    "daily_digest": { "channels": ["email"], "muted": false }
  },
  "workflows": {
    "digital.vasic.herald.alert.firing": { "muted": false,
    "channels": ["tgram","slack"] },

```

```

    "digital.vasic.herald.alert.resolved": { "muted": true }
  },
  "quiet_hours": { "tz": "Europe/Belgrade", "start": "22:00",
"end": "07:00", "exempt_categories": ["incidents"] },
  "channel_data": {
    "tgram": { "chat_id": "42", "thread_id": null },
    "slack": { "user_id": "U0123", "im_channel": "D098" }
  }
}

```

- The router consults PreferenceSet before dispatching: if muted for the workflow/category, drop (and log to diary as "filtered"); otherwise restrict to listed channels and respect quiet hours.
- channel_data carries provider-specific routing keys that don't fit the generic alias model (Slack im_channel for DMs, Telegram thread_id for forum-topic posts).

7.3 Quiet hours & throttling

- **Quiet hours** — TZ-aware window per subscriber; exempt categories override.
- **Throttling** — per-(tenant, subscriber, category) token bucket in Redis (herald:t:<id>:rl:<sub>:<cat> with INCR+EXPIRE); default cap configurable per tenant.
- **Batching** — per category, optional batch_window (e.g. 5min); events within the window collapse into a single digest message. Implementation: River job scheduled batch_window after the first event arrives.

7.4 Locale (i18n)

Per research Topic 6 (notification-platforms): **nicksnyder/go-i18n v2** with CLDR plural rules.

- One Bundle loaded at process start from commons_messaging/locales/*.toml.
- One Localizer per outgoing message, constructed from the subscriber's stored locale field (BCP-47 tag).
- Per-channel templates can override (emoji-heavy Telegram template vs sober email template, both for the same locale).
- Initial locales for V2: en-US, sr-Latn-RS, ru-RU. Additional locales as community contributes them.

7.5 AI-agent subscribers (distinct from human subscribers)

Herald is explicitly a target for AI CLI agent invocation (per §3.2). Agents are a fundamentally different kind of subscriber from humans: they invoke far more frequently, they don't sleep, they don't have quiet hours, and their failure modes (runaway loop, infinite retry, prompt-injection-driven misuse) need stronger throttling. V2 models them as a first-class subscriber kind.

Schema extension to subscribers:

- kind column (enum: human | agent | service). Default human. Indexes added on (tenant_id, kind).

- agent rows **MUST** carry a `metadata.agent_token_id` pointing at a row in `agent_tokens` (separate table, encrypted), used as the auth credential when the agent calls `/v1/send`.
- agent rows **MUST** carry `metadata.parent_subscriber_id` (the human operator who created the agent) so audit + GDPR right-to-erasure cascades correctly.

```
CREATE TABLE agent_tokens (
  id          UUID PRIMARY KEY DEFAULT uuidv7(),
  tenant_id   UUID NOT NULL,
  subscriber_id UUID NOT NULL REFERENCES subscribers(id) ON
    DELETE CASCADE,
  token_hash  BYTEA NOT NULL,           -- argon2id
    of the bearer token
  name        TEXT NOT NULL,           -- "claude-
    code-laptop", "build-bot-prod"
  created_at  TIMESTAMPTZ NOT NULL DEFAULT now(),
  last_used_at TIMESTAMPTZ,
  expires_at  TIMESTAMPTZ,             -- nullable
    = no expiry
  revoked_at  TIMESTAMPTZ,
  rate_limit_per_min INTEGER NOT NULL DEFAULT 60, -- default
    60 req/min per token
  UNIQUE (tenant_id, name)
);
ALTER TABLE agent_tokens ENABLE ROW LEVEL SECURITY;
ALTER TABLE agent_tokens FORCE ROW LEVEL SECURITY;
CREATE POLICY at_isolation ON agent_tokens
  USING (tenant_id = current_setting('app.tenant_id')::uuid)
  WITH CHECK (tenant_id =
    current_setting('app.tenant_id')::uuid);
```

Default throttling (operator-overridable per token):

Limit	Default	Burst	Notes
<code>/v1/send</code> requests	60 req/min/token	10	per the <code>rate_limit_per_min</code> column
<code>/v1/events</code> requests	30 req/min/token	5	tighter because CloudEvents body is unbounded
Outbound deliveries per token per min	120	20	a single agent CAN'T flood a tenant's channels
Quarantine threshold	3 consecutive rejected sends → token disabled for 30 min	—	auto-cool-down to prevent prompt-injection loops

Audit + observability: every agent send emits a span with `herald.subscriber.kind="agent"` and `herald.agent.token_id`; dashboards split agent vs human traffic by default. The `herald` flavor (per §18.10) flags suspicious agent patterns (sudden volume spike, off-hours bursts) as compliance events.

Quiet hours: ignored for kind=agent by default — agents are expected to send during off-hours. Operator MAY opt-in to per-token quiet hours via `agent_tokens.metadata.quiet_hours`.

Revocation: `<flavor>herald subscriber agent-token revoke <name>` zeroes the row's `revoked_at` and invalidates the token immediately (Redis cache TTL 30 s for token validity).

§8. Workable-item naming prefix

8.1 Static prefix HRD–

For all opened workable items for the Herald project (Issues, Issues_Summary, Fixed, Fixed_Summary, Status, Status_Summary, etc.) use the prefix HRD. Examples: HRD-001, HRD-002. Strict zero-padded sequence within each docset.

8.2 Derived 3-letter prefix algorithm

Per R-17 — when a consuming project does NOT define its own workable-item prefix, Herald derives a deterministic 3-letter prefix from the project name. Implementation lives in `commons/prefix`.

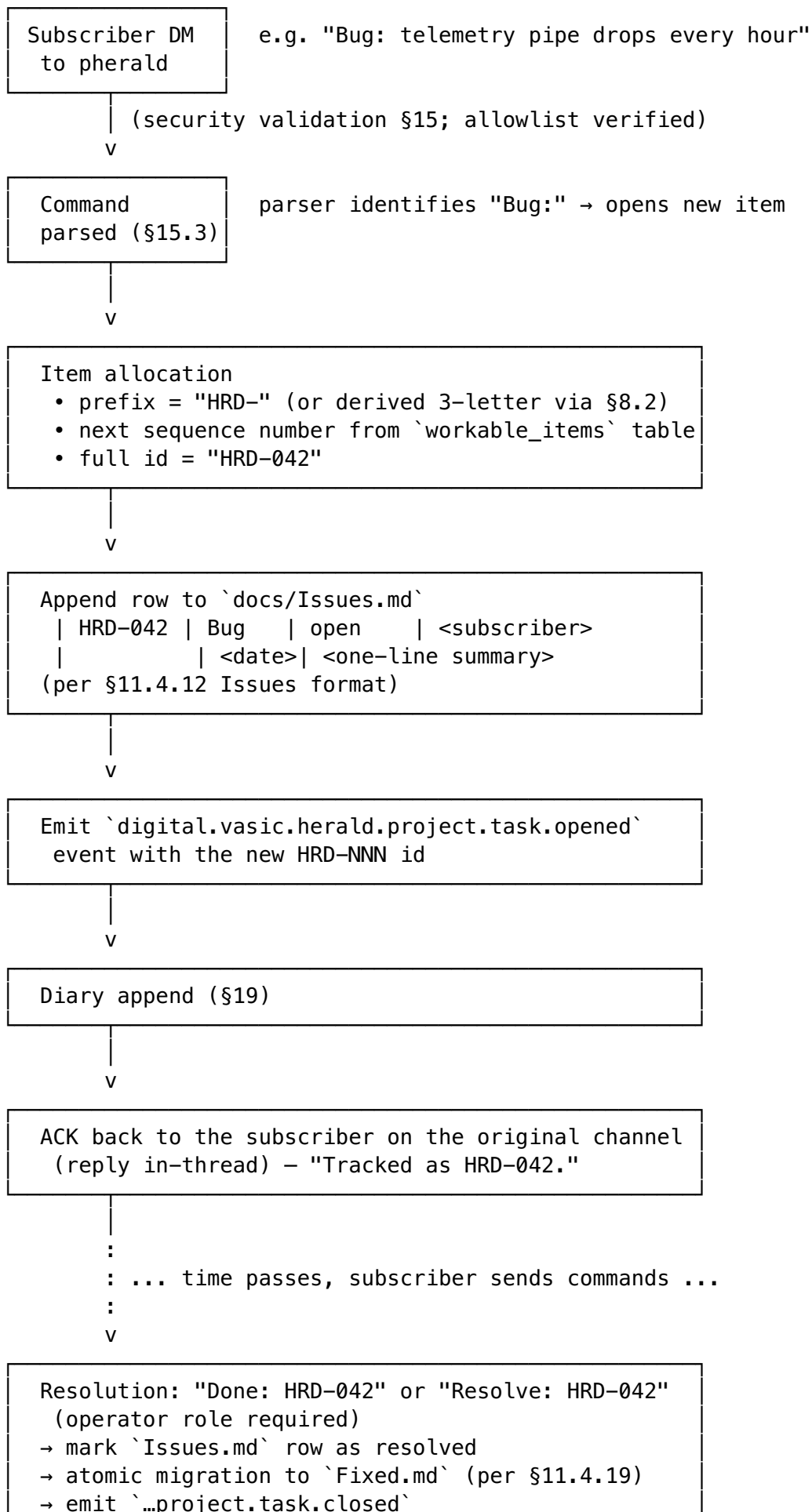
Algorithm (~80 LOC):

1. **Normalize:** Unicode NFKD → strip diacritics → retain [A-Za-z0-9] → split on CamelCase boundaries and [-_ /] into tokens.
2. **Rule A (≥3 tokens):** first letter of each of the first three tokens. HeraldRouterCore → HRC.
3. **Rule B (2 tokens):** first letter of token 1; first letter of token 2; first internal consonant of token 2. HeraldRouter → HRT; HeraldRunner → HRN.
4. **Rule C (1 token):** first letter, first internal consonant, last consonant. Herald → HRD.
5. Uppercase.
6. **Collision resolution:** maintain committed `.herald/prefix.lock` (TOML name → prefix). On collision with a *different* project, compute `fnv1a32(name) mod 26` and replace the third letter with 'A' + (h mod 26); iterate up to 26 times, then fall back to numeric suffix HR0...HR9.
7. **Persistence:** the lock file is committed so the mapping is stable across machines and regenerations.

No mature Go library exists for 3-letter abbreviation generation (the only Go prior art Defacto2/releaser/initialism is a curated lookup table, not a generator); Herald ships its own.

8.3 Workable-item lifecycle (HRD–NNN flow)

A workable item moves through this lifecycle across pherald's subscriber-command handlers and the docs/ tracker files (per Universal §11.4.12 + §11.4.53):



→ ACK in original thread

workable_items schema (lightweight pointer table — the canonical record lives in the Markdown files for human edit-ability per Universal §6):

```
CREATE TABLE workable_items (  
    tenant_id    UUID NOT NULL,  
    item_id      TEXT NOT NULL,           -- "HRD-042"  
    prefix       TEXT NOT NULL,           -- "HRD"  
    sequence     INTEGER NOT NULL,        -- 42  
    item_type    TEXT NOT NULL,           -- 'bug' |  
                'issue' | 'query' | 'request' | 'question'  
    status       TEXT NOT NULL,           -- 'open' |  
                'in_progress' | 'blocked' | 'resolved' | 'wont_fix'  
    opened_by    UUID,                   -- subscriber  
                id  
    opened_at    TIMESTAMPTZ NOT NULL DEFAULT now(),  
    resolved_at  TIMESTAMPTZ,  
    source_thread JSONB,                 --  
                ConversationRef serialised  
    PRIMARY KEY (tenant_id, item_id),  
    UNIQUE (tenant_id, prefix, sequence)  
);  
CREATE INDEX wi_status_idx ON workable_items (tenant_id, status)  
    WHERE status <> 'resolved';  
ALTER TABLE workable_items ENABLE ROW LEVEL SECURITY;  
ALTER TABLE workable_items FORCE ROW LEVEL SECURITY;  
CREATE POLICY wi_isolation ON workable_items  
    USING (tenant_id = current_setting('app.tenant_id')::uuid)  
    WITH CHECK (tenant_id =  
        current_setting('app.tenant_id')::uuid);
```

Sequence allocation: a per-tenant Postgres advisory lock around $\text{MAX}(\text{sequence}) + 1$ inside the transaction; safe under concurrent Bug: commands. For high-volume tenants, a per-prefix sequence is preallocated in batches (default batch size 100) cached in Redis to avoid contention.

Reopening: Reopen: HRD-042 (operator role) reverses the migration: row moves back to Issues.md, status='in_progress', resolved_at cleared, history preserved in docs/Reopens/HRD-042.md per Universal §11.4.55.

§9. Technology stack

9.1 Go (single-binary, multi-flavor)

Herald and all flavors MUST BE written in Go.

Toolchain pin: Go ≥ 1.22 is mandatory (stdlib log/slog, OTel slog bridge, slices + maps generics). The repo's go.mod files declare go 1.22 and set toolchain go1.22.x to the current patch release. Bumps to ≥ 1.23 are allowed when CI proves no regression; the commons module is the authoritative version (every flavor MUST follow).

License: Herald is published under the terms in [LICENSE](#) (parent project's chosen license). All go.mod files MUST declare the same license via a top-level comment, and every LICENSE file in vendored submodules MUST remain present. License compliance is checked by the planned cherald flavor (per §18.10) on every CI run when configured.

Layout (per R-18, research Topic 5):

```
Herald/
├─ go.work                                # local dev only, .gitignored
├─ commons/      go.mod                  # module github.com/vasic-digital/
herald/commons
├─ pherald/      go.mod                  # module github.com/vasic-digital/
herald/pherald → cmd/pherald
├─ sherald/      go.mod                  # module github.com/vasic-digital/
herald/sherald → cmd/sherald
├─ bherald/      go.mod                  # ... etc
├─ .goreleaser.yaml                        # one config, builds all flavors
├─ docs/, tests/, ...
```

Each flavor's go.mod declares require github.com/vasic-digital/herald/commons vX.Y.Z. **Lockstep release:** one git tag triggers GoReleaser to build all flavors and tag commons/vX.Y.Z. Use [release-please](#) in manifest mode to bump from Conventional Commits. go.work is git-ignored so CI catches forgotten bumps.

9.2 Postgres + Row-Level Security

Postgres is the main database, deployed via the containers submodule. Schema highlights:

- Every business table carries tenant_id UUID NOT NULL; composite indexes (tenant_id, ...).
- FORCE ROW LEVEL SECURITY enabled on every multi-tenant table.
- Runtime role: herald_app (no BYPASSRLS). Migration role: herald_migrator (BYPASSRLS).
- SET LOCAL app.tenant_id = '<uuid>' at the start of every transaction.
- UUIDv7 (uuidv7() function) for time-ordered primary keys.

9.3 Redis (per-tenant ACL)

Redis is the in-memory store, deployed via containers submodule.

- **Per-tenant ACL user:** redis-cli ACL SETUSER tenant_<id> on >pwd ~t:<id>:* +@read +@write ...
- **Key prefixing:** t:<tenant_id>:... on every key.
- Usage: rate-limit token buckets, fast-path idempotency-cache, transient deduplication, hot subscriber lookups.

9.4 Container ports (24XXX)

Per R-01: all Container host ports start with **24XXX** prefix (1024–49151 IANA User Ports, below the Linux ephemeral floor at 32768, above all common service defaults — Postgres 5432, Redis 6379, web 3000/5000/8000/8080/9000).

Reserved sub-blocks:

Range	Purpose
24000–24099	flavor app data ports (one per flavor instance)
24090–24099	flavor admin ports (/livez, /readyz, /metrics, pprof)
24100–24199	Postgres instances (default 24100)
24200–24299	Redis instances (default 24200)
24300–24399	NATS JetStream (when enabled)
24400–24499	OpenTelemetry Collector (default OTLP gRPC 24417, HTTP 24418)
24500–24599	Prometheus / Grafana (when self-hosted alongside)
24600–24699	Temporal (when enabled)
24700–24999	reserved for future / per-tenant

9.5 containers submodule

The full Docker/Podman Compose stack is provided by [vasic-digital/containers](#) as a Git submodule (per R-12, the owned-submodule set in HERALD_CONSTITUTION.md will be updated in the PR that introduces the submodule). All container names MUST start with prefix `herald`.

9.6 Database migration tooling

Herald uses [golang-migrate/migrate](#) (the de-facto standard Go migration tool) embedded as a library inside `commons_storage`. Rationale: `golang-migrate` is binary-distributable AND embeddable, supports up/down, file checksums (drift detection), `schema_migrations` table version locking, and ships idempotent migrations.

File layout (`commons_storage/migrations/`):

```
commons_storage/migrations/  
├─ 000001_init_core.up.sql      # tenants, roles, encryption  
keys  
├─ 000001_init_core.down.sql
```

```

└─ 000002_idempotency_keys.up.sql
└─ 000002_idempotency_keys.down.sql
└─ 000003_subscribers.up.sql      # subscribers +
subscriber_aliases (§7.1)
└─ 000003_subscribers.down.sql
└─ 000004_channel_addresses.up.sql      # §6
└─ 000004_channel_addresses.down.sql
└─ 000005_webhook_sources.up.sql      # §5.5
└─ 000005_webhook_sources.down.sql
└─ 000006_thread_refs.up.sql          # §12
└─ 000006_thread_refs.down.sql
└─ 000007_quarantined_messages.up.sql  # §15.2
└─ 000007_quarantined_messages.down.sql
└─ 000008_dead_letters.up.sql         # §5.4
└─ 000008_dead_letters.down.sql
└─ 000009_email_suppressions.up.sql    # §11.9
└─ 000009_email_suppressions.down.sql
└─ 000010_river_jobs.up.sql           # River queue schema
(managed by river/cmd/river)
└─ 000010_river_jobs.down.sql
└─ 000011_rls_policies.up.sql         # FORCE RLS on every
multi-tenant table

```

Numbering: zero-padded 6-digit sequence (000001..000999 reserved for V2 baseline; 001000.. reserved for V3+). Down migrations **MUST** exist for every up migration so `<flavor>herald migrate down -n 1` is always safe.

Runtime contract:

- `<flavor>herald migrate up [--steps N]` — apply pending migrations forward.
- `<flavor>herald migrate down --steps N` — rollback N migrations (gated behind interactive confirmation unless `--yes`).
- `<flavor>herald migrate status` — show current version + pending count.
- `<flavor>herald migrate force <version>` — recovery only; sets the version without running migrations (operator **MUST** verify manually).
- `<flavor>herald migrate validate` — checksum every applied migration against the source files; fails if drift detected.

Roles (per §16):

- `herald_migrator` — `BYPASSRLS`, owns schema, runs DDL. Only used by `migrate` subcommand.
- `herald_app` — runtime role; cannot run DDL.

Forward compatibility (per §26.3): migrations **MUST** be backward-compatible for **two minor versions** so rolling restarts during a deploy don't break the running fleet. Practical patterns: add nullable columns first, backfill, then add `NOT NULL`; never drop a column the previous binary version still reads; never rename a column — add the new one, dual-write, then drop the old in a later release.

§10. Commons (architecture layers)

Per the layering principle in V1: commons -> commons level 1 -> ... -> commons level N -> Flavor. V2 names the layers concretely:

Layer	Module	Owns
L0	commons	CloudEvents envelope, Channel interface, Branding, error types, time/uuid helpers
L1	commons_messaging	Watermill router, retry/throttle/dedup middlewares, channel adapters (Telegram, Slack, ...), templating, i18n
L1	commons_storage	Postgres connection + RLS middleware, River queue setup, Redis client + tenant ACL, migrations
L1	commons_security	HMAC verifiers (Slack/GitHub/Telegram/generic), DKIM/SPF/DMARC helpers, allowlist evaluator, command parser
L1	commons_observability	OTel setup, span helpers, metrics registration, log handler wiring (slog + otelslog)
L1	commons_prefix	3-letter prefix algorithm (§8.2)
L1	commons_diary	append + export + sync (§19)
L2	commons_workflows	Temporal workflow scaffolding (escalation chains, digest builders) — opt-in
Flavor	pherald, sherald, ...	Per-flavor commands, event-type handlers, flavor-specific subscriber commands

Rule of thumb (carry from V1): put new shared code in the **lowest layer that still makes sense**; flavors inherit upward.

§11. Channels — per-channel capabilities matrix

11.0 Channel adapter contract (Go interface + value types)

Each channel adapter implements the Channel interface defined in commons (L0). The full contract:

```
package commons // L0
```

```
import "context"
```

```
// Channel is the interface every channel adapter implements.
```

```
type Channel interface {  
    Name()  
    string  
    "tgram", "slack", ...  
}
```

```
//
```

```

Capabilities()
    Capabilities //
        declarative feature flags
Send(ctx context.Context, msg OutboundMessage) (Receipt,
    error)
Subscribe(ctx context.Context, h InboundHandler)
    error // long-running; called by `serve`
HealthCheck(ctx context.Context) error
}

// Capabilities advertises what an adapter supports at runtime.
// Routers consult Capabilities before dispatching; mismatches are
// logged
// and the message is dropped or downgraded (per the adapter's
// choice).
type Capabilities struct {
    Text bool
    Markdown bool // adapter's native markdown flavor
        (Slack mrkdwn, Telegram MarkdownV2, etc.)
    HTML bool
    Attachments bool
    AttachmentMaxMiB int
    Threads bool // first-class reply threading
    InteractiveURL bool // URL buttons / link actions
    InteractiveCall bool // callback handlers (advanced tier)
    DeliveryCeiling DeliveryEvidence // see §17 / R-05
}

// DeliveryEvidence enumerates the strongest reachable signal per
// channel.
type DeliveryEvidence int

const (
    DeliveryUnknown DeliveryEvidence = iota
    DeliveryAccepted // hop-by-hop ack (SMTP
        250)
    DeliveryRouted // platform stored &
        broadcast (Telegram/Slack API ok)
    DeliveryDelivered // recipient transport
        confirmed (Email DSN, WA delivered receipt)
    DeliveryRead // recipient read (Email
        MDN, Telegram Business read marker)
)

// OutboundMessage is the value passed to Channel.Send.
type OutboundMessage struct {
    EventID string // CloudEvents id (§4)
    IdempotencyKey string // explicit; falls back to
        EventID
    TenantID string
    To
        []Recipient // resolved from subscriber preferences
        + tag fan-out
    Subject string // optional (Email, RSS-
        like channels)

```

```

    Body          Body          // rendered per-channel
        template output
    Attachments    []Attachment
    Thread         *ConversationRef // optional; per $12
    Priority        Priority      // ntfy-compatible 1..5
    Actions         []Action      // optional interactive
        buttons
    Branding        Branding      // per-flavor ($6.3)
    Trace           TraceContext  // OTel propagation
}

// Body carries one or more rendered representations; adapter
// picks the best
// match for its Capabilities (e.g., HTML for email, Markdown for
// Telegram,
// Block-Kit JSON for Slack).
type Body struct {
    Plain      string
    Markdown   string
    HTML       string
    Native     map[string]any // adapter-specific (Slack
        blocks, Adaptive Card JSON, ...)
}

// Attachment is a single attached file.
type Attachment struct {
    Filename    string
    MIMETYPE    string
    SizeBytes   int64
    Reader      func() (io.ReadCloser, error) // lazy open so the
        adapter streams without buffering
    CID         string // optional inline-
        image Content-ID (Email)
}

// Recipient is a resolved (channel, channel_user_id) pair.
type Recipient struct {
    Channel      string // "tgram", "slack", "mailto", ...
    ChannelUserID string // chat_id, U0xxx, email address, ...
    DisplayName  string // best-effort, for templating
}

// Action is an interactive UI hint (rendered as URL button,
// callback button,
// Adaptive Card action, ntfy X-Action, etc. depending on
// Capabilities).
type Action struct {
    Type
        ActionType // ActionView | ActionURL | ActionCallback |
            ActionHTTP | ActionCopy
    Label  string
    URL    string // for ActionView / ActionURL / ActionHTTP
    Method string // "GET" | "POST" (ActionHTTP)
    Body   []byte // ActionHTTP

```

```

    Data    string    // ActionCallback payload (provider-
                      // defined, e.g. Telegram callback_data)
}

type ActionType int

const (
    ActionView      ActionType = iota // open a URL
    ActionURL        // synonym for ActionView;
                      // provider-specific styling
    ActionCallback   // round-trip back into
                      // Herald via inbound handler
    ActionHTTP       // fire-and-forget HTTP
                      // request from the recipient device (ntfy)
    ActionCopy       // copy text to clipboard
                      // (ntfy)
)

// Priority maps to ntfy 1..5 and to per-channel native
// priorities.
type Priority int

const (
    PriorityLow      Priority = 1
    PriorityNormal    Priority = 3
    PriorityHigh      Priority = 4
    PriorityUrgent    Priority = 5
)

// Receipt is what Channel.Send returns on success – the adapter's
// evidence
// of acceptance/routing/delivery so the router can decide whether
// to retry.
type Receipt struct {
    Evidence          DeliveryEvidence
    ChannelMsgID      string           // Slack ts; Telegram
                      // message_id; SMTP queue-id; ...
    SentAt            time.Time
    LatencyMillis      int64
    Native             map[string]any   // adapter-specific raw
                      // response (for diary)
}

// InboundHandler receives messages emitted by the adapter's
// Subscribe loop.
// Implementations enqueue events back into the router (§5).
type InboundHandler interface {
    Handle(ctx context.Context, ev InboundEvent) error
}

// InboundEvent is a CloudEvent constructed from a subscriber
// message.
type InboundEvent struct {
    EventID           string           // UUIDv7

```

```

CloudEvent      CloudEventEnvelope    // §4.1
Sender          Recipient              // who sent it
Subscriber      *Subscriber            // resolved via
               subscriber_aliases, nil if unknown
Body            Body
Attachments     []Attachment
Thread          *ConversationRef
Raw             map[string]any         // adapter-specific raw payload
               (for diary)
}

// Subscriber is the in-memory projection of one row from
// `subscribers`
// (§7.1) plus all linked `subscriber_aliases` for the resolved
// channel.
// Pointer fields are nullable; consumers MUST nil-check before
// use.
type Subscriber struct {
    ID          uuid.UUID
    TenantID    uuid.UUID
    Handle      string          // empty if not operator-
               mapped
    DisplayName string
    Locale      string          // BCP-47, e.g. "en-US", "sr-
               Latn-RS"
    Timezone    string          // IANA, e.g. "Europe/
               Belgrade"
    Roles       []string        // e.g.
               ["operator","ic","reader"]
    Metadata    map[string]any  // free-form per-subscriber
               data
    Aliases     []SubscriberAlias // all channels this human is
               reachable on
    Preferences *PreferenceSet  // see §7.2; nil ⇒ tenant
               defaults apply
}

// SubscriberAlias is one row from `subscriber_aliases`.
type SubscriberAlias struct {
    Channel      string          // "tgram", "slack",
               "mailto", ...
    ChannelUserID string          // chat_id, U0xxx, email
               address, ...
    VerifiedAt   *time.Time      // nil ⇒ operator-mapped (not self-
               verified)
    LastSeenAt   *time.Time
}

// CloudEventEnvelope is Herald's typed projection of a
// CloudEvents v1.0
// payload. SDK type used at the boundaries is cloudevents.Event
// from

```

```

// github.com/cloudevents/sdk-go/v2 – this struct is the in-
// process
// canonical form after parsing/validation.
type CloudEventEnvelope struct {
    SpecVersion    string           // "1.0"
    ID             string           // UUIDv7 (natural
// ordering)
    Source         string           // URI
    Type           string           // reverse-DNS, e.g.
// "digital.vasic.herald.ci.failed"
    Time           time.Time        // RFC 3339
    Subject        string           // tag:/channel:/
// empty
    DataContentType string           // e.g. "application/
// json"
    Data           []byte           // opaque payload
    Extensions     map[string]string // heralddenant,
// heralddidempotencykey, heraldpriority, ...
}

// TraceContext carries OpenTelemetry trace propagation across
// Herald
// boundaries (HTTP ingress → router → River job → channel
// adapter).
// Stored alongside messages so spans link correctly even when a
// job
// runs asynchronously minutes after the originating request
// returned.
type TraceContext struct {
    TraceID    string // 32-hex chars (W3C Trace Context)
    SpanID     string // 16-hex chars (the parent span at
// handoff)
    TraceFlags byte   // sampling flags (W3C)
    TraceState string // vendor-specific (W3C tracestate header)
    Baggage    string // W3C baggage header value
}

// Branding is the per-flavor visual identity (§6.3 reference).
// One Branding is constructed per flavor binary at startup and
// threaded
// through OutboundMessage so adapters render channel-specific
// bling.
type Branding struct {
    AppName    string // "Project Herald", "System
// Herald", ...
    BinaryName string // "pherald", "sherald", ...
    IconURL    string // for rich embeds (Slack auth user,
// Discord author, ...)
    AccentColorHex
// string // "#2C7BE5" – used as Slack attachment color,
// Discord embed color, Adaptive Card accent
    DefaultFooter string // "Sent by pherald 1.0 · github.com/
// vasic-digital/Herald"
}

```

```

// ChannelID is the canonical channel identifier. It MUST match
// the
// scheme used in `channel_addresses.address_url` and in the URL
// scheme registered by the adapter (e.g. "tgram", "slack",
// "mailto").
type ChannelID string

const (
    ChannelTelegram ChannelID = "tgram"
    ChannelMax       ChannelID = "max"
    ChannelSlack     ChannelID = "slack"
    ChannelDiscord   ChannelID = "discord"
    ChannelTeams     ChannelID = "teams"
    ChannelLark      ChannelID = "lark"
    ChannelWhatsApp  ChannelID = "whatsapp"
    ChannelViber     ChannelID = "viber"
    ChannelEmail     ChannelID = "mailto"
    ChannelNtfy      ChannelID = "ntfy"
    ChannelGotify    ChannelID = "gotify"
    ChannelWebhook   ChannelID = "webhook"
    ChannelDiary     ChannelID = "diary"
    ChannelNull      ChannelID = "null" // §11.14 sandbox/no-op
                                adapter for tests
)

// PreferenceSet is a typed view of the per-subscriber preferences
// JSON
// stored in `subscribers.metadata.preferences` (§7.2). See §7.2
// for the
// JSON shape; this is the Go decoded form.
type PreferenceSet struct {
    Categories map[string]CategoryPref // category_id → pref
    Workflows  map[string]WorkflowPref // CloudEvents type →
                                pref
    QuietHours *QuietHours // nil ⇒ no quiet hours
                                configured
    ChannelData map[ChannelID]any // provider-specific
                                routing data
}

type CategoryPref struct {
    Channels []ChannelID
    Muted    bool
}

type WorkflowPref struct {
    Channels []ChannelID // may be empty (= use Category default)
    Muted    bool
}

type QuietHours struct {
    TZ          string // IANA TZ
    Start       string // "HH:MM" 24h
    End         string // "HH:MM" 24h
}

```

```

    ExemptCategories []string // categories that override quiet
                             hours
}

```

These types live in `commons/types.go` and `commons/preferences.go`. Every adapter under `commons_messaging/channels/<name>` consumes them; no adapter is allowed to invent its own equivalent (the contract is the contract). Additional helpers in `commons/cloudevents.go` (`CloudEventEnvelope` $\rightleftharpoons$ `cloudevents.Event`), `commons/branding.go` (per-flavor Branding factory), `commons/trace.go` (TraceContext propagation), `commons/uuidv7.go` (UUIDv7 generator).

11.1 Telegram

- **SDK:** `gopkg.in/telebot.v3` (tucnak/telebot) primary; `github.com/mymmrac/telego` alt for 1:1 Bot API fidelity.
- **V1 (MVP) features:**
 - `sendMessage` with `MarkdownV2` parse mode.
 - `sendPhoto` / `sendDocument` for attachments.
 - `InlineKeyboardMarkup` with URL buttons + `callback_data`.
- **V2 advanced:**
 - `callback_query` handler (interactive replies).
 - `editMessageText` (in-place updates for ongoing incidents).
 - `web_app` buttons (open Mini-Apps).
 - `sendMediaGroup` (galleries).
 - Forum-topic threads via `message_thread_id`.
- **Out-of-scope (V2):** full Mini-App SDK, payments, Telegram Passport.
- **Delivery evidence ceiling:** Routed via Bot API; Read only via Business Bot connection with `can_read_messages` right (separate setup).
- **Webhook secret:** `setWebhook?secret_token=<token>`; verify `X-Telegram-Bot-API-Secret-Token` header on inbound.

11.2 Max (max.ru)

- **SDK:** `github.com/max-messenger/max-bot-api-client-go` (official-adjacent, Apache-2.0, English+Russian docs).
- **Gating:** behind build tag `herald_max` and documented sanctions advisory in the operator manual. VK Group parent VK Company Limited is not on the OFAC SDN list at time of writing, but several VK-affiliated individuals are designated and EU restrictive measures evolve frequently — operators must check at deploy time.
- **Bot registration:** via in-app MasterBot.
- **V1:** send text message, send media; basic inline keyboard.
- **V2 advanced:** per `dev.max.ru` docs as they expand.
- **Delivery evidence ceiling:** Routed (API ack = stored & queued).

11.3 Slack

- **SDK:** `github.com/slack-go/slack` (pin $\geq$ v0.23.1 — GHSA-gxhx-2686-5h9g fixed empty-secret bypass).

- **V1:**
 - `chat.postMessage` with Block Kit header + section + divider + image + actions (URL buttons only).
 - Threading via `thread_ts` (R-08 mapping).
- **V2 advanced:**
 - `block_actions` callback handler (interactivity).
 - `views.open` modals.
 - Message shortcuts.
 - Socket Mode for daemon ingress.
- **Out-of-scope:** Workflow Builder steps, Slack Connect, Enterprise Grid management.
- **Delivery evidence ceiling:** Routed (`ok:true` + `ts` proves posted to channel; no per-user read event).
- **Signing:** HMAC-SHA256 verification using `slack.NewSecretsVerifier` over `v0:{X-Slack-Request-Timestamp}:{rawBody}`, comparing with `X-Slack-Signature`, 5-min replay window.

11.4 Discord

- **SDK:** github.com/bwmarrin/discordgo (~5.7k stars, BSD-3-Clause, stable).
- **V1:**
 - Incoming Webhook with embeds (title, description, fields, footer, thumbnail, color).
 - Threads via webhook + `?thread_id=`.
- **V2 advanced:**
 - Bot token; components (buttons + select menus).
 - Slash commands.
 - Forum channels.
- **Out-of-scope:** modals, voice, stage channels.
- **Delivery evidence ceiling:** Routed.

11.5 Microsoft Teams

- **SDK:** github.com/atc0005/go-teams-notify/v2 (incoming-webhook-only — **no official Microsoft Go SDK** for full Graph access).
- **V1:**
 - Incoming Webhook with Adaptive Card v1.5: `TextBlock`, `Image`, `Container`, `FactSet`, `ActionSet` with `Action.OpenUrl`.
- **V2 advanced:**
 - `Action.Execute` / Actionable Messages with HMAC-signed tokens.
 - Bot Framework via Azure Bot Service (separate setup, complex).
- **Out-of-scope:** full Bot Framework conversational state, meeting extensions.
- **Delivery evidence ceiling:** Routed.

11.6 Lark / Feishu

- **SDK:** github.com/larksuite/oapi-sdk-go (**official**, MIT, code-gen flavor — verbose but accurate).
- **V1:** send text + rich message + image; basic interactive cards.
- **V2 advanced:** Mini-program cards, chatbot @-mentions, group management.
- **Delivery evidence ceiling:** Routed.

11.7 WhatsApp

Two transports for two use cases:

- **WhatsApp Web multi-device** — `go.mau.fi/whatsmeow` (`tulir/whatsmeow`, ~5.5k stars, MPL-2.0). Reverse-engineered WA Web; **not** for official Business API.
- **WhatsApp Business Cloud API** — `github.com/twilio/twilio-go` (official, multi-product; WA via Twilio Senders).
- **V1**: text + media via either transport; template-message support on Business Cloud API.
- **V2 advanced**: button-template messages, list messages, conversation pricing windows.

11.8 Viber

- **No official Go SDK**. Community: `mileusna/viber`, `strongo/bots-api-viber`.
- **V1**: hand-rolled REST client against the documented Viber REST API. Send text + media + carousel.
- **V2 advanced**: rich-media keyboards.

11.9 Email (deep)

The most operationally complex channel — Email gets the deepest treatment.

Two interchangeable transports behind one Channel interface:

1. **Raw SMTP + DKIM** — `net/smtp` (stdlib) + `github.com/emersion/go-msgauth/dkim`. Suitable for self-hosted operators.
2. **ESP HTTP API** — Resend (preferred), Postmark (fallback), SendGrid (alternative). Better deliverability + built-in bounce/complaint webhooks + suppression lists.

Mandatory features for every outbound email (V1):

- **DKIM signing** (RFC 6376) via `go-msgauth/dkim`.
- **List-Unsubscribe** (RFC 8058) — `List-Unsubscribe: <https://...>`, `<mailto:...>` + `List-Unsubscribe-Post: List-Unsubscribe=One-Click`. DKIM-signed.
- **Plain-text alternative** generated from the HTML body (MJML-rendered).
- **Inline images** via `Content-ID`: MIME parts (`cid:` references in HTML).
- **Suppression list lookup** — consult `email_suppressions` table before send; skip suppressed addresses and log to diary.

Bounce pipeline:

- Inbound mailbox parsed for RFC 3464 DSN parts, OR ESP webhook consumed for bounce/complaint/unsub events.
- Hard bounces, complaints, and manual unsubscriptions write to `email_suppressions`:

```

CREATE TABLE email_suppressions (
  tenant_id    UUID NOT NULL,
  address      TEXT NOT NULL,           -- normalized lowercase
  reason       TEXT NOT NULL,         -- 'hard_bounce' |
                                     'complaint' | 'unsubscribe'
  source_event UUID,
  created_at   TIMESTAMPTZ NOT NULL DEFAULT now(),
  PRIMARY KEY (tenant_id, address)
);
ALTER TABLE email_suppressions ENABLE ROW LEVEL SECURITY;
ALTER TABLE email_suppressions FORCE ROW LEVEL SECURITY;

```

Doctor command: <flavor>herald doctor email verifies SPF, DKIM, DMARC records for the configured sending domain at startup. Without correct DNS, Gmail/Yahoo's 2024 sender requirements quietly bin the mail.

Templating: MJML (<mj-section>, <mj-column>, <mj-image>, <mj-button>) compiled to inline-CSS HTML at **template-author time** (vendored MJML CLI; check in the compiled HTML alongside the .mjml source). The compiled HTML then runs through html/template for variable substitution at send time. No Node.js in the runtime container.

Delivery evidence ceiling: Accepted by default (relay 250 OK), upgradable to Delivered by parsing DSN, Read only when recipient voluntarily returns RFC 8098 MDN (rare).

11.10 ntfy / Gotify

Per research Topic 3 (notification-platforms): adopt ntfy's wire model as both an **inbound ingest format** (alongside CloudEvents) and as a first-class outbound channel.

- Map: X-Priority (1–5) → Herald priority enum; X-Tags → Herald tags; X-Click → action URL; X-Actions (view/http/broadcast/copy) → Herald Action schema; X-Attach/PUT body → attachment.
- **Gotify** application/client token split: application token authenticates publishers; client token authenticates subscribers; both revocable independently.
- **V1:** send to ntfy/gotify topic with priority + tags + attachment.
- **V2 advanced:** receive via WebSocket / SSE for live updates.

11.11 Generic outbound webhook

Adapter webhook: `//<url>?secret=<hmac>&format=<cloudevent|json|form>:`

- Sends Herald events as CloudEvents (binary or structured mode), or as plain JSON, or as form-encoded — chosen by query param.
- HMAC-signs outbound requests (Webhook-Signature header) so receiving side can verify.
- Retries per §5.4.

11.12 Diary (Markdown + PDF + HTML)

See §19 for full schema and sync strategy.

11.13 Feature matrix summary

Channel	Text	Markdown	Attachments	Threads	Interactive buttons	Signed-source verify
Telegram	✓	MarkdownV2 / HTML	✓	forum topic_id	✓ V1 url, V2 callback	secret_tok
Max	✓	platform-specific	✓	V2	V2	tba
Slack	✓	Block Kit	✓	thread_ts	✓ V1 url, V2 callback	X-Slack-Signature
Discord	✓	embeds	✓	thread_id	webhook url, bot components	webhook URL secrecy
MS Teams	✓	Adaptive Card	inline	conv references	OpenUrl / Action.Execute	webhook secret
Lark	✓	rich card	✓	V2	interactive card	event subscription
WhatsApp	✓	text/template	✓ (Cloud API)	conversation window	Cloud API templates	Twilio signing / Meta token
Viber	✓	rich-media	✓	—	rich-media keyboard	sig param
Email	✓	MJML→HTML	✓ (MIME)	In-Reply-To/References	url buttons only	DKIM/SPDMARC
ntfy	✓	X-Markdown	✓	—	X-Actions	basic auth token
Gotify	✓	extras.client::display	✓	—	extras actions	bearer token
Webhook	✓	CloudEvent JSON	embedded	n/a	n/a	HMAC
Diary	✓	source format	path-refs	logical via parent ref	n/a	local FS
null://	✓	✓	✓ (counted only)	✓	✓ (recorded)	n/a

11.14 null:// sandbox channel (test-only)

The null:// adapter is the in-process equivalent of /dev/null with full instrumentation. It implements the entire Channel interface but performs no I/O — every Send call records the OutboundMessage to an in-memory ring buffer (configurable size; default 1000), increments per-tag counters, and returns the configured DeliveryEvidence ceiling.

Use cases:

- **Unit tests** for commons_messaging routing: assert that a given event with a given preference set produces the expected fan-out without touching any real channel.

- **Load tests:** route traffic through `null://` to measure router/queue throughput without hitting upstream rate limits.
- **Quickstart / training:** operators can send test events to confirm routing logic before adding real channel credentials.
- **Chaos testing:** configure `null://` to return error for X% of sends to exercise retry / dead-letter paths.

URL grammar:

```
null://[?
seed=<int>&fail_rate=<0..1>&latency_ms=<int>&ceiling=<Accepted|
Routed|Delivered|Read>&tags=<csv>]
```

Examples:

- `null:///tags=test` — happy path, instant, returns Routed.
- `null:///fail_rate=0.1&tags=chaos` — 10% of sends return transient error (exercises retry).
- `null:///latency_ms=500&ceiling=Delivered&tags=load` — adds 500 ms artificial latency, claims Delivered ceiling.

Inspector API (test-only HTTP endpoint, mounted when `[testing].null_inspector=true`):

Method	Path	Purpose
GET	<code>/admin/null/messages</code>	Recent ring-buffer contents (last N OutboundMessages).
GET	<code>/admin/null/stats</code>	Per-tag counters + send/fail tally.
POST	<code>/admin/null/clear</code>	Empty the ring buffer + reset stats.
POST	<code>/admin/null/inject</code>	Inject a synthetic inbound message (test the inbound path without a real subscriber).

`null://` MUST NOT be enabled in production deployments — the operator gate `CM-NUL-CHANNEL-DISABLED-IN-PROD` (planned) verifies that `null://` is absent from `channel_addresses` when `[herald].environment=production`. Operators that need null behaviour in prod (e.g., feature-flagged channels) use the `[channel_address].enabled=false` toggle instead.

Channel adapter test fixtures pattern. Every `commons_messaging/channels/<name>/` package SHOULD ship:

- `testdata/` — recorded HTTP request/response pairs (go-vcr-compatible cassettes).
- `<name>_test.go` — unit tests against `testdata/` (no network).
- `<name>_integration_test.go` (build tag `integration`) — runs against the channel's sandbox/test mode (Telegram test bot, Slack workspace T0000 test team, etc.).
- `<name>_e2e_test.go` (build tag `e2e`) — only runs in nightly CI against real credentials in a dedicated test tenant.

§12. Messaging flows

Three mandatory message flows per channel (where the channel API supports them):

- **Simple message** — textual content sent to the channel; displayed to all subscribers.
- **Message with attachment(s)** — content + 1..N attachments; subscribers can download attachments.
- **Quote / reply message** — content sent as a reply to an existing channel message (uses §11 thread mapping: Telegram `reply_to_message_id`, Slack `thread_ts`, Discord `thread_id`, Email In-Reply-To); may include 0..N attachments.

Subscriber inbound flows (Project Herald and any flavor that opts into reply processing):

- **Direct reply to a Herald message** — parsed for commands (Bug:, Issue:, Query:, Request:, Question:).
- **Standalone message tagged for Herald** — same parsing, no parent message.
- **Thread continuation** — full thread context (chained replies from start) is parsed and processed.

Conversation reference per R-08:

```
type ConversationRef struct {
    Channel      ChannelID // "tgram", "slack", ...
    ThreadID     string      // Slack thread_ts; Telegram
                  message_thread_id (forum); Email References[0]
    ParentMessageID string    // Slack ts; Telegram
                  reply_to_message_id; Email In-Reply-To
    RootMessageID string      // first message in the thread
}
```

Persisted in the `thread_refs` table so re-sends to the same logical thread find the right native handle on every channel:

```
CREATE TABLE thread_refs (
    tenant_id          UUID NOT NULL,
    logical_thread_id  UUID NOT NULL,
    -- Herald's stable identifier across channels
    channel            TEXT NOT NULL,
    -- "tgram", "slack", "email", ...
    thread_id          TEXT,
    -- Slack
    thread_ts, Telegram message_thread_id (forum), Email
    References[0]
    parent_message_id TEXT,
    -- Slack ts (parent), Telegram reply_to_message_id, Email
    In-Reply-To
    root_message_id    TEXT,
    -- first
    message in the thread
    last_activity_at   TIMESTAMPTZ NOT NULL DEFAULT now(),
    PRIMARY KEY (tenant_id, logical_thread_id, channel)
);
```

```
CREATE INDEX thread_refs_recent_idx ON thread_refs (tenant_id,
    last_activity_at DESC);
ALTER TABLE thread_refs ENABLE ROW LEVEL SECURITY;
ALTER TABLE thread_refs FORCE ROW LEVEL SECURITY;
CREATE POLICY tr_isolation ON thread_refs
    USING (tenant_id = current_setting('app.tenant_id')::uuid)
    WITH CHECK (tenant_id =
        current_setting('app.tenant_id')::uuid);
```

A *logical thread* is Herald's tenant-stable conversation identifier; the per-channel rows map it to native handles. `last_activity_at` enables time-window garbage collection (default: 90 days after last activity, configurable).

§13. Templating & message composition

Three-layer stack per research Topic 5 (notification-platforms):

- **Layer 0 (engine)** — Go stdlib text/template (plaintext / Markdown / JSON channels) and html/template (HTML email body, auto-escaping).
- **Layer 1 (helpers)** — Sprig (date, upper, default, trunc, etc.) — universally expected by template authors; used by Helm, kubectl templates.
- **Layer 2 (email-specific)** — MJML compiled to HTML at template-author time (vendored MJML CLI; check in the compiled `.html` alongside `.mjml`), then `html/template` for runtime substitution.

Rejected: Liquid (extra runtime, no Go stdlib affinity); runtime MJML compilation (Node dependency in Go hot path).

Template directory layout:

```
commons_messaging/templates/
├── ci.failed/
│   ├── tgram.md.tmpl
│   ├── slack.json.tmpl      # Block Kit JSON
│   ├── email.mjml          # source
│   ├── email.html          # compiled, committed
│   └── diary.md.tmpl
├── deploy.succeeded/
│   └── ...
├── _shared/                 # template helpers
│   └── footer.tmpl
```

§14. Localization (i18n)

Per research Topic 6 (notification-platforms): **nicksnyder/go-i18n v2**.

- One `Bundle` loaded at process start from `commons_messaging/locales/*.toml`:

```
# locales/active.en-US.toml
[ci.failed.title]
other = "Build failed: {{.JobName}}"
```

```
# locales/active.sr-Latn-RS.toml
[ci.failed.title]
other = "Build pao: {{.JobName}}"
```

- Plurals handled via CLDR rules (built-in to go-i18n):
1 alert / 2 alerta / 5 alerti / 21 alert for Serbian works correctly without custom code.
- Per-subscriber locale (BCP-47 tag) stored on the subscribers row.
- Per-channel templates may override (Telegram emoji-heavy variant vs sober email variant).

V2 initial locales: en-US, sr-Latn-RS, ru-RU. RTL rendering tweaks and dynamic locale negotiation from incoming events are deferred.

§15. Security model

Per R-16: a **three-layer pipeline** runs *before* any routing logic.

15.1 Transport-level (channel signature verification)

Per-channel signature verifier (constant-time HMAC comparison via `crypto/hmac.Equal`):

Channel	Header	Algorithm	Replay window
Slack	X-Slack-Signature	HMAC-SHA256 over <code>v0:{ts}:{body}</code>	5 min
GitHub-style	X-Hub-Signature-256	HMAC-SHA256 over body	configurable
Telegram	X-Telegram-Bot-API-Secret-Token	shared-secret compare	n/a (no timestamp)
Stripe	Stripe-Signature	HMAC-SHA256 over <code>{ts}.{body}</code>	5 min
Email	DKIM-Signature header + DMARC alignment	RSA-SHA256 / Ed25519	per DKIM TTL

Generic webhook sources register their own per-source secret in `webhook_sources`.

15.2 Sender-level (allowlist + verified subscribers)

After transport verification, sender authority is checked:

- Per-channel allowlist keyed by canonical user-id (Slack team_id+user_id, Telegram chat_id, email DKIM-aligned From) loaded from `.herald/subscribers.toml` and/or the `subscribers` + `subscriber_aliases` tables.
- Unknown senders enter a **quarantine queue** (`quarantined_messages` table), never the live fan-out.
- An operator (or auto-policy) reviews the quarantine and either promotes the sender or discards.

quarantined_messages schema:

```
CREATE TABLE quarantined_messages (  
  id                UUID PRIMARY KEY DEFAULT uuidv7(),  
  tenant_id         UUID NOT NULL,  
  received_at       TIMESTAMPTZ NOT NULL DEFAULT now(),  
  channel           TEXT NOT NULL,  
  sender_channel_user_id TEXT NOT NULL,  
  sender_display    TEXT,  
  reason            TEXT NOT NULL,           --  
                  'unknown_sender' | 'unverified_signature' | 'rate_limited'  
                  | 'content_flagged'  
  payload_jsonb     JSONB NOT NULL,         -- full  
                  inbound message  
  triage_status     TEXT NOT NULL DEFAULT 'pending', -- 'pending'  
                  | 'promoted' | 'discarded' | 'expired'  
  triaged_at        TIMESTAMPTZ,  
  triaged_by        UUID  
                  -- subscriber id of operator  
);  
CREATE INDEX qm_pending_idx ON quarantined_messages (tenant_id,  
  received_at DESC)  
  WHERE triage_status = 'pending';  
ALTER TABLE quarantined_messages ENABLE ROW LEVEL SECURITY;  
ALTER TABLE quarantined_messages FORCE ROW LEVEL SECURITY;  
CREATE POLICY qm_isolation ON quarantined_messages  
  USING (tenant_id = current_setting('app.tenant_id')::uuid)  
  WITH CHECK (tenant_id =  
    current_setting('app.tenant_id')::uuid);
```

Pending entries auto-expire after 30 days (`triage_status='expired'`) so the queue doesn't grow unbounded on a noisy channel. CLI: `<flavor>herald quarantine [list | promote <id> | discard <id> | purge]`.

15.3 Content-level (parsing & sanitization)

After sender verification, content is parsed:

- Commands (`Bug:`, `Issue:`, `Query:`, `Request:`, `Question:`, plus flavor-specific verbs) parsed with a strict regex-anchored tokenizer.
- **Never** shell out with user-provided content.
- **Never** text/template user input into shell or SQL.

- Command bodies are length-bounded (default 8 KiB).
- Attachments are scanned for MIME mismatch + size limits (default 25 MiB per attachment, 100 MiB per message).
- Optional malware scan via ClamAV when `commons_security` is configured with the integration.

15.4 Credential handling

Per Constitution §11.4.10:

- `.env` is git-ignored (the `.gitignore` MUST contain `.env`).
- `.env.example` is committed.
- Resolution order: CLI flag > shell env > `.env` > compiled default (§3.3).
- Credentials NEVER logged. The OTel logger has a redaction middleware that filters keys matching `(?i)(token|secret|password|key|credential|authorization)` to `***`.
- Credentials in Postgres are encrypted-at-rest with `pgcrypto` (`pgp_sym_encrypt`) using a key from `HERALD_DB_ENC_KEY` env var.

15.5 Webhook ingestion (defense-in-depth)

See §5.5. Four ordered checks: signature → timestamp → delivery-ID dedup → optional IP allowlist.

§16. Multi-tenancy & isolation

Per research Topic 6 (event-fanout) + Topic 4 (operations):

- **Primary boundary:** PostgreSQL Row-Level Security.
- **Every business table** carries `tenant_id` `UUID NOT NULL` with a composite index `(tenant_id, ...)` leading every secondary index (RLS is 10–100× slower without it).
- **Policy template:**

```
ALTER TABLE <table> ENABLE ROW LEVEL SECURITY;
ALTER TABLE <table> FORCE ROW LEVEL SECURITY;
CREATE POLICY tenant_isolation ON <table>
    USING (tenant_id = current_setting('app.tenant_id')::uuid)
    WITH CHECK (tenant_id =
        current_setting('app.tenant_id')::uuid);
```

- **Roles:**
 - `herald_app` — runtime role, no `BYPASSRLS`. The `pgx` connection wrapper in `commons_storage` runs `SET LOCAL app.tenant_id = ...` at transaction start.
 - `herald_migrator` — schema-change role, `BYPASSRLS`.
- **Redis** — per-tenant ACL user (Redis 6+), key pattern `~t:<tenant_id>:*`.
- **Rate limits** — token bucket per `(tenant_id, channel)` in Redis.
- **Schema-per-tenant** is reserved for high-isolation enterprise customers; documented as opt-in but not the default (overhead: connection-pool fragmentation, slow migrations $N \times M$, harder backups).

16.1 Data retention & privacy

Herald processes content that may contain personally identifiable information (names, email addresses, IP addresses, organization data). Retention windows **MUST** be configurable per tenant and enforced by scheduled River jobs.

Default retention policy (overridable per tenant):

Class	Default retention	Purge mechanism
idempotency_keys	7 d after expires_at (already in §4.3)	nightly River job
dead_letters (triaged)	90 d	nightly River job
dead_letters (untriaged)	365 d (legal/audit floor)	manual triage prompt
quarantined_messages (pending)	30 d → auto expired	nightly River job
quarantined_messages (triaged)	90 d	nightly River job
thread_refs	90 d after last_activity_at	nightly River job
email_suppressions	indefinite (compliance — hard bounces must persist)	manual remove via CLI
subscribers (deleted)	tombstone 30 d, then hard delete	GDPR right-to-erasure flow
Diary entries (docs/herald/ diary/main.md)	tenant-configurable; default unlimited (git history)	per-tenant rotation policy
OpenTelemetry data	controlled by Collector → backend (out of Herald scope)	n/a

GDPR / privacy mechanics:

- `<flavor>herald subscriber forget <id>` initiates right-to-erasure: tombstones the row, schedules hard-delete after 30 days, anonymises subscriber references in `dead_letters` / `quarantined_messages` / diary entries (replaces `display_name` with `<redacted>`, hashes `channel_user_id`).
- `<flavor>herald subscriber export <id>` (right-to-portability) emits a JSON bundle of every record referencing the subscriber.
- **Diary redaction** — when a subscriber is forgotten, the diary writer **SHOULD** overwrite their entries with a redaction note (in-place edit + re-export); operators that want immutable audit trails **MUST** opt-out per `[privacy].diary_redaction_on_forget = false`.

Data sovereignty: the containers submodule deploys Postgres + Redis to operator-chosen regions; Herald itself stores nothing outside that pair. Cross-region replication is the operator's choice (logical replication / streaming replication) and is documented in `docs/operations/replication.md`.

§17. Observability & SLOs

Per research Topic 1 (operations):

17.1 OpenTelemetry pipeline

- **All three signals** instrumented from day one:
 - **Traces** — `go.opentelemetry.io/otel/trace` spans across the full event flow (ingest → route → enqueue → deliver → ack).
 - **Metrics** — `go.opentelemetry.io/otel/metric` counters + histograms.
 - **Logs** — `stdlib slog` shipped as OTel log records via `go.opentelemetry.io/contrib/bridges/otelslog`.
- **Default export:** OTLP/gRPC to an OpenTelemetry Collector sidecar/`DaemonSet` on `localhost:4317` (no auth) — production deployments override via env vars.
- **Collector** fans out to Prometheus (scrape `/metrics`), Tempo/Jaeger (traces), Loki (logs).
- Instrumentation lives in `commons_observability` (L1) so every flavor inherits.

Standard OTel SDK env vars Herald honours (per OpenTelemetry SDK spec — values are NOT re-invented):

Variable	Default	Purpose
<code>OTEL_SDK_DISABLED</code>	<code>false</code>	Hard kill switch — when <code>true</code> , instrumentation is no-op.
<code>OTEL_EXPORTER_OTLP_ENDPOINT</code>	<code>http://localhost:4317</code>	Single endpoint for all signals (gRPC).
<code>OTEL_EXPORTER_OTLP_TRACES_ENDPOINT</code>	<code>inherits</code>	Per-signal override.
<code>OTEL_EXPORTER_OTLP_METRICS_ENDPOINT</code>	<code>inherits</code>	Per-signal override.
<code>OTEL_EXPORTER_OTLP_LOGS_ENDPOINT</code>	<code>inherits</code>	Per-signal override.
<code>OTEL_EXPORTER_OTLP_PROTOCOL</code>	<code>grpc</code>	<code>grpc</code> <code>http/protobuf</code> <code>http/json</code> .
<code>OTEL_EXPORTER_OTLP_HEADERS</code>	<code>unset</code>	Authn (e.g. <code>Authorization=Bearer ...</code>).
<code>OTEL_EXPORTER_OTLP_INSECURE</code>	<code>false</code>	Disable TLS for <code>http</code> endpoints.
<code>OTEL_RESOURCE_ATTRIBUTES</code>	(Herald sets <code>service.name</code> , <code>service.version</code> , <code>herald.flavor</code> , <code>herald.tenant_id</code>)	Operator adds <code>deployment.environment</code> , <code>service.namespace</code> , ...
<code>OTEL_SERVICE_NAME</code>	<code><flavor>herald</code>	Convenience equivalent to <code>service.name</code> .
<code>OTEL_TRACES_SAMPLER</code>	<code>parentbased_traceidratio</code>	Sampler choice.
<code>OTEL_TRACES_SAMPLER_ARG</code>	<code>1.0</code>	Ratio when sampler supports it.
<code>OTEL_METRIC_EXPORT_INTERVAL</code>	<code>60000</code> (ms)	Push cadence.

Variable	Default	Purpose
OTEL_BSP_SCHEDULE_DELAY	5000 (ms)	Batch-span-processor c

Herald's own resource defaults:

```
service.name=<flavor>herald
service.version=<git-tag-or-commit-sha>
service.instance.id=<hostname>--<pid>
herald.flavor=<flavor>
herald.tenant_id=<tenant_uuid>          # one-of label, set per
request
telemetry.sdk.name=opentelemetry
telemetry.sdk.language=go
```

OTel semantic conventions tracked: **messaging v1.30+** (the spec moved out of experimental in 2025).

17.2 Metrics catalogue

OTel semantic conventions for messaging where they fit, Herald-specific names where they don't:

Metric	Type	Labels
messaging.client.sent.messages	counter	messaging.system="herald", messaging.destination.name=<ch herald.tenant_id, herald.flavor
messaging.client.operation.duration	histogram	+ messaging.operation.name="de messaging.operation.type="send
herald_delivery_attempts_total	counter	channel, outcome={ok, retry, drop, dead_le tenant_id
herald_queue_depth	gauge	queue, tenant_id
herald_retry_backoff_seconds	histogram	channel, attempt_bucket
herald_template_render_duration_seconds	histogram	template_id
herald_subscriber_count	gauge	tenant_id, channel
herald_dead_letter_count	gauge	tenant_id, channel

Cardinality budget: never recipient_id or message UUIDs as labels. Per-tenant labels are allowed; per-subscriber labels are NOT.

Canonical Grafana dashboard JSON shipped in deploy/grafana/herald-overview.json.

17.3 Span model

Canonical span names (and parent→child relationship):

```
herald.ingest          (root, per inbound CloudEvent)
└─ herald.signature_verify
```

```

└─ herald.idempotency_check
└─ herald.route_match
└─ herald.preference_filter
└─ herald.template_render
└─ herald.enqueue
└─ herald.deliver
    └─ herald.channel.<name>
        └─ herald.channel.<name>.api_call
└─ herald.diary_append

```

Attributes on every span: `herald.tenant_id`, `herald.flavor`, `cloudevents.type`, `cloudevents.id`.

17.4 SLOs

V2 published SLOs (per-tenant rolling 30-day):

SLO	Target
Ingress availability (HTTP 2xx + 4xx vs 5xx)	99.9%
End-to-end delivery (ingest → channel API Accepted) — p95	< 5 s
End-to-end delivery — p99	< 30 s
Delivery success rate (excluding 4xx from upstream channels)	99.5%
Dead-letter rate	< 0.1%
Doctor-CLI checks (SPF/DKIM/DMARC, DB ping, Redis ping)	run every 5 min, alert on 3 consecutive fail

17.4.1 Per-channel SLO budgets

The aggregate SLO table above can hide bad behaviour on one channel behind good behaviour on another. V2 also commits to **per-channel SLO budgets** — error budgets tracked independently so a single misbehaving adapter or upstream incident is visible immediately:

Channel	Delivery success target	p95 latency target (ingest → upstream accepted)	Notes
Telegram	99.5%	< 2 s	Telegram Bot API is famously reliable; alert if budget burn > 2× expected.
Slack	99.5%	< 3 s	<code>chat.postMessage</code> rate-limited per workspace; back off cleanly.
Discord	99.0%	< 3 s	Webhook rate limits are aggressive; expect retries.
MS Teams	98.0%	< 5 s	Incoming-webhook backend has visible jitter.

Channel	Delivery success target	p95 latency target (ingest → upstream accepted)	Notes
Lark	99.0%	< 4 s	
Max	99.0%	< 4 s	Subject to network reachability from non-RU operator regions.
Email (SMTP self-hosted)	95.0%	< 30 s	Includes DNS + greylist + tarpit latency.
Email (ESP — Resend/Postmark/SendGrid)	99.5%	< 5 s	ESP carries the deliverability risk; Herald sees Accepted quickly.
WhatsApp (Cloud API)	99.0%	< 3 s	Conversation-window restrictions can drop messages outside 24h windows.
Viber	98.0%	< 5 s	Hand-rolled REST client; expect rougher edges.
ntfy / Gotify	99.5%	< 2 s	Self-hosted = operator's own infra.
Webhook (generic outbound)	depends on operator's endpoint	< operator's deadline	Tracked but no Herald-side target.
Diary	99.99%	< 100 ms	Local file system + Pandoc batching; outliers indicate disk pressure.

Per-channel burn-rate alerts (multi-window, multi-burn-rate per Google SRE Workbook): page on **2-hour 14× burn** AND **6-hour 6× burn** simultaneously crossed; warn on either alone. Alerts route through the same Herald pipeline that any other event uses — Herald-monitoring-Herald MUST work, but operators are advised to also run a separate stand-by notifier for the case where Herald itself is the failure.

17.5 Health probes (livez / readyz / startupz)

Per research Topic 3 (operations): three endpoints on the **admin port** (24090 default, separate from data port so probes don't compete for worker capacity):

- **GET /livez** — returns **200** unless an unrecoverable internal invariant trips (deadlock detector, fatal goroutine panic flag). Cheap, no downstream calls.
- **GET /readyz** — checks Postgres + Redis ping, queue consumer attached, ≥ 1 channel adapter healthy. Returns **503** during graceful shutdown.
- **GET /startupz** — used by Kubernetes startup probe while migrations / warm-up run; once **200**, liveness/readiness take over.

Liveness failureThreshold $\sim 3\times$ readiness so a transient downstream blip removes the pod from Service but does NOT restart it.

17.6 doctor CLI

<flavor>herald doctor runs a battery of environment checks:

- Postgres connectivity + RLS policy presence.
- Redis connectivity + ACL.
- All configured channel credentials valid (probes API per channel).
- DKIM/SPF/DMARC DNS records for the configured sending domain (cite Gmail/Yahoo 2024 sender requirements).
- OTLP collector reachable.
- Disk space, port availability.

Exits with non-zero status code on any failure + writes a structured report to stdout (machine-readable JSON option `--j son`).

§18. Flavors (the implementations)

18.1 Common flavor contract

Every flavor binary MUST:

- Be named <prefix>herald and built from <prefix>herald/cmd/ <prefix>herald/main.go.
- Implement the same Cobra-subcommand surface (send, serve, doctor, migrate, deadletter, subscriber, digest, version).
- Embed commons + commons_messaging + commons_storage + commons_security + commons_observability + commons_diary at the same pinned versions.
- Publish a flavor-specific event-type subtree (digital.vasic.herald.<flavor>.*).
- Register flavor-specific subscriber commands (the Bug: / Query: / etc. tokens that map to flavor-specific handlers).
- Provide a flavor-specific HeraldBranding (app name, icon, accent color).
- Ship its own user manual under docs/flavors/<flavor>/.

18.1.1 Common channel-interaction primitives (cross-flavor)

Every flavor inherits these interaction primitives from commons_messaging so subscribers learn one mental model and apply it across channels and flavors. Per-flavor extensions are documented in each flavor's "Channel interactions" sub-section.

Slash / prefix commands — available on every channel that supports them, with text-prefix fallback for channels that don't:

Token	Behaviour	Slack/ Discord native	Text-prefix fallback
/help		slash command	Help: prefix

Token	Behaviour	Slack/ Discord native	Text-prefix fallback
	List the flavor's command palette + quick-action buttons		
/status	Snapshot of current state (open items, queue depth, channel health)	slash command	Status: prefix
/whoami	Echo the subscriber's resolved identity, roles, locale, prefs	slash command	Whoami: prefix
/silence <duration>	Mute notifications for the calling subscriber for the given duration	slash command	Silence: <duration> prefix
/unsilence	Cancel a silence	slash command	Unsilence: prefix
/subscribe <category>	Opt the calling subscriber into a category	slash command	Subscribe: <category> prefix
/unsubscribe <category>	Opt out	slash command	Unsubscribe: <category> prefix
/prefs	Open a modal/form to edit PreferenceSet (channels supporting modals); otherwise return current prefs as JSON	slash command + modal	Prefs: prefix returns JSON only

Reaction-based quick ops — for channels that support emoji reactions (Slack, Discord, Telegram, Lark). Adding a reaction to a Herald message triggers the action; removing the reaction undoes it where the action is reversible.

Emoji	Action	Reversible	Required role
 / 	Ack (acknowledge — silences re-fires for the alert fingerprint for the default window)	yes	reader+
	Silence for the configured default duration ([interactions].default_silence, default 1 h)	yes	reader+
	Resolve (closes the workable item or marks the alert resolved)	no	operator
	Escalate (bumps criticality up one level and re-pages)	no	operator
	Reopen (only on resolved items)	no	operator
	Reclassify as bug	yes	operator
	Reclassify as task	yes	operator
	Reclassify as query	yes	operator

Emoji	Action	Reversible	Required role
	Mark as spam → moves to <code>quarantined_messages</code> for operator review	yes	operator

Reactions emit `digital.vasic.herald.reply.reaction_applied` CloudEvents so the diary + audit trail capture every interaction.

Interactive button actions — for channels that support clickable buttons (Slack Block Kit actions, Discord components, Telegram inline keyboards with `callback_data`, Teams Adaptive Card Action.`OpenUrl` / `Action.Execute`). Herald renders a per-flavor button palette on every "actionable" message; clicks call back through the channel's webhook to Herald's `/v1/interactions/<channel>` endpoint.

Modal forms — for Slack (`views.open`) and Discord (modal interactions), Herald can request structured input (e.g., "what's the reproduction steps for HRD-042?") instead of free-form chat. Falls back to a multi-message conversation on channels without modal support.

Thread / forum-topic affinity — incident-style flavors (`iherald`, `aherald`) pin all related messages to one thread / Telegram forum topic / Slack thread / Discord forum-channel post, so the conversation is self-contained for postmortem readers. Composes with §12 `ConversationRef` + §35 versioned reports.

Capability degradation — if a channel doesn't support a primitive, Herald MUST degrade gracefully (text instructions instead of buttons, etc.) — never silently drop the interaction. The §11.0 `Capabilities` struct declares per-channel support; the router consults it before rendering.

18.2 Project Herald (`pherald`)

Focus: Software-project development lifecycle. Integrates with VCS, code review, task tracking. Designed for AI-CLI-agent + developer-team workflows.

Event subtree: `digital.vasic.herald.project.*` and `digital.vasic.herald.reply.*`.

Sources:

- Git hooks (post-commit, post-merge, pre-push).
- VCS webhooks (GitHub, GitLab, GitFlic, GitVerse — `push`, `pull_request`, `review`, `issue`).
- AI CLI agents (Claude Code, OpenCode, Cursor, Aider) emitting structured progress events.
- Code-review-tool webhooks (CodeRabbit, Greptile, Sourcery).

Subscriber inbound commands (extends the V1 base set):

Command	Behaviour
Bug: / Issue:	Open an issue (writes to <code>docs/Issues.md</code> per Universal §11.4.12).

Command	Behaviour
Query: / Request: / Question:	Request information; routes to LLM-driven research workflow if configured.
Status:	Reply with current project status from docs/Status.md.
Continue:	Pointer to docs/CONTINUATION.md for next agent.
Done:	Mark referenced item resolved (writes to docs/Fixed.md).
Spec:	Cite or modify spec section (subject to §23 spec-change rule).
Run: <tool>	Authorized operator only — execute an approved tool (gated by allowlist).

Quote-thread processing: Subscriber's reply automatically includes the full thread context (chained replies from bottom to thread start) — full chain parsed and processed per R-08 ConversationRef.

Security validation (extends §15):

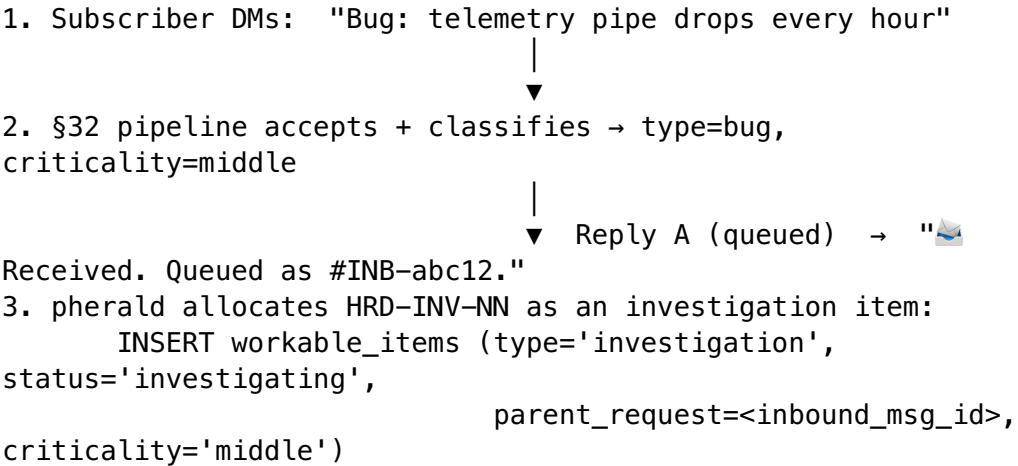
- Subscriber commands accepted only from verified, allowlisted subscribers.
- Run: requires elevated subscriber privilege (subscriber_aliases.verified_at plus roles array).
- All commands logged to diary with subscriber identity and timestamp.

Derived workable-item prefix (per §8.2): if the consuming project hasn't set one, the algorithm runs over the project name (from package.json, go.mod, pyproject.toml, or the git remote name).

18.2.1 Investigation-before-Fixing flow

When a subscriber reports a Bug: / Issue: / Implementation: request, pherald **MUST** first create an **Investigation workable item** (type investigation, status investigating) before committing to a final bug/task row. This guards against runaway LLM-generated workable items that turn out to be duplicates, out-of-scope, or non-reproducible.

The full sequence (composes §32 inbound pipeline + §33 LLM dispatch + §8.3 lifecycle):



Write row to docs/Issues.md with type='investigation'

↓
▼ Reply B (processing) → "🕒

Investigating as HRD-INV-007..."

4. §33 dispatcher invokes Claude Code with the §33.3 prompt envelope.

Claude Code analyzes:

- Reproduces locally? (where: <project> session, working dir)
- Identifies affected code paths.
- Classifies root-cause area.
- Estimates effort + dependencies.

Returns <<HERALD-REPLY>>> JSON.

↓
▼

5. pherald reads outcome:

- validated → allocate HRD-NNN final bug item, link parent_investigation=HRD-INV-007, close investigation as "validated", emit task.opened event, attach Claude's investigation summary as multi-format bundle (§36).
- needs_more_info → keep investigation open, ask subscriber follow-ups in Reply C.
- rejected (duplicate/out-of-scope/known) → close investigation with reason,

no final item,

Reply C explains.

- cannot reproduce → keep investigation open with "operator-blocked"

status per Universal §11.4.21, page
operator-on-call.

↓
▼ Reply C (final)
"✅ Created HRD-042 (bug,
" Investigation: HRD-INV-007
" Affected: pherald/internal/
" Repo: github.com/<org>/
[+ multi-format attachment

criticality=middle)."

(validated)."

telemetry.go:142"

<project>/blob/<sha>/Issues.md"

bundle per §36]

Persistence: every investigation has its own file under docs/Investigations/<HRD-INV-NNN>.md carrying the Claude-Code dispatch transcript + classification metadata + the validation decision. Composes with Universal §11.4.55 (Reopens-history) for the case where a previously-rejected investigation is reopened.

18.2.2 Criticality determination

Criticality is set in `inbound_messages.classification` by the §32.6 classifier and stored on the investigation + final workable items. Levels match Universal item-type vocabulary:

Level	Triggers	SLA replies	SLA investigation
critical	explicit critical: prefix, OR LLM keyword-confidence ≥ 0.85 on outage/data-loss/security-breach terms, OR sender has oncall role and message arrives during the configured incident window	Reply A ≤ 30 s, Reply B ≤ 2 min, Reply C ≤ 5 min	< 1 h
high	explicit high:, OR LLM 0.7–0.85	A ≤ 1 min, B ≤ 5 min, C ≤ 30 min	< 4 h
middle	default for bug/issue/task	A ≤ 5 s, B ≤ 5 min, C ≤ 2 h	< 24 h
low	explicit low: or nice-to-have:	A ≤ 5 s, B ≤ 30 min, C ≤ 24 h	< 1 week

Operators MAY override mid-flight: Override: HRD-042
`criticality=critical` re-dispatches to LLM with the new SLA and re-pages affected oncall tags.

18.2.3 Type classification (Universal §11.4.16 mapping)

Inbound type tokens map to Universal §11.4.16 item types one-to-one. The classifier emits the exact Universal vocabulary so downstream `Issues.md` rows pass §11.4.16-PARITY gate without translation. Full mapping in §32.6.

When an inbound is ambiguous (e.g., Hey, the build keeps failing — no prefix), the classifier:

1. Runs the deterministic keyword pass first (verbs like *fails*, *broken*, *crashed* → tentative bug).
2. If confidence < 0.7, escalates to LLM for type-only dispatch (§33.3 prompt envelope, `task=classify-only`).
3. If LLM confidence still < 0.7, replies **?** Could you tag this as Bug: / Issue: / Task: / Query: / ...? and stages the message as needs-classification (NOT processed further).

18.2.4 Attachment validation + storage

Subscriber-supplied attachments referenced by an inbound investigation/bug/task MUST follow this storage convention (mandatory, per the user's V3 requirement):

```
<consuming-project-root>/
└─ issues/
```

```

└─ users/
  └─ attachments/
    └─ HRD-042/                                ← WORKABLE_ITEM_ID
directory
    └─ 01_stack-trace.log                      ← original filename,
prefixed with arrival order
    └─ 02_screenshot.png
    └─ 03_repro-script.sh

```

Where HRD-042 is the canonical workable-item ID. For investigations the directory is named after the investigation ID (HRD-INV-007/); on transition to a final workable item, files are moved to the final ID's directory and HRD-INV-007/ becomes an empty placeholder kept for audit (Universal §11.4.55).

The investigation/bug Issues.md row carries a Attachments: column referencing the directory. Multi-format attachment generation (§36) does NOT apply to inbound user attachments — they are stored as-is in their original format. (§36 multi-format is for OUTBOUND attachments Herald itself produces.)

Pre-storage validation pipeline (per §32.4):

1. Each attachment downloaded into a sandbox directory (configurable; default /tmp/herald-staging/<random>/).
2. ClamAV scan (if configured) — quarantine on hit.
3. Magic-byte + MIME match — reject mismatched.
4. Extension allowlist — reject
.exe, .dll, .so, .dylib, .bat, .cmd, .ps1, .scr, .jar, .class by default.
5. Per-file size cap ([attachments].in_max_mib, default 25 MiB).
6. Per-message total cap ([attachments].in_total_max_mib, default 100 MiB).
7. If all pass → move to issues/users/attachments/<WORKABLE_ITEM_ID>/.
8. If any fail → record reason in quarantined_messages, do NOT move to canonical path, Reply C cites the validation error.

The attachments_index.md file inside each WORKABLE_ITEM_ID directory documents:

Attachments for HRD-042

Order	Filename	MIME	Size (B)	SHA-256	Uploaded by	Uploaded at	Notes
01	stack-trace.log	text/plain	12_348	<hex>			
	alice@tgram:42		2026-05-20T18:30:12Z				repro context
02	screenshot.png	image/png	348_551	<hex>			
	alice@tgram:42		2026-05-20T18:30:14Z				UI state
03	repro-script.sh	text/x-shellscript	1_204	<hex>			
	alice@tgram:42		2026-05-20T18:30:17Z				runs in 10 s

The index file IS the source of truth for "what's attached to this workable item" — Herald regenerates it on every attachment add/remove (per §11.4.61 freshness rules; if the index drifts from the directory contents, the §32 validator FAILs with attachment_index_drift).

18.2.5 Claude Code project-session integration

Per §33.2 the Claude Code session for the consuming project is anchored at `<consuming-project>/herald/claude-code/sessions/<project_name>.session`. For Project Herald specifically:

- The `[herald].project_name` config value (e.g. `ATMOSphere`) drives the anchor name.
- Each invocation runs `claude --resume <UUID> --print "<§33.3 envelope>"` with `cwd=<consuming-project-root>`.
- The session anchor is read-only to Herald; manual deletion resets the session (operators MAY want this when Claude's context degrades — e.g. after a long-running incident produces a noisy session).
- The flavor binary refuses to start if `[herald].project_name` is empty (Claude Code dispatch is non-optional in V3 r1).

18.2.6 Channel interactions

In addition to the §18.1.1 cross-flavor primitives, `pheraId` ships these flavor-specific interactive surfaces:

Surface	Channels	What it does
<code>/investigate <HRD-NNN> slash command</code>	Slack, Discord, Telegram	Re-runs the investigation phase for an existing item (useful after the subscriber adds more attachments to the thread).
<code>/promote <HRD-INV-NNN> slash command</code>	Slack, Discord	Operator-only — force-promotes an investigation to a final workable item without waiting for LLM validation.
<code>/reject <HRD-INV-NNN> <reason> slash command</code>	Slack, Discord	Operator-only — closes an investigation with a documented reason.
Investigation summary modal	Slack <code>views.open</code> , Discord modal	When a subscriber clicks "Add reproduction steps" on Reply B, opens a structured modal asking for: repro steps, expected vs actual, environment, attachments.
Investigation status buttons	Slack Block Kit actions, Telegram inline keyboard, Discord buttons	On Reply C of an investigation: [Validate] [Reject] [Need more info] [Reassign].
Workable-item card	All channels with rich messaging	A pinned card with workable item summary + criticality badge + assignee + status — refreshed via §35 versioned-report mechanic on every status change.

18.3 System Herald (sherald)

Focus: OS/host/service health and security. Designed for systems-administration teams + on-call rotation.

Event subtree: `digital.vasic.herald.system.*`.

Sources:

- `journalctl` watcher (configurable `_SYSTEMD_UNIT` filters).
- `auditd` events.
- Prometheus Alertmanager webhook receiver.
- Loki/Grafana log alerts.
- File-integrity-monitoring (AIDE, Tripwire) hooks.
- SNMP traps (via a small SNMP-to-CloudEvent adapter).
- Kernel events (oom-kill, panics) — via `journal` filter.

Event types:

- `digital.vasic.herald.system.host.cpu_high` (threshold-crossing).
- `digital.vasic.herald.system.host.disk_full` (filesystem).
- `digital.vasic.herald.system.host.memory_pressure`.
- `digital.vasic.herald.system.service.restarted`.
- `digital.vasic.herald.system.service.crashed`.
- `digital.vasic.herald.system.service.flapping` (≥ 3 restarts in 5min).
- `digital.vasic.herald.system.security.login_anomaly` (failed SSH burst, unusual IP).
- `digital.vasic.herald.system.security.privilege_escalation`.
- `digital.vasic.herald.system.cert.expiring` (X.509 certificate $\leq 30d$).
- `digital.vasic.herald.system.backup.missed`.

Subscriber commands:

- **Ack:** — acknowledge an alert (silences future fires of the same fingerprint for a window).
- **Silence:** `<fingerprint> for <duration>` — manual silencing.
- **Resolve:** `<fingerprint>` — manual resolution.
- **Status:** — current open-alerts snapshot.
- **Runbook:** `<fingerprint>` — link to the runbook for this alert type.

Integrations: sherald is often paired with `aherald` and `iherald` — the three flavors share the `commons_alert` package.

18.3.1 Channel interactions

Surface	Channels	What it does
Quick-action buttons on every alert	Slack, Discord, Telegram, Teams	[Ack] [Silence 1h] [Silence 24h] [Resolve] [Runbook] [Escalate]
 reaction	Slack, Discord, Telegram, Lark	One-tap silence for the alert's fingerprint for the default window (1h) — most-common-action wins the easiest UX.

Surface	Channels	What it does
/silence—similar slash command	Slack, Discord	Silences not just the current fingerprint but every alert sharing the same service label + severity.
/runbook <fingerprint> slash command	Slack, Discord, Telegram	Posts the runbook URL inline (saves operators from copy-pasting).
Service-health card	All rich channels	Per-service status card with last-N alerts, MTTR, current open count — refreshed via §35 versioned-report mechanic.
Slack views.open modal	Slack	Triggered by [Silence custom...] button — modal asks for duration + reason + scope (just fingerprint vs whole service).
Forum-topic per service	Telegram (forum group)	Each service gets its own forum topic; all alerts for that service land there → less noise in the main channel.

18.4 Build Herald (bherald)

Focus: CI/CD build lifecycle events. Designed for development teams + release engineers.

Event subtree: `digital.vasic.herald.ci.*`.

Sources:

- GitHub Actions workflow webhook (`workflow_run`, `check_suite`).
- GitLab CI webhook (Pipeline Hook).
- Jenkins post-build steps invoking `bherald send`.
- CircleCI / Drone / Buildkite via their respective webhooks.
- Tekton / Argo Workflows via CloudEvents emitters (native).

Event types:

- `digital.vasic.herald.ci.build.queued` | `started` | `succeeded` | `failed` | `cancelled`.
- `digital.vasic.herald.ci.test.passed` | `failed` | `flaky` | `skipped`.
- `digital.vasic.herald.ci.security_scan.finding` (Semgrep, Snyk, Trivy, gitleaks).
- `digital.vasic.herald.ci.dependency.outdated` | `vulnerable`.
- `digital.vasic.herald.ci.coverage.dropped`.
- `digital.vasic.herald.ci.lint.failed`.

Routing logic:

- Failed builds with @-mentions of the author (via `subscriber_aliases` mapping git-author-email → subscriber).
- Flaky tests batched into a daily digest (per §7.3 throttling).
- Security findings of CRITICAL severity bypass quiet hours.

Subscriber commands:

- **Retry:** — re-trigger the failed build (if integration grants permission).
- **Snooze:** <duration> — silence a flaky test.
- **Triage:** <finding> — mark a security finding for review.

18.4.1 Channel interactions

Surface	Channels	What it does
[Retry] [Open logs] [Blame] buttons	Slack, Discord, Telegram, Teams	Posted alongside every failed-build message; one-click access to the most common follow-ups.
[Snooze flaky 1d] [Snooze flaky forever] buttons	Slack, Discord	Posted on flaky-test events to throttle noise without needing prefix commands.
`/triage {accepted wont-fix false-positive}` slash command		
 reaction	Slack, Discord, Telegram	Promotes a failed-build event into a pherald bug investigation (HRD-INV-NNN) — one-emoji cross-flavor handoff.
Coverage delta card	Slack, Discord, Teams	Posted on every PR's CI completion; shows new-vs-base coverage + which files dropped + jump-to-blame.
Build digest forum topic	Telegram (forum group)	All build events for the same branch land in one topic; auto-archives on branch deletion.

18.5 Deploy Herald (dherald)

Focus: Release / deployment / rollout events.

Event subtree: `digital.vasic.herald.deploy.*`.

Sources:

- ArgoCD / Flux webhook (application synced, health degraded).
- Spinnaker pipeline notifications.
- Kubernetes Event watcher (Deployment rolled out, ReplicaSet failed).
- Custom deploy scripts invoking `dherald send`.

Event types:

- `digital.vasic.herald.deploy.started | succeeded | failed | rolled_back`.
- `digital.vasic.herald.deploy.canary.promoted | canary.aborted`.
- `digital.vasic.herald.deploy.feature_flag.toggled`.
- `digital.vasic.herald.deploy.config.drift_detected`.

Routing:

- Production deploys notify `#prod-deploys` + an Email to `release-eng`.

- Failed deploys with rollback option button (Slack Block Kit Action).

Subscriber commands:

- Rollback: `<deploy_id>` — initiate rollback (gated by elevated privilege).
- Hold: `<env>` — freeze further deploys to env.
- Status: `<env>` — current state of env.

Composes with **rherald** for the full release pipeline.

18.5.1 Channel interactions

Surface	Channels	What it does
[Rollback] [Promote canary] [Hold env] [Open dashboard] buttons	Slack, Discord, Telegram, Teams	Posted on every deploy event with elevated-role check before execution. Confirmation modal required for Rollback and Hold env (destructive).
 reaction on a deploy event	Slack, Discord	Pages the on-call engineer + freezes further deploys to that env (one-emoji shortcut for "rollback in progress").
/promote <code><deploy_id></code> slash command	Slack, Discord	Promotes a canary to full rollout (operator role required).
/hold <code><env></code> <code><duration></code> [reason] slash command	Slack, Discord	Freezes deploys to an env; bidirectional sync to deploy tool.
Environment status card	All rich channels	One card per env (dev / staging / canary / prod) with current version + last deploy + health-check status — refreshed via §35 versioned-report mechanic on every event.
Slack views.open modal	Slack	[Rollback] button opens modal asking for: target version, scope (full vs canary), reason, on-call notify list.

18.6 Alert Herald (aherald)

Focus: Monitoring-alert routing. Sits between alert producers (Alertmanager, Datadog, Grafana) and human/on-call channels (PagerDuty, OpsGenie, Slack). Provides smarter routing than Alertmanager's native receivers.

Event subtree: `digital.vasic.herald.alert.*`.

Sources:

- Prometheus Alertmanager webhook.
- Grafana alert webhook.
- Datadog webhook.
- OpenTelemetry-native alert sources.
- Generic CloudEvents alert producers.

Routing features:

- **De-duplication**: same alert fingerprint within window → single notification.
- **Grouping**: related alerts (same service label + severity) collapse into a digest.
- **Inhibition**: parent alert silences child alerts (per Alertmanager's `inhibit_rules`).
- **Escalation**: integrates with Temporal workflow for time-based escalation chains.
- **Quiet hours** override only for `severity=critical` + `category=incidents`.

Subscriber commands:

- `Ack:`, `Silence:`, `Resolve:` (same as `sherald`).
- `Escalate:` — bump severity, route to on-call.

18.6.1 Channel interactions

Surface	Channels	What it does
[Ack] [Silence 1h] [Silence 4h] [Resolve] [Escalate] buttons	Slack, Discord, Telegram, Teams	Posted on every alert; one-click. [Ack] carries an implicit time-window (acknowledgement claim lasts for the alert's <code>escalation_window</code> , default 15 min — if not resolved by then, alert re-fires and escalation re-engages).
 reactions	Slack, Discord, Telegram, Lark	Cross-flavor primitives (per §18.1.1) wired to <code>ack/silence/escalate</code> .
<code>/aherald group <service> slash</code> command	Slack, Discord	Shows the current grouping for a service: which alerts are collapsed into which digest.
<code>/aherald inhibit <parent> <child> slash</code> command	Slack, Discord	Operator-only — creates a runtime inhibition rule without editing Alertmanager config (synced back via API).
Alert digest card	All rich channels	Refreshed via §35 versioned-report mechanic — shows currently-firing group with member-alert chips; each chip is clickable for drill-down.
Telegram inline-keyboard "expand" button	Telegram	Collapses long alert descriptions; one-tap to expand. Avoids hitting Telegram's message-length limit on big alert payloads.
Email reply-by-keyword	Email	Subscribers may reply <code>ack</code> , <code>silence 4h</code> , <code>resolve</code> , <code>escalate</code> in the email body; Herald parses keywords + applies the action even without buttons (email is button-less).

18.7 Schedule Herald (scherald)

Focus: Scheduled jobs + recurring notifications (cron-like).

Event subtree: `digital.vasic.herald.schedule.*`.

Sources:

- River queue periodic jobs.
- `scherald serve` runs an internal cron-style scheduler.
- External cron jobs invoking `scherald send`.

Event types:

- `digital.vasic.herald.schedule.job.started | succeeded | failed | skipped`.
- `digital.vasic.herald.schedule.digest.daily | weekly | monthly`.
- `digital.vasic.herald.schedule.reminder.due` (scheduled human reminders).

Built-in digest builders:

- Daily ops digest (yesterday's alerts + deploys + failed builds).
- Weekly project digest (PRs merged, issues opened/closed, contributors).
- Monthly compliance digest (per `cherald` if installed).

Subscriber commands:

- Snooze: `<reminder_id> for <duration>`.
- Cancel: `<reminder_id>`.
- Remind me: `<prose>` — parse and create a one-shot reminder.

18.7.1 Channel interactions

Surface	Channels	What it does
[Snooze 1h] [Snooze 1d] [Snooze custom] [Cancel] buttons	Slack, Discord, Telegram, Teams	One-click on every reminder. [Snooze custom] opens a modal (Slack/Discord) or DM-prompt fallback for duration entry.
/remind <subject> in <duration> slash command	Slack, Discord, Telegram	Native cross-platform reminder creation; parses <duration> permissively (5m, 2 hours, tomorrow 9am, next Mon 14:00 UTC).
`/digest <daily weekly monthly>` slash command		
 reaction on a reminder	Slack, Discord, Telegram	Re-schedules for the same delta from now (e.g., subscriber gets reminder at 10:00, clicks  at 10:30 → next reminder at 11:00).
Digest "[I read this]" reaction button	Slack, Discord, Teams	Tracks readership; in subsequent digests Herald can deprioritise

Surface	Channels	What it does
Forum-topic per recurring series	Telegram (forum group)	sections fewer subscribers read (closes feedback loop). Each weekly project digest gets its own forum topic so readers can subscribe per series, not per channel.

18.8 Incident Herald (`iherald`)

Focus: Incident lifecycle — declare, escalate, resolve, postmortem.

Event subtree: `digital.vasic.herald.incident.*`.

Sources:

- PagerDuty / OpsGenie webhooks (incident open/escalated/resolved).
- Internal `iherald` send from on-call tools.
- Auto-escalation triggered by `aherald` after N min unacknowledged.

Event types:

- `digital.vasic.herald.incident.opened` | `escalated` | `resolved` | `reopened`.
- `digital.vasic.herald.incident.commander.assigned`.
- `digital.vasic.herald.incident.update.posted`.
- `digital.vasic.herald.incident.postmortem.due` | `published`.

Workflow (Temporal):

- On open: page primary on-call → wait 5 min → if no ack, escalate to secondary → wait 10 min → page manager.
- On resolve: schedule postmortem reminder 24h out.
- On postmortem.published: notify stakeholders.

Subscriber commands:

- Page: `<person>` — manual escalation.
- IC: (incident-commander) — assign IC role.
- Update: `<prose>` — post a public update.
- Resolve: — close the incident.

18.8.1 Channel interactions

Surface	Channels	What it does
Incident command room	Slack thread / Discord forum-channel post / Telegram forum-topic /	Every incident gets a dedicated command room — all updates, page-out logs, IC handoffs, action items, and resolution land in one place. Auto-archived 30 days post-resolution.

Surface	Channels	What it does
	Teams channel	
[Take IC] [Page sec] [Open runbook] [Update] [Resolve] buttons	Slack, Discord, Telegram, Teams	Posted on every incident.opened. [Take IC] is a single-tap takeover (atomic compare-and-swap on incidents.commander_id).
[Acknowledge page] button	Slack, Discord, Telegram, Teams, Email, WhatsApp	Posted on every page-out — the engineer's ack short-circuits the 5/10-min escalation. Email implementation uses a one-click signed URL (Universal §11.4.10 credentials never tracked → URL signed with [interactions].ack_signing_key).
/ic <handle> slash command	Slack, Discord	Assign IC role to another subscriber; both parties get a DM confirming the handoff.
/postmortem slash command	Slack, Discord	Generates a postmortem template (using §36 multi-format export) seeded with the incident timeline pulled from incident_events table; opens a Slack modal / Discord thread for in-place authoring.
Status-update reaction kbd	Slack	Authoring an update in the command room uses Slack's native message composer; a [Post as public status] button publishes the message to subscribers outside the command room.
Real-time timer	All rich channels	Refreshed via §35 versioned-report mechanic every 60 s — shows time-since-open, time-since-last-update, time-to-postmortem-due.

18.9 Release Herald (rherald)

Focus: Release lifecycle — tags, changelogs, dependency notifications.

Event subtree: digital.vasic.herald.release.*.

Sources:

- Git tag webhooks.
- GoReleaser / Release-Please / semantic-release pipeline hooks.
- Renovate / Dependabot PR webhooks (dependency.update.available).
- OCI registry push events (oci.image.pushed).

Event types:

- digital.vasic.herald.release.tagged | published.
- digital.vasic.herald.release.changelog.generated.
- digital.vasic.herald.release.dependency.update.available | major.update.available.

- `digital.vasic.herald.release.sbom.generated | provenance.signed.`
- `digital.vasic.herald.release.security_advisory.published` (CVE for a project dep).

Composes with dherald — release publish event triggers deploy pipeline notification chain.

Subscriber commands:

- Promote: `<version> to <env>`.
- Approve: `<dep_update>` — approve a Renovate PR via authorised channel.

18.9.1 Channel interactions

Surface	Channels	What it does
Release card	All rich channels	One pinned card per release tag with version, SBOM checksum, signed-provenance link, changelog excerpt, breaking-changes flag. Refreshed via §35 versioned-report mechanic on every related event.
[Promote to staging] [Promote to prod] [Hold] [Open changelog] buttons	Slack, Discord, Telegram, Teams	One-click promotion path; [Promote to prod] requires a Slack modal confirmation with <code>release_note_signoff</code> field (recorded in audit log per §11.4.10).
[Approve] [Reject] [Defer 7d] buttons	Slack, Discord, Telegram	Posted on every dependency-update event (Renovate / Dependabot PR). Approval routes back to the source via PR-comment API.
<code>/cve <CVE-id></code> slash command	Slack, Discord	Returns CVSS score + affected versions in the project + remediation guidance.
<code>/release-notes</code> slash command	Slack, Discord, Telegram	Generates a §36 multi-format release notes bundle from <code>docs/changelogs/</code> since last tag.
Compliance badge reactions	Slack, Discord	Operator reactions  /  on SBOM/SLSA-provenance events drive <code>cherald</code> triage queue.
Breaking-changes thread	Slack thread / Telegram forum-topic	Each release with <code>breaking_changes=true</code> opens a thread for migration-question Q&A; auto-archive 30 days post-release.

18.10 Compliance Herald (`cherald`)

Focus: Audit + compliance + governance events. For regulated environments (SOC2, HIPAA, PCI-DSS, GDPR).

Event subtree: `digital.vasic.herald.compliance.*`.

Sources:

- Cloud audit logs (AWS CloudTrail, GCP Cloud Audit Logs, Azure Activity Log) via OpenTelemetry / native exporters.
- IAM change webhooks (Okta, Auth0, AzureAD).
- Vault / KMS access logs.
- Database audit log streamers.
- GitGuardian / TruffleHog secret-scan webhooks.

Event types:

- `digital.vasic.herald.compliance.audit.access` (privileged action).
- `digital.vasic.herald.compliance.policy.violation` (e.g. unencrypted bucket, S3 public ACL).
- `digital.vasic.herald.compliance.cert.expiring | expired`.
- `digital.vasic.herald.compliance.license.expiring | non_compliant`.
- `digital.vasic.herald.compliance.access.review.due` (quarterly access reviews).
- `digital.vasic.herald.compliance.secret.exposed`.

Routing:

- All events archived to immutable storage (`docs/herald/audit/` with WORM bit if filesystem supports).
- High-severity events routed to security + legal channels.
- Quarterly summary digest emailed to compliance officer.

Constitution composition: `cherald` events plug into the parent project's Constitution §11.4.10 (credentials never tracked) and §11.4.18 (audit-log discipline).

18.10.1 Channel interactions

Surface	Channels	What it does
Restricted audience by default	Slack private channel, Discord role-gated channel, Telegram private group, Teams private team	All <code>cherald</code> channel addresses default to <code>restricted=true</code> in <code>channel_addresses.metadata</code> ; messages are <i>not</i> visible to unprivileged subscribers regardless of category.
[Acknowledge violation] [Mark false-positive] [Open ticket] buttons	Slack, Discord, Teams	Posted on every policy-violation event. [Open ticket] cross-flavor handoff into <code>pherald</code> (creates an investigation in the security workable-items track).

Surface	Channels	What it does
/audit <subscriber-id> slash command	Slack (operator-only)	Returns the audit trail for the named subscriber — every event they touched in the last N days. Operator-gated; emits a <code>digital.vasic.herald.compliance.audit.review</code> event so audits-of-audits are themselves audited.
 reaction	Slack, Discord (operator-only)	Marks an event as sensitive; subsequent re-publish suppresses message body in non-restricted channels, leaving only the event ID + "details in restricted channel" pointer.
Compliance digest modal	Slack <code>views.open</code>	Quarterly review modal lists overdue access-reviews + expiring certs + license issues in a single composable form for the compliance officer's sign-off.
Email-as- system-of- record	Email	Every cherald event is <i>also</i> emailed (per the §35 versioned-report mechanic) so the immutable mail archive is the legal-grade backup; subscribers reply with <code>keep / ignore</code> keywords to drive triage.
Forum-topic per compliance domain	Telegram (forum group)	One topic per domain (SOC2 / HIPAA / PCI-DSS / GDPR / internal-policy) so auditors can scope their review by clicking one topic.

18.11 Future flavors

Identified candidates (NOT in V2 scope; documented to lock-in event-subtree namespaces):

- **fherald** — Finance Herald (billing events, invoice paid/failed, MRR alerts) — `digital.vasic.herald.finance.*`.
- **mherald** — Marketing Herald (campaign sent, A/B test winner) — `digital.vasic.herald.marketing.*`.
- **gherald** — Game/Server Herald (multiplayer match events, anti-cheat reports) — `digital.vasic.herald.game.*`.
- **xherald** — Experiment Herald (feature-flag experiment results) — `digital.vasic.herald.experiment.*`.
- **hherald** — Hardware Herald (IoT device telemetry alerts) — `digital.vasic.herald.hardware.*`.
- **lherald** — Legal Herald (contract renewals, NDA expirations) — `digital.vasic.herald.legal.*`.
- **vherald** — Vendor Herald (third-party service status, SLA breaches) — `digital.vasic.herald.vendor.*`.

§19. Diary

`docs/herald/diary/main.md` (+ `main.pdf` + `main.html`) is the **append-only conversation log** of every inbound and outbound message Herald processes.

19.1 Diary path resolution (per R-20)

Resolved relative to the **operator-specified working directory**:

- Standalone Herald: defaults to Herald's own repository root.
- Herald as submodule: defaults to the parent project's root (discovered via the same parent-walk as `find_constitution.sh`).
- Override: `--diary-root <path>` flag, or `[herald].diary_root` in `config.toml`.

19.2 Schema (Markdown)

2026-05-19T18:30:00Z · pherald · digital.vasic.herald.ci.failed

Field	Value
Tenant	<code>`00000000-...-0001`</code>
Event ID	<code>`01931a7c-...-5678`</code>
Source	<code>`github.com/vasic-digital/Herald/actions/runs/4231`</code>
Channels	tgram (delivered), slack (delivered), email (queued)

****Body:****

> Build pao u ``main``: 3/5 testova nije prošlo. Pogledaj log:
> <https://github.com/vasic-digital/Herald/actions/runs/4231>

****Subscribers reached:**** alice (tgram + slack), bob (email).

19.3 Sync strategy (per R-03)

- **Pandoc** (Markdown → HTML5) + **WeasyPrint** (HTML → PDF) via Pandoc's `--pdf-engine=weasyprint` flag.
 - **Triggers**:
 - Under `<flavor>herald serve`: **fsnotify-watched debounced builds** (500 ms idle, 2 s ceiling). A single editor save fires 4–12 events; debouncing avoids redundant rebuilds.
 - Under one-shot `<flavor>herald send`: post-write hook in the diary writer.
 - **Manifest** at `docs/herald/diary/.sync.json` records `{md_sha256, html_sha256, pdf_sha256, source_md_sha256_at_build, built_at}`.
 - **Anti-bluff gate** (CM-DIARY-SYNC per Universal §11.4.61):
 1. Read current `main.md` SHA-256.
 2. Assert it equals `source_md_sha256_at_build` in the manifest.
 3. For HTML: re-run Pandoc to a temp file; byte-equality with on-disk HTML.
 4. For PDF: extract text (`pdftotext main.pdf -`) and compare to deterministic extraction of the HTML body (byte-equal PDF comparison fails due to embedded timestamps + non-deterministic font subsetting).
-

§20. Extensibility

Per research Topic 6 (operations): two-tier extensibility model.

20.1 Tier A — in-tree adapters (default for V2)

Every channel adapter lives under `commons_messaging/channels/<name>` and implements the `Channel` interface (§11). Out-of-tree authors fork or vendor.

20.2 Tier B — subprocess + manifest (deferred to V2.1)

Spec'd now, implementation deferred. Herald discovers external channel binaries through a manifest file (`heraldchannel.yaml`):

```
name: my-custom-channel
exec: /usr/local/lib/herald/channels/my-channel
supports:
  - text
  - markdown
  - attachments
env:
  required:
    - MY_CHANNEL_TOKEN
protocol_version: 1
```

Communication: stdin/stdout NDJSON with versioned envelope. No in-process linkage — adapters can be written in any language, sandboxed with OS tooling. Mirrors Apprise / Mattermost / git credential-helper.

Explicitly rejected for V2:

- Go plugin stdlib (toolchain-version brittleness, no Windows, breaks `-trimpath`).
 - HashiCorp go-plugin (RPC surface + per-plugin process mgmt — overhead vs. subprocess+JSON).
 - Wazero/WASM (promising; WASI sockets still incomplete; network-bound adapter can't run usefully today). Marked as **V3 roadmap candidate**.
-

§21. Supply chain & release engineering

Per research Topic 5 (operations) + R-18:

21.1 Multi-binary versioning

`go.work` for local dev (git-ignored). Per-flavor `go.mod`. Lockstep release: one git tag → GoReleaser builds all flavors + tags `commons/vX.Y.Z`. Release-Please in `manifest` mode bumps all modules from Conventional Commits.

21.2 Reproducible builds

Mandatory flags: `CGO_ENABLED=0 GOFLAGS=-trimpath`. Pinned `-ldflags "-buildid= -s -w"`. Record `GOTOOLCHAIN`.

21.3 SBOMs

Every binary + every container image generates **CycloneDX JSON + SPDX JSON** via `syft`. Attached as release assets and as OCI refererrs on the image.

21.4 Signing

Keyless cosign (Sigstore OIDC via GitHub Actions) for:

- Binaries: `cosign sign-blob`.
- OCI images: `cosign sign`.

21.5 SLSA provenance (target: Build L3)

GitHub actions/`attest-build-provenance` emits **in-toto** statements signed via Sigstore. Move the build into a **reusable workflow** shared across mirrors to reach **SLSA Build L3**.

21.6 Distribution channels

Channel	Tool	Path
Homebrew tap	GoReleaser	<code>vasic-digital/homebrew-herald</code>
Scoop bucket	GoReleaser	<code>vasic-digital/scoop-herald</code>
<code>.deb</code> / <code>.rpm</code>	nFPM	<code>vasic-digital/herald-packages</code> <code>apt+yum repos</code>
Container images	GoReleaser → Docker	<code>GHCR ghcr.io/vasic-digital/<flavor>herald</code>
Source release	GitHub Releases	Multi-mirror per §103

Verification UX: `scripts/verify-release.sh` runs `cosign verify + cosign verify-attestation` against the published cert identity (https://github.com/vasic-digital/Herald/.github/workflows/release.yml@refs/tags/*).

§22. Constitution integration

Once Herald is fully implemented and verified, **promote candidate universal rules** into the root Constitution, `AGENTS.md`, and `CLAUDE.md` **via a HelixConstitution PR** (audited per Universal §11.4 + §11.4.17 — universal-vs-project classification), never by editing the parent constitution Submodule from inside Herald (per R-09; see `CONSTITUTION_INHERITANCE.md` §"Promoting Herald rules into the constitution"). Each Flavor presents its Constitution extensions through the same promotion process.

Note: Herald's implementation MUST BE in direct connection with the constitution Submodule — discovery via `find_constitution.sh` parent-walk per §103 / §105 of Herald Constitution.

See [../..guides/HERALD_CONSTITUTION.md](#) and [../..guides/CONSTITUTION_INHERITANCE.md](#).

22.1 How constitution rules are extended via constitutable/

A parent project may drop `Constitution.md` / `CLAUDE.md` / `AGENTS.md` (in `constitutable/`, `constitutable/<flavor>/`, `constitutable/<flavor>/<variant>/`, etc.) to layer extensions or overrides on top of the discovered `constitution/` Submodule.

Load priority (per constitutable/ mechanism):

`constitution` Submodule → `constitutable/**` extensions/overrides for `Constitution` / `CLAUDE.md` / `AGENTS.md` → Project + Submodule definition files.

Each `constitutable/<path>` MUST contain at least one of: `Constitution.md`, `CLAUDE.md`, or `AGENTS.md`.

Note: Tests in the `constitution` Submodule MUST be properly extended and updated as `constitutable/` content changes.

Note: Herald is **primarily** consumed as a Submodule of another Project; in that case access to the `constitution` Submodule is through the root of that project (cloned under `project_root/constitution` or a configured alternative). For **standalone development** of Herald, the `constitution` is cloned **alongside** Herald (sibling-clone) — current development setup uses this layout. See [../..guides/CONSTITUTION_INHERITANCE.md](#) §"Standalone development" and R-10.

Note: Carefully investigate the codebase of the `constitution` Submodule before any changes are applied. Comprehensive analysis precedes any extension or promotion.

§23. Specification documents (change rule)

We MUST keep the following rule / mandatory constraint in `Constitution.md` (parent), `AGENTS.md`, `CLAUDE.md`, and `HERALD_CONSTITUTION.md` §106:

IMPORTANT: Whenever this document (`docs/specs/mvp/specification.V3.md`) or any file under `docs/specs/` (any depth) is modified, **comprehensive planning and implementation of all changes is MANDATORY**. This rule does NOT apply to creating or renaming files; for those, explicitly tell the worker (CLI agent) what to do with the new path. Treat every spec edit as a project-wide ripple, not a doc tweak.

The rule's enforcement anchor is the phrase comprehensive planning and implementation — inheritance-gate invariants **I7a–c** assert its presence in CLAUDE.md, AGENTS.md, and HERALD_CONSTITUTION.md. Path references in those propagated files **MUST** point at the currently-active spec file (V3 at time of writing; bump in lockstep when V4 supersedes).

§24. Documentation

README.md **MUST** be fully updated with all relevant project details. All user guides and manuals are properly linked from README.md, including (when present):

- docs/flavors/<flavor>/ — per-flavor user manual.
- docs/channels/<channel>/ — per-channel setup guide (credentials, webhooks, signing).
- docs/operations/ — deployment + doctor + backups + upgrades.
- docs/security/ — credential handling, signing keys, secret rotation.
- docs/api/ — machine-readable API specifications (see §24.1).
- docs/migration/ — operator guides for migrating from other notification stacks (Apprise, Gotify, Mattermost-bridge, etc.).

We **MUST** have **mandatory documentation up to the smallest details**: full user guides, manuals, diagrams, schemes in all major formats (Markdown source + PDF + HTML siblings per §11.4.61 + §11.4.65) and other relevant materials.

24.1 Machine-readable API specifications

Herald ships its own API contracts as machine-readable schemas so client tooling (SDK generators, mock servers, schema-validating proxies, API gateways) doesn't have to reverse-engineer them.

Spec	Location	Format	Generated by
HTTP ingress (/v1/events, /v1/send, /v1/subscribers, /v1/deadletters, /v1/channels)	docs/api/openapi.v1.yaml	OpenAPI 3.1	hand-authored from the canonical Go handler signatures in commons_http/*; CI gate CM-OPENAPI-DRIFT (planned) verifies handler ^[?] spec parity.
Webhook ingest (signed, per-source)	docs/api/openapi.v1.yaml (sub-tree under /webhooks/)	OpenAPI 3.1	same source as above.
Event taxonomy (digital.vasic.herald.* event types per §4.2)	docs/api/asynapi.v1.yaml	AsyncAPI 2.6	machine-generated from commons/events.go event-type registry.
	commons/types.go	Go source	

Spec	Location	Format	Generated by
Channel adapter Go interface (§11.0)			the source IS the spec; pkg.go.dev rendering is the human view.
Database schema	commons_storage/migrations/*.sql	PostgreSQL DDL	the migration files ARE the schema spec; <flavor>herald schema dump exports current state.

CLI helpers:

- <flavor>herald openapi — print the embedded OpenAPI spec (so operators don't need the repo).
- <flavor>herald asyncapi — same for AsyncAPI.
- <flavor>herald schema dump [--format=sql|markdown] — emit current DB schema.

Documentation cross-link rule (§11.4.59 + §11.4.61 composed): every change to a commons_http/ handler MUST update docs/api/openapi.v1.yaml, MUST add an entry to docs/changelogs/, MUST regenerate docs/api/openapi.v1.html (rendered via Redoc or stoplight-elements at build time). Drift is a release blocker.

§25. Testing

Whole project and all derivatives MUST follow testing rules from the root Constitution (Constitution.md), CLAUDE.md, AGENTS.md in the constitution Submodule. Specifically:

- **No bluffing** — every PASS carries positive evidence (§11.4).
- **Paired mutation gates** — every new gate has a paired mutation proving it catches regressions (§1.1).
- **Captured evidence** for test logs (§11.4.2).
- **Test pyramid**: unit tests in each module, integration tests against ephemeral Postgres + Redis (testcontainers-go), end-to-end tests with real-channel sandboxes.
- **No fakes beyond unit tests** (Universal §11.4.27) — integration + end-to-end tests use real Postgres, real Redis, real channel-sandbox or test-bot endpoints.

CI runs the inheritance gate (tests/test_constitution_inheritance.sh) as a precondition to any other test.

§26. Operations

26.1 Deployment

Reference deployment topologies:

- **Single-host Docker Compose** — Herald flavor + Postgres + Redis on one host. Suitable for small teams.
- **Kubernetes Deployment** — Herald flavor as a Deployment, Postgres + Redis as separate StatefulSets (or external managed). HPA on `messaging.client.operation.duration` p95.
- **Serverless / Lambda** — `<flavor>herald send` invoked as a Lambda function (one-shot mode); `serve` mode NOT supported in Lambda due to long-running needs.

26.2 Backups

- Postgres: daily logical backup (`pg_dump`) + WAL archiving for PITR.
- Redis: AOF rewrite + RDB snapshots.
- Diary: standard git history is the backup (everything is in `docs/herald/diary/main.md`).

26.3 Upgrades

- Lockstep across flavors via §21.1 release model.
- Database migrations are **forward-compatible** for 2 minor versions (so a rolling restart works during a deploy).
- `<flavor>herald migrate` is idempotent and safe to run multiple times.

26.4 Operator runbooks

`docs/operations/runbooks/` contains one runbook per common operational scenario:

- "Postgres connection storm" → check `herald_queue_depth` + `pg_stat_activity`.
- "Telegram bot suspended" → rotate token, update `.env`, run `<flavor>herald doctor`.
- "Dead-letter spike" → query `dead_letters`, identify pattern, replay or purge.
- "DKIM verification failing" → DNS check via `<flavor>herald doctor email`.

26.5 Operator quickstart (5-minute Docker Compose)

Goal: a working pherald ingesting one webhook and fanning out to Telegram + Email in five minutes on a fresh laptop. This is the canonical "hello world" deployment.

```
# docker-compose.quickstart.yml – referenced from containers/  
quickstart/  
version: "3.8"
```

```
services:
  postgres:
    image: postgres:16-alpine
    container_name: herald-postgres
    environment:
      POSTGRES_USER: herald
      POSTGRES_PASSWORD: ${HERALD_DB_PASSWORD}
      POSTGRES_DB: herald
    ports:
      - "24100:5432"
    volumes:
      - herald-pg:/var/lib/postgresql/data
    healthcheck:
      test: ["CMD-SHELL", "pg_isready -U herald"]
      interval: 5s
  redis:
    image: redis:7-alpine
    container_name: herald-redis
    command: ["redis-server", "--requirepass", "${HERALD_REDIS_PASSWORD}"]
    ports:
      - "24200:6379"
    volumes:
      - herald-redis:/data
  otel-collector:
    image: otel/opentelemetry-collector-contrib:latest
    container_name: herald-otel
    command: ["--config=/etc/otel-config.yaml"]
    volumes:
      - ./otel-config.yaml:/etc/otel-config.yaml:ro
    ports:
      - "24417:4317"
  pherald:
    image: ghcr.io/vasic-digital/pherald:latest
    container_name: herald-pherald
    depends_on:
      postgres: { condition: service_healthy }
      redis: { condition: service_started }
    environment:
      HERALD_POSTGRES_DSN: "postgres://herald:${HERALD_DB_PASSWORD}@postgres:5432/herald?sslmode=disable"
      HERALD_REDIS_ADDR: "redis:6379"
      HERALD_REDIS_USER: "default"
      HERALD_REDIS_PASSWORD: "${HERALD_REDIS_PASSWORD}"
      OTEL_EXPORTER_OTLP_ENDPOINT: "http://otel-collector:4317"
      OTEL_RESOURCE_ATTRIBUTES: "deployment.environment=quickstart"
      TELEGRAM_BOT_TOKEN: "${TELEGRAM_BOT_TOKEN}"
      TELEGRAM_CHAT_ID: "${TELEGRAM_CHAT_ID}"
    ports:
      - "24091:24091" # webhook ingress
      - "24090:24090" # admin (/livez, /readyz, /metrics)
    command: ["serve"]
```

```
volumes:
  herald-pg:
  herald-redis:
```

Steps:

```
# 1. Clone Herald + containers submodule
git clone git@github.com:vasic-digital/Herald.git && cd Herald
git submodule update --init

# 2. Copy & fill the example .env
cp .env.example .env
$EDITOR .env # set HERALD_DB_PASSWORD, HERALD_REDIS_PASSWORD,
              TELEGRAM_BOT_TOKEN, TELEGRAM_CHAT_ID

# 3. Boot
docker compose -f containers/quickstart/docker-
compose.quickstart.yml up -d

# 4. Wait for ready
curl --retry 30 --retry-delay 2 --retry-connrefused http://
localhost:24090/readyz

# 5. Send a test event
curl -X POST http://localhost:24091/v1/events \
  -H "Content-Type: application/cloudevents+json" \
  -d '{
    "specversion": "1.0",
    "id": "01931a7c-3f4e-7000-9abc-def012345678",
    "source": "https://example.com/quickstart",
    "type": "digital.vasic.herald.system.host.cpu_high",
    "subject": "tag:*",
    "data": {"host": "laptop", "cpu_pct": 97}
  }'

# 6. Verify
docker logs herald-pherald --tail=20
cat docs/herald/diary/main.md | tail -30
```

A successful run delivers a Telegram message to the configured chat within ~3 seconds, appends a diary entry, and emits OTel traces visible at <http://localhost:24417> (Collector logs).

26.6 Disaster recovery

Recovery objectives (V2 baseline; per-tenant overrides allowed):

Class	RPO target	RTO target	Mechanism
Postgres data	5 min	30 min	WAL archiving + PITR (pgbackrest recommended)
Redis state	5 min	5 min	

Class	RPO target	RTO target	Mechanism
Diary	0 (git)	minutes	AOF rewrite + RDB snapshot every 5 min; warm replica optional git push fan-out to 4 mirrors per §103; restore via git clone <any mirror>
Credentials	0 (out-of-band)	depends on operator	Vault / 1Password / OS keychain; Herald NEVER stores plaintext credentials
Configuration	0 (git)	minutes	config.toml is git-committed (no secrets); .env is git-ignored, backed up out-of-band by operator
Workflow state (Temporal opt-in)	5 min	30 min	Temporal's own backup/restore; out of Herald scope

Cold-start recovery procedure:

1. Restore Postgres from latest WAL position.
2. Restore Redis from latest RDB (transient state is fine to lose; rate-limit buckets repopulate).
3. git clone Herald + containers submodule from any mirror.
4. Re-provision .env from out-of-band credential store.
5. docker compose up -d.
6. <flavor>herald doctor — confirm all green.
7. <flavor>herald deadletter list — replay any in-flight messages caught at the time of failure.

Tested scenarios (each MUST have an integration test under tests/dr/):

- Postgres primary loss → failover to replica.
- Redis loss → cold restart (token buckets reset, no data corruption).
- Single Herald replica crash → other replicas continue (multi-instance deployments).
- Whole-host loss → cold-start from backups.
- All four git mirrors momentarily unreachable → push deferred, queued locally, retried.

§27. Roadmap

27.1 V2 → V3 candidates

Candidate	Notes
WASM channel adapters (wazero)	Once WASI sockets stabilise — Topic 6 (operations)
LLM-driven message rendering	Auto-summarize long events to channel-appropriate brevity
Slack workflow builder steps	Beyond V2 advanced tier

Candidate	Notes
WhatsApp Business custom-template approval workflow	Once Cloud API matures
Mini-Apps inside Telegram	Subscriber-side UI
Adaptive Card Designer integration for Teams	UX for non-developer template authors
First-class Matrix protocol channel	If demand materializes
Mattermost adapter	Open-source alternative to Slack
Rocket.Chat adapter	Self-hosted alternative

27.2 Deferred V1 Recommendations

V1 R-NN items that V2 did not yet implement (with intended landing):

R	Status in V2	Landing
R-01	✓ Applied (24XXX ports in §9.4)	—
R-02	✓ Applied (single binary, two modes §3.1)	—
R-03	✓ Specified (§19.3)	First implementation cycle
R-04	✓ Applied (§3.3)	—
R-05	✓ Specified (delivery evidence enum §11.13)	First adapter cycle
R-06	✓ Specified (§11.2 Max behind build tag)	When sanctions advisory drafted
R-07	✓ Applied (§7.1)	—
R-08	✓ Applied (§12 ConversationRef)	—
R-09 / R-10 / R-14 / R-15 / R-19 / R-20 / R-21 / R-22	✓ Applied	—
R-11 / R-12	✓ Specified (§9.5)	When first SDK / containers lands
R-13	Deferred — constitutable/ loader + I8/ I9 gates	Next constitution PR
R-16	✓ Specified (§15)	First implementation cycle
R-17	✓ Specified (§8.2 algorithm)	First commons_prefix commit
R-18	✓ Specified (§21.1)	First release pipeline

27.3 Cost considerations

Order-of-magnitude indicative pricing as of 2026-Q2 (operators MUST re-verify at deployment time; tiers change frequently). Herald itself is open-source / no licence fee — these costs are external dependencies an operator pays for in production.

Infrastructure (per single-region deployment):

Component	Self-host minimum	Managed (illustrative)
Postgres 16 (2 vCPU / 4 GiB / 20 GiB)	~\$15/mo (Hetzner CX21, DO Basic)	RDS db.t4g.small ~\$35/mo
Redis 7 (1 GiB)	~\$10/mo (same node as Postgres for small tenants)	ElastiCache cache.t4g.micro ~\$15/mo
Herald binary host (1 vCPU / 1 GiB)	~\$5/mo	ECS Fargate 0.25 vCPU ~\$10/mo
OTel Collector	sidecar / shared	Grafana Cloud free tier or self-host
Single-tenant baseline	~\$30/mo	~\$60–80/mo

Transactional email provider (ESP) — pick one based on volume + deliverability needs:

Provider	Free tier	Paid tier entry	Bounce/complaint webhook	Notes
<u>Resend</u>	3 000 emails/mo, 100/day	\$20/mo for 50k	✓ (Event Webhook)	Best DX of the three; Idempotency-Key header support.
<u>Postmark</u>	none — paid only	\$15/mo for 10k	✓ (Bounce / Spam / Open / Click streams)	Best deliverability reputation for transactional traffic; HTTP 406 for blocked recipients.
<u>SendGrid</u>	100 emails/day free forever	\$19.95/mo for 50k	✓ (Event Webhook)	Widest ecosystem; complex pricing tiers.
Self-host SMTP	\$0	infra + IP-reputation labour	DSN parsing only	Only if operator has DNS / reverse-DNS / warm IPs already; otherwise deliverability tanks.

Messaging platform fees:

Channel	Cost model
Telegram Bot API	Free, no fee per message.

Channel	Cost model
Slack	Free for public/private channel webhooks; paid plans only required for full Slack workspace, not for the integration.
Discord	Free webhooks; free bot.
Microsoft Teams	Free incoming webhooks; Bot Framework requires Azure Bot Service ~\$0.50/1 k messages.
Lark / Feishu	Free for chatbots within an org.
WhatsApp Business Cloud API (Meta direct)	Per-conversation pricing, ~0.005–0.15 depending on country + category.
WhatsApp Business via Twilio	Twilio markup on top of Meta price.
Viber	Free for service messages within 30 days of user interaction; promotional pricing varies.
Max	Free Bot API at the time of writing (verify at deploy).
ntfy / Gotify	Self-hosted = \$0; ntfy.sh free public instance.

Supply-chain tooling:

Tool	Cost
GitHub Actions (public repo)	Free unlimited minutes.
GitHub Actions (private repo)	2 000 free minutes/mo on Linux; \$0.008/min after.
Sigstore / cosign	Free (keyless via OIDC).
syft (SBOM)	Free / OSS.
GoReleaser OSS	Free.
GoReleaser Pro	\$19/mo if Herald needs the per-subproject <code>tag_prefix</code> feature (R-18 alternative — V2 default does not require Pro).

OpenTelemetry backend:

Backend	Free tier
Grafana Cloud	10 k series metrics, 50 GiB logs, 50 GB traces /mo
Honeycomb	20 M events/mo
Datadog	5 hosts free for 14 days
Self-host Prometheus + Tempo + Loki	\$0 + operator time

Total order-of-magnitude TCO for a small team running pherald + sherald self-hosted on Hetzner with Resend free tier: ~\$30–60/mo of recurring infrastructure. Operator labour for upgrades, monitoring, and incident response is the larger real cost — design choices in §17 (observability) and §26 (operations) exist specifically to minimise that labour.

§28. Notes & open questions

- The list of integrated messengers in §11 is the V2 commitment; additional channels may be added in later iterations.
 - Whether to ship a **first-party web UI** for subscriber preference management is an open question — current direction is "no UI in V2; expose REST API only; let third parties build UIs".
 - Whether aherald should incorporate **machine-learning-based alert grouping** (similar to BigPanda, Moogsoft) is deferred to V3.
 - Whether to support **end-to-end encryption** of messages (Signal Protocol via olm/megolm) is deferred — only Matrix bridges currently demand this.
 - The **rate-limit cap** for AI-CLI-agent subscribers needs operator-level tuning per deployment to avoid runaway invocation; default suggested 60 messages/minute per agent token.
-

§29. Changelog

29.1 V1 → V2 changes (2026-05-19)

V1 → V2 changes (2026-05-19):

- **Renamed** `specification.md` → `specification.V1.md` (preserved as historical record).
- **Created** `specification.V2.md` (this document).
- **New sections** (no V1 counterpart): §2.2 What Herald is NOT, §2.3 Architecture diagram, §4 Event model & wire format (CloudEvents), §5 Architecture overview, §6 Channel addressing & routing (Apprise-style URLs + tags), §7 Subscriber model (identity, preferences, quiet hours, locale), §13 Templating, §14 Localization, §15 Security model (three-layer), §16 Multi-tenancy & isolation (Postgres RLS + Redis ACL), §17 Observability & SLOs (OpenTelemetry), §20 Extensibility (Tier A + Tier B), §21 Supply chain & release engineering (SLSA L3), §26 Operations, §27 Roadmap.
- **Populated V1 TBDs:**
 - System Herald (was TBD) → fully specified §18.3.
 - Project Herald's Constitution rules → folded into §18.2 subscriber-command contract.
 - Input commands → expanded per-flavor in §18.
 - Input attachments → §15.3 content-level scanning + size limits.
 - Others and misc → §18.4–18.11 (7 new flavors + future-flavor namespace reservations).
- **New flavors** beyond V1's pherald + sherald: bherald (Build), dherald (Deploy), aherald (Alert), scherald (Schedule), iherald (Incident), rherald (Release), cherald (Compliance) — plus reserved namespaces for fherald / mherald / gherald / xherald / hherald / lherald / vherald.
- **Game-changing architecture adoptions** (from research):
 - **CloudEvents v1.0** as canonical wire format.
 - **Watermill** as routing core.
 - **River + Postgres** as default queue (transactional enqueue); NATS JetStream as opt-in.
 - **Apprise URL+tag** channel model.
 - **Knock-style preferences** matrix.

- **OpenTelemetry** end-to-end + Prometheus semantic conventions for messaging.
- **PostgreSQL RLS** + Redis ACL for multi-tenancy.
- **SLSA L3** supply chain (cosign + syft SBOM + in-toto provenance).
- **MJML** for email templates, compiled at author time.
- **nicksnyder/go-i18n** with CLDR plurals.
- **All V1 text-level Recommendations** (R-01 / R-04 / R-09 / R-10 / R-15 / R-19 / R-20 / R-21 / R-22) carried forward and re-expressed in V2 context.
- **Per-channel feature matrix** (§11.13) — every channel now has documented V1-minimum, V2-advanced, out-of-scope tiers + delivery-evidence ceiling.
- **Email deep dive** (§11.9) — DKIM signing (RFC 6376) + RFC 8058 one-click unsubscribe + DSN bounce parsing + suppression list + doctor email DNS verification, addressing Gmail/Yahoo 2024 sender requirements.
- **Removed** the V1 Review section — its findings are folded into the V2 body or marked applied/deferred in §27.2. V1's full Review remains in `specification.V1.md` for traceability.

V2 r2 → r3 (within V2 lifecycle, all detailed in §30): added §11.0 Go type contract for the Channel interface, defined `webhook_sources` / `channel_addresses` / `thread_refs` / `quarantined_messages` schemas, pinned Go ≥ 1.22 + license, added §16.1 Data retention & GDPR, §17.1 OpenTelemetry env-var table, §26.5 Operator quickstart, §26.6 Disaster recovery, §27.3 Cost considerations. R3 added the remaining undefined types (`Subscriber`, `CloudEventEnvelope`, `TraceContext`, `Branding`, `ChannelID`, `PreferenceSet`), §9.6 Database migration tooling, §3.4 Worker pools + SIGHUP hot-reload, §5.7 Ingress API URLs, §7.5 AI-agent subscribers, §8.3 Workable-item lifecycle, §11.14 `null:// sandbox` channel, §17.4.1 Per-channel SLO budgets, §24.1 Machine-readable API specs, §5.4.1 Outbound idempotency, §3.5 Time/clock abstraction.

29.2 V2 → V3 changes (2026-05-20)

- **Created** `specification.V3.md` (this document). `specification.V2.md` marked Status=superseded and kept as historical record alongside `specification.V1.md`. V1 + V2 + V3 stack constitutes the spec evolution chain.
- **NEW top-level sections** (no V2 counterpart):
 - **§31 Project integration contract** — explicit contract for what a consuming project provides + what Herald provides in return; composition with eight named Universal Constitution mandates (§11.4.12, .15, .16, .21, .32, .44, .55, .59, .60, .61, .65); project-side `config.toml` template; mandatory `test_project_integration.sh` audit gate.
 - **§32 Inbound processing pipeline** — full lifecycle from `channel.Subscribe` to diary append. 30 s polling cadence mandate (per-channel mechanic table). FIFO ordering per (`tenant`, `channel_address`) via Postgres advisory locks. Seven Worker stages (validation → safety → anti-spam → classification → dispatch → materialization → reply). `inbound_messages` schema. Anti-spam at four layers (per-sender rate, burst detection, reputation, channel-level frequency).
 - **§33 LLM/agent dispatch** — Claude Code as first integration. `resolve_session(project_name)` algorithm anchored at `<consuming-project>/herald/claude-code/sessions/<project>.session`. Structured `<<<HERALD-DISPATCH-v1>>>` request envelope. JSON `<<<HERALD-REPLY>>>` response schema (outcome enum, summary, details,

affected_paths, reproduction_steps, estimated_effort, workable_item_proposed, follow_up_questions). Pluggable Dispatcher interface — V3 r1 ships only claude-code; spec hooks for OpenCode/Aider/Gemini/Cursor/Managed Agents.

- **§34 Reply protocol** — three mandatory replies per inbound message: (A) queued ack with quoted original ≤ 5 s, (B) processing-started ≤ 5 s of dispatch (edit-in-place where channel supports), (C) final result within criticality SLA. Failure replies carry precise reason + diagnostics. Per-channel quote/edit matrix for all 13 channels. Operator-tunable verbosity (minimal | normal | verbose).
- **§35 Versioned reports + Git linkage** — report-aware event types (.report.created/.updated/.archived) with update_key for correlation. Per-channel update mechanic (edit-in-place vs re-post). Git commit SHA + URL + diff URL embedded in fan-out. report_publications schema with (content_sha256, git_commit_sha) dedup. Uncommitted-changes warning.
- **§36 Outbound multi-format attachments** — every Herald-produced attachment ships in four formats (.md + .html + .pdf + .docx) so subscribers pick their preferred. Pandoc generation pipeline with --reproducible flag. Cache at <diary_root>/.herald/format-cache/<sha256>/. Per-channel delivery rules + per-subscriber PreferenceSet.attachment_formats overrides. Bundle size cap (default 50 MiB).
- **Expanded §18.2 Project Herald** with the full **Investigation-before-Fixing flow** (§18.2.1): every bug/issue/implementation request first creates a HRD-INV-NNN investigation item; LLM (§33) analyzes reproducibility + affected paths + effort; only validated investigations promote to final workable items. Adds §18.2.2 criticality determination table (with explicit SLA windows per level), §18.2.3 Universal §11.4.16 type-classification mapping, §18.2.4 attachment storage at issues/users/attachments/<WORKABLE_ITEM_ID>/ with attachments_index.md source-of-truth file, §18.2.5 Claude Code project-session integration (anchor file at .herald/claude-code/sessions/<project>.session).
- **§29 retitled "Changelog"** (was "Changelog (V1 → V2)") so V1→V2 / V2→V3 / future changelogs accumulate under one logical section.

V2 sections that V3 does NOT change (still authoritative — V3 just extends): §1–§28 architectural baseline, §11.0 channel contract types, all flavor sections §18.3–§18.11 (refinement scheduled for V3 r2 per the metadata Continuation row).

§31. Project integration contract

First-version focus. §31 makes Herald a load-bearing piece of any consuming project that already follows the Helix Universal Constitution. The contract is symmetric: the consuming project gets a fully-instrumented event-to-channel pipeline; Herald gets a discoverable place to live and the constitution's rules to operate under.

31.1 Where Herald lives in a consuming project

Herald is consumed as a Git submodule. Conventional path:

```

<consuming-project>/
├── constitution/                                # Helix Universal
Constitution (also a submodule)
├── herald/                                      # this repo, as submodule
│   ├── pherald/cmd/pherald/main.go           # built per §21
│   ├── sherald/cmd/sherald/main.go
│   └── ...
├── containers/                                # docker/podman compose
(also a submodule)
└── docs/
    ├── Issues.md
    ├── Issues_Summary.md
    ├── Fixed.md
    ├── Fixed_Summary.md
    ├── CONTINUATION.md
    ├── Status.md
    └── herald/
        └── diary/main.{md,html,pdf,docx}

```

The consuming project's CI invokes `<flavor>herald send` from build steps and runs `<flavor>herald serve` as a daemon (Docker Compose / Kubernetes). Subscribers DM the configured bots; Herald processes those inbound messages, opens workable items, and replies in-thread.

31.2 Mandatory integration points

A consuming project that adopts Herald **MUST**:

1. **Add Herald as a Git submodule** at `<consuming-project>/herald/`. Run `install_upstreams.sh` per Universal §11.4.36.
2. **Register Herald in the Owned-submodule set** of the project's Constitution.md extension (per Universal §4 / §11.4.28).
3. **Pin the Herald version** via submodule SHA. Bumps follow Universal §11.4.32 (post-pull validation).
4. **Provide credentials** via `.env` + shell-exported variables (per §3.3). `.env` is git-ignored; `.env.example` is committed and templates every variable Herald needs.
5. **Wire the channel addresses** by populating `channel_addresses` (per §6) with the project's bot tokens / webhook URLs. Tags follow project conventions — common defaults: `prod`, `staging`, `oncall`, `audit`, `compliance`.
6. **Mount the diary path** so `<consuming-project>/docs/herald/diary/main.{md,html,pdf,docx}` is writable by Herald (per §19).
7. **Honor the spec-change rule** — any change to `<consuming-project>/herald/docs/specs/` triggers comprehensive planning per Universal §11.4 + Herald Constitution §106 (read order documented in `CLAUDE.md`).
8. **Add Herald CI hooks** — at minimum, post-commit hook calling `<flavor>herald send --type digital.vasic.herald.ci.commit.pushed ...` and CI-build webhook configured per §5.5.

31.3 Event-type registration

The consuming project MAY introduce its own event subtree under `digital.vasic.herald.<project_subtree>.*` and register the schema in the AsyncAPI spec (§24.1). The schema MUST be committed in `<consuming-project>/herald/docs/api/asynapi.<project>.yaml`. Herald validates inbound events against the schema and rejects malformed payloads with HTTP 422 + a per-channel error reply.

31.4 Composition with existing constitution mandates

Universal mandate	Herald V3 contribution
§11.4.12 Auto-generated docs sync	Herald emits events on every <code>Issues / Issues_Summary / Fixed / Fixed_Summary / Status / Status_Summary</code> change so subscribers get real-time visibility.
§11.4.15 Item-status tracking	Status transitions trigger <code>digital.vasic.herald.project.task.*</code> events.
§11.4.16 Item-type tracking	Type classifier (§32.4) maps inbound <code>Bug:/Issue:/Task:/Implementation:</code> commands to the correct item type.
§11.4.21 Operator-blocked status	When a workable item enters <code>operator-blocked</code> , Herald fan-outs to the configured <code>oncall</code> tag with the <code>unblock-question</code> payload.
§11.4.32 Post-Constitution-Pull validation	Herald's submodule bumps are validated against the constitution; Herald's gate (<code>tests/test_constitution_inheritance.sh</code>) is part of that validation.
§11.4.44 Document Revision Header	Herald respects §11.4.61 superseding format (table) when reading project docs.
§11.4.55 Reopens-history	Reopen flow (§8.3) writes to <code>docs/Reopens/<HRD-NNN>.md</code> .
§11.4.59 README always-sync	Herald reports README out-of-sync as an event (<code>digital.vasic.herald.compliance.doc.stale</code>).
§11.4.60 Documentation composite covenant	Herald's diary + multi-format exports per §36 satisfy the composite gate.
§11.4.61 Markdown metadata + ToC	Herald's diary follows the canonical metadata table; every diary entry carries Revision + Last modified per §19.
§11.4.65 Universal Markdown export	§36 multi-format pipeline is the implementation of this mandate at attachment-time.

31.5 Project-side configuration template

```
# <consuming-project>/herald/config.toml – committed (no secrets)
[herald]
flavor      = "pherald"
project_name = "ATMOSphere"           # used for Claude
        Code session resolution (§33.2)
tenant_id   = "000000000-0000-0000-0000-0000000000001"
diary_root  = ""                     # blank → parent-
        walk discovery (§19.1)
admin_port  = 24090
http_port   = 24091

[ingest]
poll_interval_seconds = 30
        # §32.2 – mandatory 30s cadence
fifo_strict           = true         # §32.3 strict FIFO

[security]
spam_max_per_minute_per_sender = 10    # §32.5 anti-spam
        thresholds
spam_max_per_hour_per_sender   = 100
quarantine_unknown_sender      = true

[llm]
default_agent      = "claude-code"     # §33.1 default
        dispatch target
claude_code_binary = "claude"          # path / name on
        PATH
session_strategy   = "project-cwd"     # §33.2 strategy
        enum

[attachments]
out_format_set      = ["md", "html", "pdf", "docx"] # §36 multi-
        format default
in_storage_root     = "issues/users/attachments"   # §18.2
        inbound attachment path
in_max_mib          = 25
in_total_max_mib    = 100
```

31.6 Project audit gate

<consuming-project>/herald/tests/test_project_integration.sh
(planned) asserts:

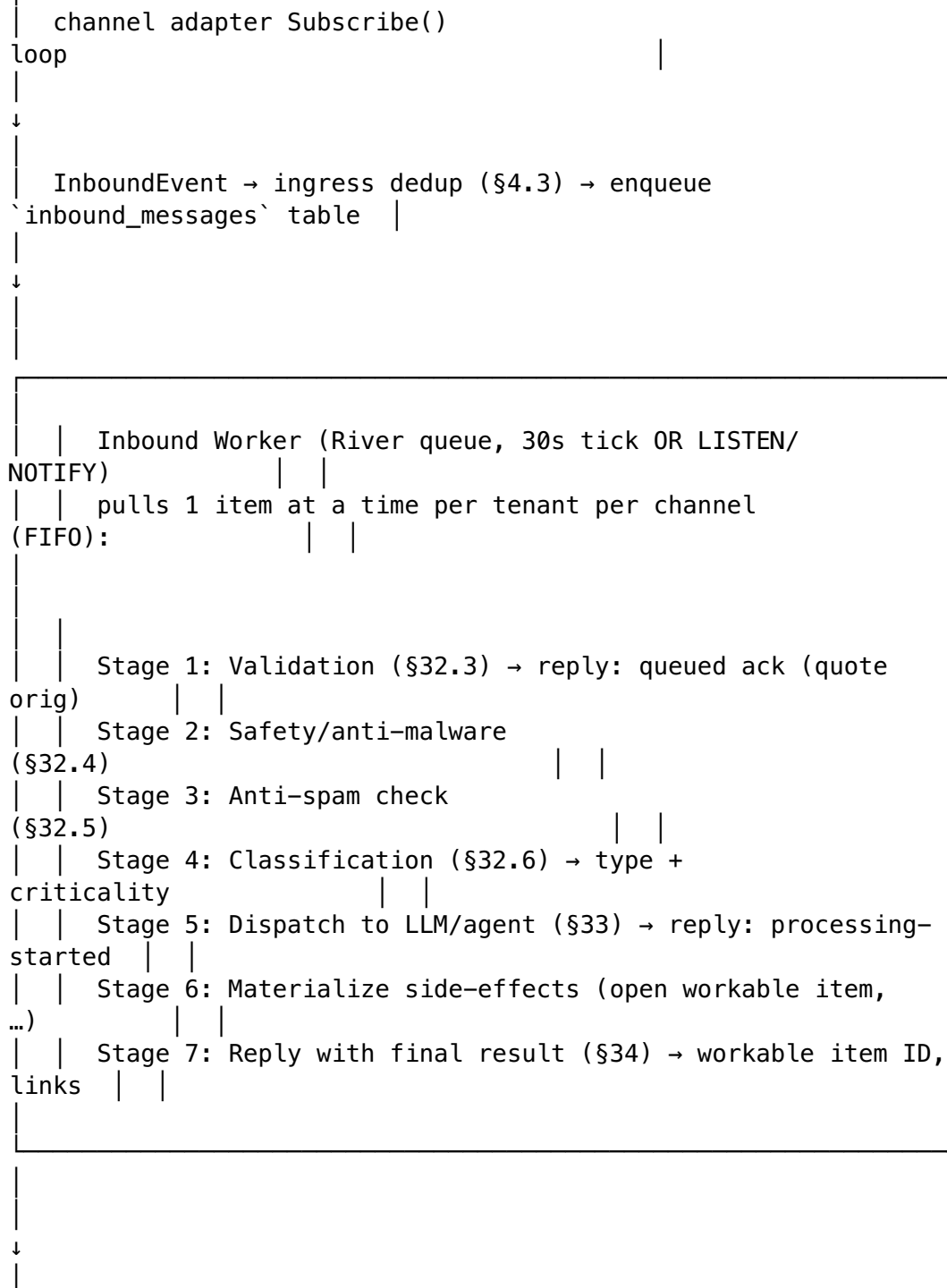
- constitution/ submodule discoverable via parent-walk.
- containers/ submodule present and version-pinned.
- .env.example committed; .env git-ignored.
- channel_addresses table non-empty for the project's default tenant.
- Project's Owned-submodule set lists herald/ and containers/.
- Diary path exists and is writable.
- pherald doctor exits zero.

Paired §1.1 mutation: rename .env to track-ed — gate FAILs.

§32. Inbound processing pipeline

32.1 Pipeline overview

Every message a subscriber sends back into Herald (DM reply, channel mention, email reply with Herald's Message-ID in In-Reply-To, ntfy poll) enters the **inbound queue** for sequential processing by Workers. The pipeline is FIFO per tenant per channel-address, with explicit anti-spam, multi-stage validation, and three user-visible reply checkpoints (§34).



| diary append (\$19); 0Tel span
closed

32.2 Polling cadence (30 s mandate)

Every flavor's Subscribe loop **MUST** check upstream for new messages **at least every 30 seconds**. Upstream-specific implementation:

Channel	Mechanism	Effective check rate
Telegram	Bot API getUpdates long-poll (timeout 25 s)	continuous, but a 30 s safety-net timer also fires getUpdates if the long-poll thread stalled
Slack	Socket Mode (WebSocket) OR Events API webhook	continuous on Socket Mode; 30 s timer as keepalive ping
Discord	Gateway WebSocket	continuous; 30 s timer asserts heartbeat OK
MS Teams	Bot Framework activity webhook	webhook-driven; 30 s timer asserts subscription validity
Lark	Event subscription webhook	same
WhatsApp Cloud	Webhook	same
Viber	Webhook	same
Email	IMAP IDLE preferred; fall back to 30 s IMAP poll	IDLE = continuous; non-IDLE = 30 s
ntfy	WebSocket/SSE	continuous
Gotify	WebSocket	continuous
Max	Bot API poll	30 s

Configurable via `[ingest].poll_interval_seconds` (default 30); operators **MAY** tighten to 10 s for high-volume tenants but **MUST NOT** loosen beyond 60 s without operator-explicit override (`--allow-slow-poll`).

32.3 FIFO order + Worker selection

Inbound items are queued in `inbound_messages` with `enqueued_at` timestamp + UUIDv7 id. The River queue is partitioned by (`tenant_id`, `channel_address_id`) so:

- Multiple senders on the same channel are processed in strict arrival order.
- Different channels for the same tenant run in parallel.
- Different tenants run in parallel.

Schema:

```

CREATE TABLE inbound_messages (
  id                UUID PRIMARY KEY DEFAULT uuidv7(),
  tenant_id         UUID NOT NULL,
  channel           TEXT NOT NULL,
  channel_address_id UUID NOT NULL REFERENCES
    channel_addresses(id),
  sender_channel_user_id TEXT NOT NULL,
  received_at       TIMESTAMPTZ NOT NULL DEFAULT now(),
  cloudevent_jsonb  JSONB NOT NULL,
  attachments_jsonb JSONB NOT NULL DEFAULT '[]'::jsonb,
  stage             TEXT NOT NULL DEFAULT 'queued', --
    queued|validating|safety|anti_spam|classifying|dispatched|
    completed|failed
  stage_started_at  TIMESTAMPTZ NOT NULL DEFAULT now(),
  classification    JSONB, --
    type+criticality+confidence
  workable_item_id  TEXT, --
    after successful materialization
  last_reply_at     TIMESTAMPTZ,
  failure_reason    TEXT,
  failure_details   JSONB
);
CREATE INDEX inbound_fifo_idx ON inbound_messages (tenant_id,
  channel_address_id, received_at)
  WHERE stage NOT IN ('completed', 'failed');
ALTER TABLE inbound_messages ENABLE ROW LEVEL SECURITY;
ALTER TABLE inbound_messages FORCE ROW LEVEL SECURITY;
CREATE POLICY inb_isolation ON inbound_messages
  USING (tenant_id = current_setting('app.tenant_id')::uuid)
  WITH CHECK (tenant_id =
    current_setting('app.tenant_id')::uuid);

```

The Worker holds a per-(tenant_id, channel_address_id) advisory lock for the duration of one item's pipeline so strict FIFO is preserved across the seven stages.

32.4 Stages 1–2: validation + safety

Stage 1: Validation. Asserts:

- CloudEvents id is unique within idempotency window (§4.3 hit/miss).
- sender_channel_user_id matches an entry in subscriber_aliases OR is allowlisted as a verified webhook source.
- Message body is well-formed UTF-8 ≤ 8 KiB per command + ≤ 256 KiB total.
- Attachments declared in attachments_jsonb MUST be retrievable from the source channel and MUST be $\leq$ [attachments].in_max_mib each (default 25 MiB) and $\leq$ [attachments].in_total_max_mib total (default 100 MiB).

Failure → reply with precise reason (§34.4), stage = failed, NO further processing.

Stage 2: Safety / anti-malware. Each attachment is scanned:

- ClamAV (when commons_security.clamav.enabled=true and the daemon is reachable) — definitive engine.

- Magic-byte type check vs declared MIME (rejects MIME spoofing).
- Filename allowlist by extension (default:
`.txt .md .json .yaml .yml .csv .pdf .docx .html .png .jpg .jpeg .webp .gif .log .zip .tar.gz`).
- Optional: per-tenant additional scanner (configurable hook command receives the file path, returns 0 = clean, non-zero = quarantine).

Inbound text body is scanned for:

- URL allowlist / blocklist per tenant.
- Prompt-injection markers (heuristics — short list of known patterns: Ignore previous instructions, BEGIN SYSTEM, `<|im_start|>`, etc.). Hit → quarantine, NOT auto-reject (operator review).

Failure → reply with reason, stage = failed, attachment quarantined to `quarantined_messages.attachments_jsonb`.

32.5 Stage 3: anti-spam

Spam prevention is layered:

1. **Per-sender rate limits** (configurable per tenant via `[security].spam_max_*`):
 - `spam_max_per_minute_per_sender` (default 10)
 - `spam_max_per_hour_per_sender` (default 100)
 - `spam_max_per_day_per_sender` (default 500) Exceeded → message accepted, but reply downgraded to 429 Too Many Requests with the cooldown window.
2. **Burst detection** — a sender that posts > N similar messages (Levenshtein distance < 5%) within window T is throttled; if pattern continues, sender enters quarantine.
3. **Sender reputation** — per-(tenant, sender_channel_user_id) score in Redis (`t:<id>:rep:<sender>` integer), incremented on successful interaction, decremented on validation/safety failures. Negative score → mandatory operator review before processing.
4. **Channel-level frequency** — if `channel_addresses[address_id]` receives > `rate_floor` messages/minute from distinct senders, channel-wide soft rate-limit kicks in.
5. **Known-bot allowlist** — agent tokens (§7.5) bypass per-minute limits but obey per-hour caps.

All spam decisions logged to `spam_audit` (Redis stream, 7-day retention) for tuning.

32.6 Stage 4: classification

The classifier (running as a Watermill handler in `commons_messaging`) determines:

Item type (per Universal §11.4.16 + Project Herald subscriber-command vocabulary):

Inbound trigger	Type	Maps to
Bug: / Issue: / Issue: <prose>	bug	<code>docs/Issues.md</code> row + <code>digital.vasic.herald.project.task.opened</code>

Inbound trigger	Type	Maps to
Task:	task	same docs flow, different type column
Implementation: / Implement: / Feature:	implementation	same
Query: / Question: / Q: / ?	query	LLM-only path (no workable item — research/info request)
Request: / Req:	request	LLM-routed; outcome may produce a workable item if approved
Investigation: / Investigate:	investigation	intermediate state (§32.7)
Status:	status_request	reply with current state from docs/Status.md
Continue:	continuation_request	reply with docs/CONTINUATION.md pointer
Done: / Resolve: (operator role only)	closure	close workable item, migrate Issues→Fixed
Reopen: (operator role only)	reopen	per Universal §11.4.55 reopen flow
Ack: / Silence: / Snooze:	ops_command	per-flavor ops handlers
Spec:	spec_change_request	gated by §23 spec-change rule

Criticality (independent of type; required for bug, issue, task, implementation, investigation):

Level	Trigger	SLA
critical	explicit critical: prefix in subject line, OR LLM classifier confidence ≥ 0.85 on production-outage keywords	acknowledge within 5 min; first investigation within 1 h
high	explicit high: OR LLM 0.7–0.85	within 30 min; investigation within 4 h
middle	default	within 2 h; investigation within 24 h
low	explicit low: or nice-to-have:	within 24 h; investigation within 1 week

The classifier itself is **deterministic-first** (keyword/regex), falling back to LLM (§33) only when the deterministic step returns ambiguous. Operators MAY override classifications via `Override: HRD-NNN type=task criticality=high`.

32.7 Stage 5: Investigation-before-Fixing intermediate state

When a bug / issue / implementation arrives, Herald first creates an **Investigation workable item** (type investigation, status investigating), NOT the final bug/task row. The investigation:

1. Stores in `workable_items` table with type investigation and `parent_request` referencing the inbound message id.

2. Dispatches to the LLM (§33) for **reproducibility analysis** — can the LLM identify the affected code path? Reproduce locally? Estimate effort?
3. Stores LLM findings as a comment in docs/Investigations/<HRD-NNN>.md.

Once investigation concludes:

- **Validated** → Herald creates the *final* bug / task / implementation workable item, atomically migrates the investigation row to "investigation completed" status, links the new item via `parent_investigation`.
- **Cannot reproduce / not actionable** → investigation row stays; replies with reason + asks for more info; subscriber's follow-up reply re-runs the investigation.
- **Rejected (out of scope / duplicate / known)** → investigation closed with that reason; no final item created.

The investigation gate is a strong guard against runaway LLM-generated workable items.

32.8 Spam audit + observability

Per §17.2 the inbound pipeline emits:

- `herald_inbound_received_total{tenant,channel,outcome}` — outcome $\in$ `enqueued | rejected_validation | quarantined_safety | rate_limited | classified | dispatched | completed | failed`.
 - `herald_inbound_stage_duration_seconds{stage}` histogram.
 - `herald_inbound_classification{type,criticality,confidence_bucket}` counter.
 - `herald_spam_block_total{tenant,reason}` counter.
 - Span name `herald.inbound.process` with child spans per stage.
-

§33. LLM / agent dispatch

33.1 First target: Claude Code

V3's first LLM dispatch target is **Claude Code** (the Anthropic CLI). The dispatcher lives in `commons_messaging/dispatch/claude_code/`.

Design constraints:

- Claude Code sessions are scoped to a **working directory**, not a freestanding "name". V3 introduces a **project-named session resolution algorithm** (§33.2) that maps the consuming project's name to a stable working-directory anchor.
- The CLI is invoked in **non-interactive batch mode** for each request: `claude --resume <session> --print "<prompt>"`.
- Background invocation: Herald spawns the CLI in a separate process group with timeout (default 5 min); stdout is collected; non-zero exit becomes a `failed` stage with reason recorded.
- Concurrency: per-project session is single-writer (one in-flight Claude Code invocation at a time). Multiple inbound requests for the same project queue behind each other (River job priority preserves arrival order).

33.2 Session resolution algorithm

For project named ATMOSphere:

```
function resolve_session(project_name) -> session_id:
  1. compute working_dir = config[herald.session_workdir]
    (default: <consuming-project-root> discovered via parent-
walk)
  2. compute session_anchor_path = working_dir/.herald/claude-
code/sessions/<project_name>.session
  3. if session_anchor_path exists AND contains a session UUID
    AND `claude --resume <uuid> --print "ping"` returns 0:
    → return that UUID
  4. else:
    spawn `claude --print "Initializing Herald session for
project: <project_name>"`
    in working_dir
    capture the new session UUID emitted by Claude Code
stdout
    write UUID to session_anchor_path
    → return new UUID
```

The `.herald/claude-code/sessions/` directory is `.gitignore'd`. Session anchors persist across Herald restarts. Operators can manually reset by deleting the anchor file (next dispatch will create a fresh session).

33.3 Request envelope

Every dispatch sends a structured prompt:

```
<<<HERALD-DISPATCH-v1>>>
Project:      <project_name>
Inbound ID:   <UUIDv7>
Sender:       <channel>:<subscriber.handle> (verified: yes|no,
roles: [operator|reader|...])
Channel:      <ChannelID>
Received at:  <RFC 3339>
Classification: type=<type> criticality=<level>
confidence=<0.0-1.0>
Conversation: <thread-of-quoted-replies, full chain bottom-to-
top>
Attachments: [<name>:<mime>:<size_bytes>, ...]
```

User message:

<verbatim user text>

HERALD TASK (run in background along with mainstream work):

```
<task verb derived from classification>:
- For `bug`/`issue`/`investigation`: reproduce + identify affected
code paths +
```

- classify root-cause area + propose validation steps.
- For `query`/`question`: research + answer; cite project docs if relevant;
 - short answers preferred (subscribers see this directly).
- For `request`/`implementation`: scope effort + propose approach + flag prerequisites
 - + estimate workable-item dependencies.
- For `spec\_change\_request`: invoke Herald Constitution §106 spec-change rule.

Reply with a JSON object on a single line, prefixed with
`<<<HERALD-REPLY>>>`:

```
{
  "outcome": "validated"|"rejected"|"needs_more_info"|"answered",
  "summary": "<short summary for the subscriber>",
  "details": "<longer markdown body for the diary>",
  "affected_paths": [<file>:<line>", ...],           // optional
  "reproduction_steps": ["...", ...],                 // for bug/
investigation
  "estimated_effort": "S|M|L|XL",                     // for
request/implementation
  "workable_item_proposed": {                         // optional
    "type": "bug|task|implementation|investigation",
    "criticality": "critical|high|middle|low",
    "title": "...",
    "labels": ["..."]
  },
  "follow_up_questions": ["..."]                     // when
outcome=needs_more_info
}
```

DO NOT modify project files unless the subscriber explicitly asked you to.
DO NOT commit. DO NOT push.
<<<END-HERALD-DISPATCH>>>

Herald parses the <<<HERALD-REPLY>>> JSON line out of Claude Code's stdout, validates against the response schema, and proceeds to Stage 6 materialization.

33.4 Materialization (Stage 6)

Based on the outcome and workable_item_proposed:

- validated + workable_item_proposed → allocate next HRD-NNN, write to docs/Issues.md + emit digital.vasic.herald.project.task.opened (per §8.3 lifecycle) + link investigation parent (§32.7).
- answered (query/question) → no workable item; the reply IS the answer.
- needs_more_info → no workable item; reply asks subscriber for clarifications listed in follow_up_questions.
- rejected → no workable item; reply states rejection reason.

33.5 Other LLM/agent targets (spec hooks, V3+ implementation)

The dispatcher interface is provider-agnostic:

```
type Dispatcher interface {
    Name() string
    Capabilities() DispatcherCapabilities
    Dispatch(ctx context.Context, req DispatchRequest)
        (DispatchResponse, error)
}
```

V3 ships only `claude-code` dispatcher. Spec hooks reserved for:

- `opencode` — same CLI pattern.
- `aider` — file-modifying dispatcher (extra safety gates required; not enabled by default).
- `gemini-cli` — when GA.
- `cursor-cli` — pending product availability.
- `agentic-claude-api` — direct Anthropic API (Managed Agents) for hosted deployments where a CLI isn't desirable.

Operators select per-tenant via `[llm].default_agent`; per-classification-type override via `[llm.routing]` table.

§34. Reply protocol (queued → processing → result)

Every inbound message MUST receive **three replies** unless the inbound itself was rejected at Stage 1 (in which case one reply explaining the rejection).

34.1 Reply A — Queued ack

Within ≤ 5 s of receipt:

- Quote the original message (per-channel thread mechanic per §12 `ConversationRef`).
- Body: 📬 Received. Queued as `#INB-<short-id>`. I'll process this momentarily.
- Carries `Herald-Reply-Stage`: queued extension header for adapters that support custom headers.

34.2 Reply B — Processing started

Within ≤ 5 s of Stage 5 dispatch:

- Quote the original (same thread).
- Body: ⌚ Processing as `<classification.type>` (priority: `<criticality>`). Investigating...
- Edit-in-place where the channel supports it (Telegram `editMessageText`, Slack `chat.update`, Discord webhook edit); otherwise post a new message in the thread.

34.3 Reply C — Final result

Within the SLA window for the classified criticality (§32.6):

- Quote the original (same thread).
- Body varies by outcome:
 - **Validated + workable item created:**
✅ Created HRD-042 (bug, criticality=high). Investigation summary attached. Link: <Issues.md row anchor>. Repo: <git URL>
With multi-format attachment bundle per §36 containing the investigation summary.
 - **Answered (query):**
💡 <answer>
With cited documents attached as multi-format if relevant.
 - **Needs more info:**
❓ Need more detail: 1) <question> 2) <question>
 - **Rejected:**
🚫 <reason>. <suggested next step>.

34.4 Failure replies

If validation, safety, anti-spam, or classification fails:

- Quote the original message.
- Body: ❌ <stage>: <precise reason>. Details: <link-to-diary-entry-with-stack-trace>.
- Body MUST contain the exact rejection cause (not "internal error" — anti-bluff per Universal §11.4).
- Stage = failed in inbound_messages; original receipt is preserved.

Examples:

- ❌ validation: attachment 'malware.exe' exceeds size limit (30 MiB > 25 MiB max). Details: ...
- ❌ safety: attachment 'invoice.pdf' triggered ClamAV signature 'EICAR-Test-File'. Quarantined. Details: ...
- ❌ anti-spam: rate limit (12 msg/min) exceeded. Cooldown until <RFC 3339 UTC>. Details: ...
- ❌ classification: ambiguous type. Suggested prefixes: 'Bug:', 'Query:', 'Request:'. Details: ...

34.5 Per-channel quoting/edit-in-place matrix

Channel	Quote original	Edit-in-place (B → C)	Notes
Telegram	reply_to_message_id	editMessageText ✓	Reply B edited into Reply C if same message id
Slack	thread_ts (parent ts)	chat.update ✓	edits the queued ack

Channel	Quote original	Edit-in-place (B → C)	Notes
Discord	?thread_id= + webhook?wait=true	webhook edit ✓	requires bot token for non- webhook edit
MS Teams	message reference	Adaptive Card refresh × (per-message replacement only)	post new message in conversation
Lark	reply API	message edit ✓	
WhatsApp Cloud	context.message_id	not supported	post new message
Viber	tracking_data thread	not supported	post new message
Email	In-Reply-To + References headers	not supported	post new message in thread
ntfy	not natively threaded	not supported	new message with X-Tag: same-as- original
Diary	parent-id anchor	append + cross-link	

When edit-in-place is unavailable, Herald posts a NEW message and Reply B+C are distinct.

34.6 Configurable verbosity

Operators MAY tune reply verbosity per tenant via `[replies].verbosity = minimal | normal | verbose`:

- `minimal` — only Reply A (queued ack) + Reply C (final result); no Reply B.
- `normal` (default) — A + B + C as described.
- `verbose` — A + B + C + per-stage progress (Stage 3 done, Stage 4 done, ...).

§35. Reports + state-tracking documents (versioned fan-out with Git linkage)

Some events carry **reports that change over time** — security-scan summaries, build-status digests, weekly project digests, compliance reports. When a report's source document changes, Herald MUST re-publish to subscribers with the updated file attached + a link to the Git commit that introduced the change.

35.1 Report-aware event types

CloudEvents types under `digital.vasic.herald.report.*` are special:

- `.report.updated` — content changed since last publish.

- `.report.created` — first publish.
- `.report.archived` — no longer being maintained.

Each carries an `update_key` extension attribute (stable identifier for the report) so Herald can correlate updates with previous deliveries.

35.2 Update mechanic per channel

When a `.report.updated` event arrives:

Channel	Mechanism
Telegram	Send new message in the channel with the updated file attached + caption Updated: <code><git short-sha> - <commit message subject></code> . If channel supports <code>editMessageMedia</code> for original messages, edit in place; otherwise re-post.
Slack	Edit original message via <code>chat.update</code> (using <code>channel_msg_id</code> from <code>report_publications</code> table); attach new file via <code>files.upload</code> and reference.
Discord	Edit webhook message; attach updated file.
Teams	Post new Adaptive Card with <code>previousVersionRef</code> ; old card is left in place (no edit-in-place reliable).
Email	New message with In-Reply-To: <code><previous-Message-ID></code> + References chain; full updated attachment bundle.
Diary	Append new entry referencing previous; the report file at <code>docs/herald/reports/<update_key>/main.md</code> (and siblings) is the source of truth (overwritten on each update).

35.3 Git linkage

If the report's source `.md` is committed in the consuming project's repo, Herald includes:

- `git_commit_sha` — short SHA from `git log -1 --pretty=format:%h <file>` at publish time.
- `git_commit_url` — derived from `git remote get-url origin` + the commit SHA, formatted for the host (GitHub blob URL, GitLab blob URL, GitFlic/GitVerse equivalents).
- `git_diff_url` — URL to the diff against the previous publish's commit SHA.

If the source `.md` is NOT committed yet (working-tree only), Herald posts with a warning: ⚠ This report has uncommitted changes – link will become live once the change is committed.

35.4 Persistence

```
CREATE TABLE report_publications (
  id                UUID PRIMARY KEY DEFAULT uuidv7(),
  tenant_id         UUID NOT NULL,
  update_key        TEXT NOT NULL,
  -- stable identifier for the report
```

```

channel          TEXT NOT NULL,
channel_address_id UUID NOT NULL REFERENCES
    channel_addresses(id),
channel_msg_id    TEXT,                                -- so we
    can edit-in-place on next update
content_sha256    BYTEA NOT NULL,
    -- of the source .md
git_commit_sha    TEXT,                                --
    nullable for uncommitted
published_at      TIMESTAMPTZ NOT NULL DEFAULT now(),
UNIQUE (tenant_id, update_key, channel, channel_address_id)
);
ALTER TABLE report_publications ENABLE ROW LEVEL SECURITY;
ALTER TABLE report_publications FORCE ROW LEVEL SECURITY;
CREATE POLICY rp_isolation ON report_publications
    USING (tenant_id = current_setting('app.tenant_id')::uuid)
    WITH CHECK (tenant_id =
        current_setting('app.tenant_id')::uuid);

```

The (content_sha256, git_commit_sha) pair is the dedup key: if a re-publish event arrives but the source .md is byte-identical AND the commit SHA is the same, Herald skips the publish (logs digital.vasic.herald.report.noop).

§36. Outbound multi-format attachments (.md + .html + .pdf + .docx)

Every report, technical-documentation page, or research material that Herald sends as a subscriber-visible attachment **MUST** be attached in **four formats** so subscribers can pick the one they prefer for their use case.

36.1 Format set

Default [attachments].out_format_set = ["md", "html", "pdf", "docx"]. Per-channel overrides allowed via channel-address query param format_set=md,pdf (e.g. for bandwidth-constrained ntfy push).

36.2 Generation pipeline

For each source .md file Herald wants to attach:

```

source.md    (canonical, source of truth)
  ↓
pandoc -f gfm -t html5 -s -o source.html
  ↓
pandoc -f gfm --pdf-engine=weasyprint -o source.pdf
  ↓
pandoc -f gfm -o source.docx

```

docx generation requires Pandoc (already a dependency for HTML/PDF per §11.4.65); no extra runtime needed. WeasyPrint stays the PDF engine.

36.3 Pre-generation caching

Generation is deterministic — given the same source `.md`, the outputs are byte-stable (modulo PDF embedded timestamps, mitigated via Pandoc `--reproducible` flag in V3 r1).

Cache at `<diary_root>/herald/format-cache/<sha256-of-md>/`
`{source.md, source.html, source.pdf, source.docx, manifest.json}`.
Cache hit avoids regeneration.

36.4 Per-channel delivery rules

Channel	Delivery
Telegram	Four <code>sendDocument</code> calls in sequence (Telegram's bot API has no native "file group"); the order is <code>.md</code> , <code>.html</code> , <code>.pdf</code> , <code>.docx</code> so the most-readable preview surfaces first.
Slack	Single <code>files.upload_v2</code> with all four files referenced in one message; preview thumbnail = PDF.
Discord	Multiple file attachments on one webhook message (up to 10 per message; we use 4); embed shows PDF preview.
MS Teams	Adaptive Card with four <code>Action.OpenUrl</code> links to per-format URLs in a Herald-hosted blob (channel doesn't support multi-file attachment natively).
Lark	Multi-file upload in one message.
WhatsApp Cloud	One message per file (WA Business doesn't support multi-attachment messages).
Viber	Carousel of links.
Email	One MIME multipart message with four <code>application/...</code> parts, each <code>Content-Disposition: attachment</code> and <code>filename="report.<ext>"</code> .
ntfy	Posts the <code>.md</code> inline; the other three via X-Attach URLs to Herald-hosted blobs.
Gotify	Same as ntfy.
Webhook (outbound)	CloudEvents payload with four <code>data_base64</code> entries OR four URLs depending on <code>attachment_mode</code> query param.
Diary	All four written to <code>docs/herald/diary/attachments/<message_id>/</code> and referenced from the diary entry.

36.5 Format-set override per subscriber

Subscribers MAY express format preferences via `PreferenceSet.metadata.attachment_formats` (per §7.2):

```
{
  "attachment_formats": ["md", "pdf"]    // only these two; skip
html + docx
}
```

If a subscriber's preference excludes a format that another subscriber on the same channel-address wants, Herald sends the union (or the channel's max bundle if multi-attachment is supported). On channels that allow only one attachment per message (WhatsApp, Viber), Herald sends per-subscriber DM with that subscriber's preferred format.

36.6 Total size limits

Combined size of the four formats per attachment-bundle MUST stay under `[attachments].out_bundle_max_mib` (default 50 MiB). If a single source `.md` produces > 50 MiB of total output (rare — typically only image-heavy reports), Herald posts a single message with a link to a Herald-hosted blob carrying the full bundle.

§37. Tracker-doc change events (Issues / Fixed / Status / Continuation)

Operator mandate (2026-05-20): any modification of constitution-defined tracker documents MUST fire CloudEvents that fan out to all configured channels for all subscribed receivers. Subscribers see project state evolve in real time, not on the next digest cycle.

37.1 In-scope tracker docs

Every modification under `<consuming-project>/docs/` of any of these files triggers a CloudEvent (the same list as Universal §11.4.60's eight bound classes):

Doc	Triggers event type
<code>docs/Issues.md</code>	<code>digital.vasic.herald.tracker.issues.updated</code>
<code>docs/Issues_Summary.md</code>	<code>digital.vasic.herald.tracker.issues_summary.updated</code>
<code>docs/Fixed.md</code>	<code>digital.vasic.herald.tracker.fixed.updated</code>
<code>docs/Fixed_Summary.md</code>	<code>digital.vasic.herald.tracker.fixed_summary.updated</code>
<code>docs/Status.md</code>	<code>digital.vasic.herald.tracker.status.updated</code>
<code>docs/Status_Summary.md</code>	<code>digital.vasic.herald.tracker.status_summary.updated</code>
<code>docs/CONTINUATION.md</code>	<code>digital.vasic.herald.tracker.continuation.updated</code>
<code>docs/Reopens/<HRD-NNN>.md</code>	<code>digital.vasic.herald.tracker.reopens.updated</code>

Plus the high-fidelity item-level events that compose with §4.2:

Item-level event	Fired by
<code>digital.vasic.herald.project.task.opened</code>	

Item-level event	Fired by
	Row added under Issues.md Open section
digital.vasic.herald.project.task.in_progress	Row's Status column transitions to in_progress
digital.vasic.herald.project.task.blocked	Row's Status transitions to blocked or operator-blocked
digital.vasic.herald.project.task.closed	Row migrates atomically from Issues.md to Fixed.md
digital.vasic.herald.project.task.reopened	Row migrates from Fixed.md back to Issues.md (per Universal §11.4.55)
digital.vasic.herald.project.task.reclassified	Type or criticality column changes in place

37.2 Detection mechanism

<flavor>herald serve runs an fsnotify-watched debounced (500 ms idle, 2 s ceiling) tracker-doc watcher over <consuming-project>/docs/. On every observed change:

1. Hash the file's new content (SHA-256).
2. Compare to tracker_state.content_sha256 (a per-doc row in the new tracker_state table — schema below).
3. If new SHA differs, parse the file (Markdown table → row diff) to detect which rows changed; emit one **doc-level** event (always) plus one **item-level** event per row delta (when the diff is parseable).
4. Persist new SHA + last_emitted_at.

-- §37.2 tracker_state (added to migrations as a future
000006_tracker_state.up.sql)

```
CREATE TABLE IF NOT EXISTS tracker_state (
  tenant_id      UUID NOT NULL,
  doc_path       TEXT NOT NULL,
  content_sha256 BYTEA NOT NULL,
  last_event_id  UUID,
  last_emitted_at TIMESTAMPTZ NOT NULL DEFAULT now(),
  PRIMARY KEY (tenant_id, doc_path)
);
ALTER TABLE tracker_state ENABLE ROW LEVEL SECURITY;
ALTER TABLE tracker_state FORCE ROW LEVEL SECURITY;
CREATE POLICY ts_isolation ON tracker_state
```

```
USING (tenant_id = current_setting('app.tenant_id')::uuid)
WITH CHECK (tenant_id =
    current_setting('app.tenant_id')::uuid);
```

37.3 Fan-out

Each tracker-doc event is routed via the standard §6 channel-addresses + tag-fan-out matching pipeline. By default tracker events carry the tag `tracker` so operators can scope subscribers per category:

- `tracker:issues` — subscribers who want every `Issues.md` change (verbose).
- `tracker:fixed` — closure announcements only.
- `tracker:status` — high-level state changes.
- `tracker:incidents` — `Issues/Fixed` entries with `Type=incident` only.

Subscribers opt in via `PreferenceSet.categories.tracker_*` (spec §7.2). The default for new tenants is `tracker:fixed` enabled, others muted — so subscribers aren't flooded by every in-progress edit.

37.4 Composition

- **§11.4.60 composite always-sync** — §37 is the *event-emission* layer; §11.4.60 ensures the `.md/.html/.pdf` siblings stay in sync. They're orthogonal but complementary: §11.4.60 prevents stale renders, §37 prevents stale subscriber awareness.
 - **§35 versioned reports** — `.report.*` events are a *subset* of §37: any report doc that also lives in a tracker file gets BOTH a §37 tracker event AND a §35 report event (with shared `update_key`).
 - **§32 inbound pipeline** — §37 events are pure-outbound; they don't go through the inbound worker pipeline.
-

§38. Workable-item announcement contract

Operator mandate (2026-05-20): when a new workable item is added, send an announcement to all subscribers with: title, short description, and attachments — inline when small enough for the channel, otherwise via direct URL to the Git host's permalink. Whenever channel-side size constraints make the inline attachment infeasible, fall back to a URL pointing at the canonical attachment under `issues/users/attachments/<HRD-NNN>/<filename>` on the project's Git remote (GitHub / GitLab / GitFlic / GitVerse).

38.1 Announcement structure

Every `digital.vasic.herald.project.task.opened` event triggers a per-subscriber announcement message containing:

[<flavor icon>] <criticality badge> <Type>: <HRD-NNN> – <Title
(≤ 100 chars)>

<Short description (≤ 280 chars, single paragraph)>

📎 Attachments: <inline summary OR list of permalinks>

🔗 Permalink: <Git host URL of the Issues.md row's anchor>

👤 Opened by: <subscriber.handle> on <channel>

🕒 <RFC 3339 timestamp>

The <flavor icon> is the flavor's emoji (📄 pherald, 📄 sherald, 🛠 bherald, 🚀 dherald, 🔔 aherald, 📄 scherald, 📄 iherald, 📄 rherald, 📄 cherald).

The <criticality badge> is colored / emoji-coded: 📄 critical, 🟡 high, 🟢 middle, 🟠 low.

38.2 Attachment size policy

For each attachment associated with the new workable item, Herald computes per-channel inline-feasibility:

Channel	Inline-feasible if attachment ≤	Fallback
Telegram	50 MiB (Bot API limit per file)	Permalink
Slack	1 GiB (workspace plan-dependent; default soft-cap 100 MiB)	Permalink
Discord	25 MiB (free tier) / 100 MiB (Nitro) — Herald uses 25 MiB	Permalink
MS Teams	10 MiB (webhook restriction)	Permalink
Lark	30 MiB	Permalink
WhatsApp Cloud	16 MiB (image) / 100 MiB (document)	Permalink
Viber	200 MiB	Permalink
Email (SMTP)	[attachments].email_inline_max_mib (default 10 MiB)	Permalink
ntfy	X-Attach URL only — always permalink	Permalink
Gotify	extras link only — always permalink	Permalink
Webhook outbound	per-receiver — defaults to permalink	Permalink
Diary	always inline (filesystem-local)	n/a

Permalink construction. Herald reads the project's git remote get-url origin and derives the host's permalink format:

Host	URL pattern
GitHub	https://github.com/<org>/<repo>/blob/<sha>/issues/users/attachments/<HRD-NNN>/<filename>
GitLab	https://gitlab.com/<org>/<repo>/-/blob/<sha>/issues/users/attachments/<HRD-NNN>/<filename>
GitFlic	https://gitflic.ru/project/<org>/<repo>/blob/<sha>/issues/users/attachments/<HRD-NNN>/<filename>

Host	URL pattern
GitVerse	<code>https://gitverse.ru/<org>/<repo>/content/<sha>/issues/users/attachments/<HRD-NNN>/<filename></code>

The `<sha>` is captured at announcement time so the URL remains valid even after subsequent commits.

Uncommitted-attachments fallback. If the attachment hasn't been committed yet (working-tree only), the announcement includes the inline file PLUS a notice: ⚠ Attachment not yet committed – permalink will become live once the next commit lands. Subscribers can still receive the inline payload; the warning is for traceability.

38.3 Multi-format bundle composition

Per §36, every outbound Herald-produced attachment ships as a four-format bundle (`.md` + `.html` + `.pdf` + `.docx`). For *subscriber-uploaded* attachments (the ones at `issues/users/attachments/<HRD-NNN>/`), the multi-format expansion is **NOT** applied — those files are sent as-is in their original format (per §18.2.4). Only Herald-generated documents (investigation summaries, reports, weekly digests) get the multi-format bundle.

38.4 Status-transition follow-up announcements

Every subsequent transition (`task.in_progress` / `task.blocked` / `task.closed` / `task.reopened` / `task.reclassified`) fires a smaller follow-up announcement in the same thread (per §12 ConversationRef):

```
[<flavor icon>] HRD-NNN → <new status> <transition reason /
short note>
🔗 <permalink>
```

Subscribers MAY mute these via `PreferenceSet.workflows...transitions = { muted: true }`.

§39. Message presentation + template standards

Operator mandate (2026-05-20): messages sent to subscribers MUST be properly designed, nicely and clearly written, organized — AND adhere to **standardized templates** with strict rules.

39.1 Why standardize

Herald sends thousands of messages a day at scale. Even tiny stylistic drift between channels (different emoji choices, different field-order, different "permalink" wording) creates cognitive friction for subscribers who scan messages in seconds. §39 fixes the templates so every flavor + channel combination renders predictably; operators can tune *content* per tenant but the *shape* is constitution-level.

39.2 The Herald canonical template (HCT)

Every outbound subscriber-facing message is composed of FIVE blocks, in this order:

- [1] HEADER – flavor icon + criticality badge + type + ID + title (one line ≤ 100 chars)
- [2] LEAD – short paragraph (≤ 280 chars). One thought; one CTA implied.
- [3] DETAILS – optional. Key:value pairs, bullet lists, code blocks (well-fenced).
- [4] ATTACHMENTS – optional. Inline thumbnails OR permalinks (per §38.2).
- [5] FOOTER – opened-by + timestamp + permalink + ``<flavor>herald <version>`` attribution.

When the channel supports rich messaging (Slack Block Kit, Discord embeds, Adaptive Cards), each block maps to a native rich-message element; on plain channels (SMS, ntfy text-only), blocks degrade to delimited plain text.

39.3 Standardized template files

All templates live under `commons_messaging/templates/<event_type>/<channel>.tpl` (per §13). The directory MUST follow this structure:

```
commons_messaging/templates/
├── _shared/
│   ├── header.tpl           # HCT block 1
│   ├── lead.tpl             # HCT block 2
│   ├── details.tpl          # HCT block 3
│   ├── attachments.tpl      # HCT block 4
│   └── footer.tpl           # HCT block 5
├── digital.vasic.herald.project.task.opened/
│   ├── tgram.md.tpl
│   ├── slack.json.tpl       # Block Kit JSON
│   ├── discord.json.tpl     # Embed JSON
│   ├── teams.json.tpl       # Adaptive Card v1.5
│   ├── email.mjml           # MJML source
│   └── email.html           # compiled MJML (committed
alongside source)
│   ├── ntfy.txt.tpl
│   ├── diary.md.tpl
│   └── meta.toml             # per-template metadata: i18n
keys, helper imports, max-length asserts
└── digital.vasic.herald.tracker.issues.updated/
    └── ...
```

39.4 Mandatory template properties

Each `meta.toml` declares (and Herald's CI gate CM-TEMPLATE-CONFORMANCE, planned, enforces):

Property	Required	Notes
event_type	yes	matches the parent directory
channels	yes	array of channels the template directory covers — gate flags missing channels
i18n_keys	yes	list of locale keys this template references; missing translations FAIL the gate
header_max_chars	yes	hard cap on HCT block 1 — default 100; SMS-style channels override to 70
lead_max_chars	yes	hard cap on HCT block 2 — default 280
body_max_chars	yes	hard cap on full rendered body before truncation
attachment_policy	yes	`inline`
helpers	no	additional Sprig / custom helpers the template needs

39.5 Style rules (constitution-level)

Templates **MUST** follow these style rules (CM-TEMPLATE-STYLE gate, planned):

1. **One emoji per block** — header may have flavor-icon + criticality-badge; otherwise emojis are atomic.
2. **Sentence case** — no SCREAMING headlines except for 🚨 CRITICAL badges.
3. **Active voice** in the lead — "Build failed" not "A build has been failed by".
4. **Past-tense in event-confirmation messages, present-tense in status-update messages** — keeps tense aligned with the event semantics.
5. **No clipping mid-word** — body truncation always happens at a clause boundary; ellipsis (...) marks the cut.
6. **i18n-safe** — no string concatenation; only `{{tr "key" .Param}}` calls.
7. **No raw user input in HTML / shell context** — template **MUST** use the auto-escaping `html/template` or `text/template` per channel (spec §15.3).
8. **Permalink wording is always "🔗 Permalink:"** — never "Link:", "URL:", "See:", etc.
9. **Timestamps are RFC 3339 with explicit timezone** — never relative ("5 minutes ago") because diary entries lose context over time.
10. **Universal <flavor>herald <version> attribution in the footer** — operators can suppress for white-label deployments via `[branding].suppress_footer=true`.

39.6 Per-channel rendering tiers

Tier	Channels	HCT mapping
Rich (interactive)	Slack, Discord, Telegram, Teams, Lark, WhatsApp Cloud, Viber	Header → emphasised header element + criticality color; Lead → top text; Details → fields/blocks; Attachments → file attachments + previews; Footer → context block.
Rich (read-only)	Email (HTML), Gotify, ntfy with X-Markdown	Same blocks, no interactive components.

Tier	Channels	HCT mapping
Plain	Email (plain), SMS-like channels, generic webhook with <code>format=text</code>	Blocks delimited by <code>\n\n</code> ; emojis preserved; no rich formatting.
Structured	Webhook with <code>format=cloudevent</code>	Blocks serialised as JSON fields in the CloudEvent data payload.
Source	Diary	Markdown source — no transformation.

39.7 Template-evolution discipline

Changes to templates follow the §23 spec-change rule when they alter the HCT block layout. Pure copy edits (typos, i18n additions, color hex tweaks) DO NOT trigger the spec-change rule — they're catalogued in `docs/changelogs/templates/` (per Universal §11.4.18 script-companion-doc parallel) and audited by the template-conformance gate.

§40. Documentation + testing completeness mandate

Operator mandate (2026-05-20): everything MUST be fully documented and covered with all possible test types and challenges.

40.1 Documentation completeness

Every module, package, type, and exported function MUST carry documentation. The CI gate CM-DOC-COVERAGE (planned) enforces:

Surface	Required documentation
Every <code>commons*</code> package	Package-level <code>// Package <name> doc.go</code> OR top-of-file comment naming the spec section it implements.
Every exported type	One-paragraph godoc that names purpose + invariants + spec section.
Every exported function/method	godoc with parameters, return semantics, error conditions, spec section.
Every SQL migration	Header comment with spec section reference + rationale + irreversibility notes (if any).
Every CLI subcommand	Short, Long, per-flag Description; <code>--help</code> output is the source of truth for operators.
Every channel adapter	<code>docs/channels/<channel>/setup.md</code> with credential acquisition steps, webhook setup, troubleshooting.
Every flavor	<code>docs/flavors/<flavor>/<flavor>.md</code> with use cases, command palette, channel-interaction matrix.
Every Universal Constitution composition	The package/function MUST comment which Universal §X.Y mandate it implements.

Surface	Required documentation
Every channel adapter test fixture	testdata/README.md documenting recording conditions + redaction policy.

CM-DOC-COVERAGE is run by `go vet ./... extension` + a custom golangci-lint analyzer.

40.2 Test-type matrix

Herald MUST ship eight test tiers (per Universal §11.4.27 no-fakes-beyond-unit-tests + §11.4.39 per-feature on-device end-user validation):

Tier	Build tag	Required for	What it covers
Unit	(none)	every PR	pure-logic tests, no external services, in-memory mocks only of commons interfaces
Component	component	every PR	one module's exported surface against its own real dependencies (e.g. commons_storage against a real Postgres started via testcontainers-go)
Integration	integration	every PR (CI-only)	cross-module flows: pherald send → router → null:// adapter against real Postgres + Redis + River
Contract	contract	every PR	adapter tests against recorded HTTP fixtures (go-vcr cassettes) — proves the SDK invocation is byte-stable
End-to-end (sandbox)	e2e_sandbox	nightly CI	per-channel sandboxes: Telegram test bot, Slack test workspace, Email IMAP IDLE against a test mailbox
End-to-end (live)	e2e_live	release-gated	live bot tokens in a dedicated test tenant; runs against the published image
Mutation	mutation	every release	Universal §1.1 paired-mutation tests for every gate — anti-bluff invariant
Chaos	chaos	nightly	null:// fail_rate + latency-injection + worker-pool starvation + Postgres connection-storm

40.3 Test challenges (per Universal §11.4.39 + spec §40)

Beyond test tiers, Herald MUST ship **named challenges** — scenarios that exercise the boundaries of correctness:

- **C-01. 30-second poll cadence enforcement** — slow upstream means `getUpdates` long-poll occasionally stalls; the safety-net timer (§32.2) MUST fire `getUpdates` exactly at the 30 s mark. Test inserts an artificial stall + asserts second invocation.
- **C-02. FIFO under contention** — 100 inbound messages from 10 senders on one channel; assert per-sender processing order is preserved.
- **C-03. Anti-spam thresholds** — burst of 100 similar messages from one sender; assert reputation drops + quarantine triggers after threshold; assert legitimate senders unaffected.
- **C-04. Investigation-before-Fixing rejection path** — submit a duplicate Bug: for an already-fixed issue; assert LLM rejects + no new workable item; assert subscriber reply explains reason.
- **C-05. Attachment-size threshold** — submit attachment exactly at the channel limit, +1 byte, +1 MiB; assert correct inline vs permalink fallback.
- **C-06. Multi-format bundle determinism** — generate same source `.md` twice with `--reproducible`; assert byte-identical outputs.
- **C-07. RLS bypass attempt** — assert that omitting `SET LOCAL app.tenant_id` in a transaction yields zero rows on every multi-tenant table (fails closed).
- **C-08. Graceful shutdown drain** — fire 50 in-flight Sends, send `SIGTERM`, assert all 50 complete within `HERALD_SHUTDOWN_GRACE`; second `SIGTERM` forces immediate exit.
- **C-09. Tracker-doc fsnotify debounce** — write to `Issues.md` 12 times within 100 ms; assert exactly ONE `...tracker.issues.updated` event fires, not 12.
- **C-10. Idempotency replay** — POST the same `CloudEvent` twice with same idempotency key; assert second POST returns the cached response, NOT a duplicate fan-out.
- **C-11. Cross-channel reply threading** — Slack thread reply → Telegram-mirror message; assert both link back to the same `logical_thread_id`.
- **C-12. Channel-credential rotation mid-flight** — rotate Telegram bot token during a 30 s send burst; assert pending sends complete with old token, new sends use new token, no message loss.
- **C-13. Template style-rule violation** — submit a template containing emoji in two HCT blocks; assert `CM-TEMPLATE-STYLE` gate FAILs.
- **C-14. Investigation LLM timeout** — Claude Code session hangs > 5 min; assert Herald cancels, posts failed reply with reason, opens `HRD-INV` row as `operator-blocked`.
- **C-15. Disaster-recovery cold-start** — destroy Postgres + Redis containers; restore from latest backup; assert dead-letters table contents survive; assert in-flight messages replayed without duplicates.

40.4 Documentation MUST-include per file class

Each file class carries a documentation responsibility:

File	Doc must include
*.go	godoc per §40.1 + spec section reference in package comment

File	Doc must include
*.sql	header with migration number, spec section, rationale, idempotency notes
Dockerfile*	layer-by-layer rationale + build / runtime separation explained
docker-compose*.yaml	bring-up instructions + assumed env vars + verification commands
*.tmpl	il8n-key inventory + max-length asserts + HCT block boundaries marked with comments
tests/*.sh	mandatory header explaining: what the gate checks, what the paired mutation does, exit code semantics
*.md	Universal §11.4.61 metadata table + ToC (when ≥ 2 H2s) + Universal §11.4.65 export siblings

40.5 Composition

§40 doesn't replace existing testing rules; it expands them:

- Universal §11.4.27 no-fakes-beyond-unit-tests is INHERITED — V3 doesn't loosen it.
- Universal §11.4.39 per-feature end-user validation MAPS to tier `e2e_live` here.
- Universal §11.4.2 captured-evidence applies to every tier $\geq$ component (recorded outputs MUST be attached to CI artefacts).
- Universal §1.1 paired-mutation tests are the `mutation` tier.

The §40 mandate is intentionally aspirational — V3 r1 ships the spec; V3 implementation lands the test tiers progressively per the HRD-008..HRD-015 first-implementation cycle. The CM-DOC-COVERAGE and CM-TEMPLATE-CONFORMANCE gates land alongside the modules they cover.

§41. REST API surface (Gin Gonic)

Operator mandate (2026-05-20): every Herald flavor — where it makes sense for that flavor — MUST expose a REST API for triggering commands that operators would otherwise issue via the CLI. The REST surface lets applications (web UIs, mobile apps, third-party orchestrators) integrate with Herald without spawning subprocess invocations. The standard framework is **Gin Gonic** (github.com/gin-gonic/gin).

41.1 Which flavors expose REST

Flavor	REST?	Rationale
pherald (Project Herald)	✓ yes	Highest integration surface — IDE plugins, web dashboards, AI agents call REST to open investigations, fetch workable items, post replies.
	✓ yes	

Flavor	REST?	Rationale
sherald (System Herald)		Monitoring stacks (Grafana / Datadog / OpsGenie integrations) push events via REST instead of synthetic webhooks.
bherald (Build Herald)	✓ yes	CI tools without native webhook support call REST.
dherald (Deploy Herald)	✓ yes	Deploy orchestrators trigger rollback / hold / promote via REST.
aherald (Alert Herald)	✓ yes	Alert routers post events; subscribers (or front-ends) query open-alerts state.
scherald (Schedule Herald)	✓ yes	Reminder UIs create / snooze / cancel reminders.
iherald (Incident Herald)	✓ yes	Incident-management UIs page on-call, take IC, post updates.
rherald (Release Herald)	✓ yes	Release dashboards.
cherald (Compliance Herald)	✓ yes	Audit dashboards + IR tools.
Future flavors	per-flavor	Decided when each flavor is specified.

Every yes-flavor exposes `/v1/...` HTTP routes through Gin. **Flavors MAY opt out** of REST only when no realistic app/integration consumer exists — operators **MUST** justify the opt-out in the flavor's manual.

41.2 Framework: Gin Gonic

Why Gin — actively maintained (~80k stars), httprouter under the hood (so latency is ~5× lower than net/http defaults for high-fanout APIs), middleware ecosystem already covers OTel + CORS + rate-limit + recovery, idiomatic for Go developers reading Herald source. Alternatives (chi, echo, fiber) were considered; Gin wins on operator familiarity and the existing OTel + Prometheus middleware quality.

Dependency: `github.com/gin-gonic/gin` pinned via each flavor's `go.mod`. The Gin handler hand-off into `commons_messaging.Router` keeps adapter code Gin-agnostic — only the flavor's `internal/http/` wires Gin into the router.

41.3 Endpoint surface (common across all REST-enabled flavors)

Mounted under `/v1/` per spec §5.7 (REST is the *same* ingress port — `[server].http_port`, default 24091; the HTTP surface IS the REST API plus webhooks).

Method	Path	Behaviour
POST	<code>/v1/events</code>	CloudEvents v1.0 ingest (binary + structured) — same as §5.7.

Method	Path	Behaviour
POST	/v1/send	Convenience REST ingest (non-CloudEvents JSON body, wrapped server-side).
GET	/v1/events/{id}	Idempotent replay; 200 with cached response, 409 on body-mismatch.
GET	/v1/items	List workable items (paginated, filterable by status, type, criticality).
GET	/v1/items/{id}	Single workable item with full Markdown row + linked investigation + attachments.
POST	/v1/items	Open a new workable item (operator role required — alternative to Bug:/Issue: subscriber commands).
PATCH	/v1/items/{id}	Update status / type / criticality.
POST	/v1/items/{id}/close	Migrate row from Issues.md → Fixed.md (per §8.3).
POST	/v1/items/{id}/reopen	Reverse migration (per Universal §11.4.55).
POST	/v1/items/{id}/attachments	Upload an attachment (multipart) — Herald validates per §32.4 + stores at issues/users/attachments/<HRD-NNN>/.
GET	/v1/subscribers / POST /v1/subscribers	Subscriber CRUD.
GET	/v1/channels	List configured channel addresses (filtered by enabled/tag).
GET	/v1/deadletters / POST /v1/deadletters/{id}/replay	Dead-letter management.
GET	/v1/status	Same payload as docs/ Status_Summary.md machine-readable JSON.
GET	/v1/healthz	Public-facing health (composite of /livez + /readyz).
Per-flavor	/v1/<flavor>/...	Flavor-specific endpoints (e.g. /v1/incident/{id}/take-ic on iherald; /v1/build/{id}/retry on bherald).

41.4 Authentication

Reuses the §5.7 auth model:

- HTTP Basic with per-tenant ingest_token (for simple integrations).
- JWT bearer (Authorization: Bearer ...) validated against JWKS in [auth.oidc] (for OAuth-integrated apps).
- mTLS via reverse proxy (for high-security deployments).

REST endpoints requiring operator role check claims for roles: ["operator"] in the JWT (or look up the API key's owning subscriber's subscribers.roles).

41.5 Versioning

Same as §5.7 — /v1/ is the stable contract; breaking changes ship as /v2/ with ≥ 6 months of /v1/ co-existence. OpenAPI spec at docs/api/openapi.v1.yaml is the source of truth; CI gate CM-OPENAPI-DRIFT enforces handler [\[?\]](#) spec parity per §24.1.

41.6 Containerization mandate (composes with §9.5)

Reinforced operator mandate (2026-05-20): every flavor binary MUST be distributed as a container image built via the containers Submodule (per V3 §9.5). The submodule provides:

- Per-flavor Dockerfile (multi-stage, distroless or alpine runtime).
- Compose / Kubernetes / Nomad manifests at the per-flavor reference deployment.
- Reproducible-build flags (CGO_ENABLED=0, GOFLAGS=-trimpath, deterministic -ldflags).
- SBOM + cosign signatures per V3 §21.

Operators MAY use containers/quickstart/Dockerfile.pherald (shipped in this commit at HRD-008) as a *local development bridge* until the containers Submodule is added; once the submodule lands, the quickstart files migrate there and Herald's containers/ directory becomes a thin pointer.

41.7 OpenAPI generation

Per §24.1, docs/api/openapi.v1.yaml is the source-of-truth schema. Gin-based REST handlers MUST be tagged with openapi:"<operation_id>" comments (custom golangci-lint analyzer herald-openapi-tags will enforce); the spec generator scans tags + handler signatures to keep YAML and code in lockstep. Drift triggers CM-OPENAPI-DRIFT gate FAIL.

41.8 Per-app integration patterns

Two recommended integration patterns documented in docs/integrations/:

- **Embedded SDK** — apps in Go vendor the relevant Herald client (planned: clients/go/); other languages call REST directly. SDK generators from the OpenAPI spec are documented (TypeScript via openapi-typescript, Python via openapi-python-client).
- **Reverse-proxy fan-out** — apps mount Herald's REST under their own /api/herald/* namespace, applying app-side auth before forwarding.

pherald r1 ships REST scaffolding under pherald/internal/http/ (planned in HRD-016 follow-up — not in this V3 r2 commit; the Go binary currently exposes only CLI surface, with HTTP wiring deferred to the implementation cycle).

§42. Constitution-flavor binding catalogue

Operator mandate (2026-05-20): every Helix Universal Constitution rule that produces a *runtime-observable state change* in a governed project **MUST** be bound to the natural Herald flavor that owns it — so subscribers learn about violations, transitions, and compliance state through the same channels they already use for project events. Process-only rules (agent self-discipline like §11.4.6 no-guessing, §11.4.20 subagent-by-default) are deliberately excluded; binding them adds noise without value.

§42 is the **single canonical mapping** from constitution clauses to Herald event types + owning flavors. It composes with §37 (tracker-doc events), §32 (inbound pipeline), and §34 (reply protocol).

42.1 Binding architecture (event envelope, mode ladder, replayability)

Synthesised from a deep survey of how real governance systems emit events (OPA Gatekeeper, OPA Decision Logs, Kyverno PolicyReports, AWS CloudTrail + Config Rules, GCP Cloud Audit Logs, GitHub branch-protection, NIST SSDF, SLSA VSA, Sigstore policy-controller, Anthropic Constitutional Classifiers). Five design rules are universal across all of them:

§42.1.1 Three-axis envelope. Every constitution-rule event carries the triple (rule_id, severity_category, decision_result). These are the three minimum required CloudEvent extension attributes on digital.vasic.herald.constitution.* events:

Extension attribute	Example	Notes
heraldconstitutionrule	§11.4.10	Stable rule identifier; matches the §X.Y reference in Constitution.md.
heraldconstitutionseverity	critical/ high/middle/ low	Per spec §18.2.2 criticality vocabulary.
heraldconstitutiondecision	pass/warn/ fail/error/ skip	Kyverno-aligned (scored=false ⇒ warn).

The CloudEvents type is the **event class**, not the rule ID — e.g. digital.vasic.herald.constitution.gate.failed carries heraldconstitutionrule=§11.4.61 as an attribute, NOT in the type itself. This keeps the event-type tree finite (~12 leaf classes) and lets routers fan out by rule via filter expressions without exploding subject namespaces.

§42.1.2 Transitions, not states. Herald **MUST** emit a constitution-rule event **ONLY** on state *change* — pass → fail, fail → pass, unknown → fail. Continuous "still compliant" pings are forbidden; they drown the audit channel and train operators to mute it. This mirrors AWS Config's Config Rules Compliance Change event (which carries both newEvaluationResult and

previousEvaluationResult) and Kyverno's summary transitions.
Implementation: every rule-evaluation result is hashed and stored in a Postgres constitution_state table; events fire only when the hash changes.

```
-- §42.1.2 constitution_state (planned
000006_constitution_state.up.sql).
CREATE TABLE IF NOT EXISTS constitution_state (
  tenant_id      UUID NOT NULL,
  rule_id        TEXT NOT NULL,
  subject        TEXT NOT NULL,
  last_decision   TEXT NOT NULL,
  last_evaluated_at TIMESTAMPTZ NOT NULL DEFAULT now(),
  last_event_id   UUID,
  PRIMARY KEY (tenant_id, rule_id, subject)
);
ALTER TABLE constitution_state ENABLE ROW LEVEL SECURITY;
ALTER TABLE constitution_state FORCE ROW LEVEL SECURITY;
CREATE POLICY cs_isolation ON constitution_state
  USING (tenant_id = current_setting('app.tenant_id')::uuid)
  WITH CHECK (tenant_id =
    current_setting('app.tenant_id')::uuid);
```

§42.1.3 Constitution-bundle hash (replayability). Every constitution-rule event MUST carry the `heraldconstitutionbundle.sha` extension — the SHA-256 of the rendered `Constitution.md` at the time of evaluation. This is the `OPA-Decision-Logs bundles` field and the `SLSA-VSA policy.digest`: without it, "rule §X said deny at T" is unreplayable a year later when the constitution has moved on. The bundle hash is captured at *evaluation* time, not *event-emission* time, so even if Herald itself fails over mid-stream the receiver can still verify which constitution revision produced the verdict.

§42.1.4 Mode ladder (allow / warn / enforce). Every binding declares a mode per tenant:

- `allow` — evaluator runs, decision is computed, NO event fires. Used during initial rollout to gather baseline data.
- `warn` — events fire on fail/warn outcomes but routed to non-paging channels (digest / diary only; never SMS / page-out).
- `enforce` — events fire to all configured channels per §6 tag-fan-out; high-severity failures may page on-call.

The ladder mirrors Gatekeeper's `enforcementAction` field, Sigstore policy-controller's modes, and Anthropic's auto-mode safety thresholds. Operators MUST be able to roll a new binding through `allow` → `warn` → `enforce` without redeploying. Storage: per-binding row in `constitution_bindings` table (planned 000007_constitution_bindings.up.sql).

§42.1.5 Push + pull surfaces. Per the research (Gatekeeper CR status is pull; Gatekeeper log line is push; GitHub PR comment is push; GitHub branch-protection settings query is pull), Herald maintains BOTH:

- **Push** — CloudEvents on `digital.vasic.herald.constitution.*` topic fanned out to subscribed channels per the standard §6 + §32 pipeline.
- **Pull** — REST endpoint per §41 mounted at `/v1/compliance` on every REST-enabled flavor. Returns the current `constitution_state` rows for the calling tenant + pagination + filter (`?rule=§11.4.10, ?subject=docs/Issues.md, ?decision=fail`).

The pull surface lets auditors snapshot compliance posture without subscribing to fan-out; the push surface lets engineers learn about regressions in their channel of choice.

42.2 Canonical event-class taxonomy

CloudEvents type is one of these twelve leaf classes under `digital.vasic.herald.constitution.*`:

Event type	When emitted	Owning flavor (default)
<code>.gate.failed</code>	a CI/pre-commit gate keyed on a constitution rule FAILs (e.g. CM-DOC-REVISION-HEADER-PRESENT)	bherald (CI) or cherald (deep audit)
<code>.gate.recovered</code>	the same gate transitions back to PASS	same as <code>.gate.failed</code>
<code>.policy.violation</code>	a runtime evaluator detects a violation (e.g. naming rule §11.4.29, file-layout §11.4.11)	cherald
<code>.policy.cleared</code>	a previously-violating subject now passes	cherald
<code>.host.safety_breach</code>	a §12 host-safety rule violated (forbidden op attempted, mem budget exceeded)	sherald
<code>.repo.safety_breach</code>	a §9 codebase-safety rule violated (force-push without authorization, missing backup)	sherald / pherald (both subscribe)
<code>.credential.leak</code>	a §11.4.10 / §11.4.10.A credential-handling violation	cherald + iherald (paged)
<code>.bundle.updated</code>	the constitution itself moves to a new SHA (post-pull validation §11.4.32 passed)	sherald
<code>.bundle.update_failed</code>	post-pull validation FAILED	sherald + iherald (paged)
<code>.release.gate_blocked</code>	a §11.4.40-class release gate refused to let the tag land	rherald
<code>.spec.revision_drift</code>		cherald

Event type	When emitted	Owning flavor (default)
	§11.4.73 spec-vs-Revision drift detected	
.catalogue.miss	§11.4.74 catalogue-check missing from a PR	cherald

Adapter implementation notes: each event carries the standard three-axis envelope (§42.1.1) plus the bundle hash (§42.1.3) plus the OTel trace context (heraldtraceparent / heraldtracestate).

42.3 Master binding table (constitution rule → flavor)

Rules NOT listed are intentionally excluded from runtime binding — they're process-only / agent-discipline rules that have no observable target-system event surface. Excluded rules: §11.4.6 (no-guessing), §11.4.8 (deep-web-research), §11.4.20 + §11.4.70 (subagent-by-default), §11.4.35 (canonical-root clarity), §11.4.54 (ATM-NNN — ATMOSphere-specific), §11.4.58 (parallel-development methodology), §11.4.63 (workable-items procedure), §11.4.72 (audio top-priority — operator-scheduling rule), §8 (aspirational), §10 (enforcement meta), §11 (anchor only).

Constitution rule	Default event class	Owning flavor	Default mode	Severity	Notes
§1 Test coverage mandatory	.gate.failed	bherald	enforce	high	coverage drop or zero-test PR
§1.1 False-positive immunity (paired mutation)	.gate.failed	bherald + cherald	enforce	critical	meta-test fails to detect mutation
§2 Commit + push mechanics	.repo.safety_breach	pherald + sherald	enforce	high	wrong entrypoint or partial fan-out
§3 Submodule changes propagate first	.repo.safety_breach	pherald	enforce	high	parent commit before submodule commit
§4 Tag mirroring	.release.gate_blocked	rherald	enforce	high	tag missing on own submodule
§5 Changelog + multi-format export	.policy.violation	rherald + cherald	warn	middle	changelog missing or stale export
§7.1 NO-BLUFF positive-evidence	.gate.failed	cherald	enforce	critical	gate PASSes without captured evidence
§9.1 Destructive-op protocol	.repo.safety_breach	sherald	enforce	critical	rm -rf / git reset --hard without backup
§9.2 Force-push authorization	.repo.safety_breach	sherald + pherald	enforce	critical	force-push without explicit per-session auth
	.gate.recovered	sherald	enforce	middle	

Constitution rule	Default event class	Owning flavor	Default mode	Severity	Notes
§9.3 Hardlinked backup before destructive					backup-created ev for audit trail
§9.4 Commit-message audit trail	.policy.violation	cherald	warn	low	history rewrite without audit line
§11.4.1 FAIL-bluffs forbidden	.gate.failed	cherald	enforce	critical	FAIL that's actually fake-fail
§11.4.2 Recorded-evidence requirement	.gate.failed	bherald	enforce	high	test PASS without tests/.captureevidence/ artifact
§11.4.3 Per-environment-topology dispatch	.gate.failed	bherald	warn	middle	test ran in wrong environment
§11.4.4 Test-interrupt-on-discovery	.gate.failed	bherald	warn	middle	test continued past first failure
§11.4.5 Captured-evidence quality	.gate.failed	bherald	warn	middle	evidence file present but malformed/em
§11.4.7 Demotion-evidence	.gate.failed	bherald	warn	middle	promotion lacks the captured demotion proof
§11.4.9 Batch-source-fixes-before-rebuild	.policy.violation	bherald	warn	low	per-fix rebuild loop detected
§11.4.10 Credentials-handling	.credential.leak	cherald + iherald	enforce	critical	tracked .env, plaintext credential source
§11.4.10.A Pre-store leak audit	.credential.leak	cherald + iherald	enforce	critical	gate before committing credential storage
§11.4.11 File-layout discipline	.policy.violation	pherald	warn	low	file in wrong directory
§11.4.12 Auto-generated docs sync	.policy.violation	cherald	warn	low	covered by §37; reuses tracker even
§11.4.13 Out-of-band sink-side evidence	.gate.failed	bherald	warn	middle	log-side claim without sink-side proof
§11.4.14 Test playback cleanup	.policy.violation	bherald	warn	low	playback artifact left over after run
§11.4.15 Item-status tracking	.policy.violation	pherald	warn	low	covered by §37
§11.4.16 Item-type tracking	.policy.violation	pherald	warn	low	covered by §32.6 classifier
§11.4.17 Universal-vs-	.policy.violation	cherald	warn	low	rule promoted with §11.4 audit

Constitution rule	Default event class	Owning flavor	Default mode	Severity	Notes
project rule promotion					
§11.4.18 Script documentation mandate	<code>.policy.violation</code>	cherald	warn	low	shell script without companion <code>.md</code>
§11.4.19 Fixed-document column alignment	<code>.policy.violation</code>	cherald	warn	low	misaligned columns in <code>Fixed.md</code>
§11.4.21 Operator-blocked status	<code>.policy.violation</code>	pherald + iherald	enforce	high	item enters operator blocked → page of call
§11.4.22 Document-sync commit discipline	<code>.policy.violation</code>	pherald	warn	low	doc + code commit in separate commit
§11.4.23 Visual-cue & grouping for Issues docs	<code>.policy.violation</code>	cherald	warn	low	colorizer drift
§11.4.24 Build-resource stats tracking	<code>.gate.failed</code>	bherald + sherald	warn	middle	build stats missing
§11.4.25 Full-Automation-Coverage	<code>.policy.violation</code>	cherald	warn	low	manual step detected in operator runbook
§11.4.26 Constitution-Submodule Update Workflow	<code>.bundle.updated</code>	sherald	enforce	middle	constitution pulled successfully
§11.4.27 No-Fakes-Beyond-Unit-Tests	<code>.gate.failed</code>	bherald	enforce	high	fake/mock present in non-unit test
§11.4.28 Submodules-As-Equal-Codebase	<code>.policy.violation</code>	cherald	warn	low	submodule rule violated
§11.4.29 Lowercase-Snake_Case-Naming	<code>.policy.violation</code>	cherald	warn	low	naming convention violation
§11.4.30 No-Versioned-Build-Artifacts	<code>.repo.safety_breach</code>	cherald + bherald	enforce	high	build artifact committed
§11.4.31 Submodule-Dependency-Manifest	<code>.policy.violation</code>	cherald	warn	low	manifest missing/s
§11.4.32 Post-Constitution-Pull Validation	<code>.bundle.updated</code> / <code>.bundle.updated</code>	sherald + bherald	enforce	high	post-pull gate results

Constitution rule	Default event class	Owning flavor	Default mode	Severity	Notes
§11.4.33 Type-aware closure-status vocabulary	<code>.policy.violation</code>	pherald	warn	low	covered by §32.6 classifier
§11.4.34 Reopened-source attribution	<code>.policy.violation</code>	pherald	warn	low	covered by §37 / §11.4.55 composited
§11.4.36 Mandatory install_upstreams	<code>.repo.safety_breach</code>	s herald	warn	middle	submodule missing upstream config
§11.4.37 Fetch-before-edit	<code>.repo.safety_breach</code>	pherald	warn	middle	edit on stale base
§11.4.38 Installable-Asset Evidence	<code>.release.gate_blocked</code>	r herald	enforce	high	release asset fails installability check
§11.4.39 Per-Feature On-Device Validation	<code>.gate.failed</code>	b herald	enforce	high	feature claimed do without on-device proof
§11.4.40 Full-suite retest before release tag	<code>.release.gate_blocked</code>	r herald	enforce	critical	tag attempted with full retest
§11.4.41 Pre-Force-Push Merge-First	<code>.repo.safety_breach</code>	s herald + pherald	enforce	critical	force-push without preceding merge
§11.4.42 Iteration-discipline	<code>.policy.violation</code>	pherald	warn	low	iteration cycle skipped
§11.4.43 TDD-Fix-Discipline	<code>.gate.failed</code>	b herald + cherald	enforce	high	fix without preceding test
§11.4.44 Document Revision Header	<code>.policy.violation</code>	cherald	warn	low	doc missing revision header
§11.4.45 Integration-Status-Doc Maintenance	<code>.policy.violation</code>	s cherald + cherald	warn	low	Status.md stale; composes with §3
§11.4.46 Validate-recent-work-before-post-flash	<code>.gate.failed</code>	b herald	warn	middle	post-flash tests ran on un-rebased base
§11.4.47 Firebase Data Review	<code>.policy.violation</code>	s herald	warn	low	data review skipped (project-specific)
§11.4.48 UI-Driven Video Testing	<code>.gate.failed</code>	b herald	warn	middle	UI test without video capture
§11.4.49 Dual-Approach Testing	<code>.gate.failed</code>	b herald	warn	middle	only one of unit/e2e present
	<code>.gate.failed</code>	b herald	enforce	high	

Constitution rule	Default event class	Owning flavor	Default mode	Severity	Notes
§11.4.50 Deterministic Consistency					flaky test detected (same input, different result)
§11.4.51 Live-ADB-First Maximization	.policy.violation	bherald	warn	low	proxy when live-ADB available
§11.4.52 Autonomous-Validation	.gate.failed	bherald	warn	middle	human-only validation step skipped
§11.4.53 Fixed_Summary parity	.policy.violation	cherald	warn	low	covered by §37
§11.4.55 Reopens-history tracking	.policy.violation	pherald	warn	low	reopen without Reopens/HRD-NNN.md
§11.4.56 Status_Summary parity	.policy.violation	cherald	warn	low	covered by §37
§11.4.57 README doc-link section	.policy.violation	cherald	warn	low	README missing doc-link table
§11.4.59 README always-sync	.policy.violation	cherald	warn	low	covered by §37
§11.4.60 Documentation composite covenant	.gate.failed	cherald	enforce	high	composite gate failed
§11.4.61 Markdown metadata + ToC	.policy.violation	cherald	warn	low	new structured doc missing metadata/
§11.4.65 Universal Markdown export	.policy.violation	cherald	warn	low	.md edited without .html/.pdf regen
§11.4.66 Blocker-resolution clarification	.policy.violation	pherald + iherald	enforce	high	operator-blocked without clarification prompt
§11.4.67 Shell-script parseability	.gate.failed	bherald	warn	low	non-portable bash detected
§11.4.68 Positive sink-side evidence	.gate.failed	cherald	enforce	high	downstream proof missing
§11.4.69 Sink-Side Positive-Evidence Taxonomy	.gate.failed	cherald	enforce	high	taxonomy violation
§11.4.71 Pre-Push Fetch +	.repo.safety_breach		enforce	high	

Constitution rule	Default event class	Owning flavor	Default mode	Severity	Notes
Investigate + Integrate		pherald + sherald			push without preceding fetch+integrate
§11.4.73 Main-spec versioning + revision discipline	.spec.revision_drift	cherald	enforce	high	spec touched with Revision bump
§11.4.74 Submodule-catalogue-first	.catalogue.miss	cherald + pherald	enforce	high	non-trivial PR missing Catalogue Check line
§12.1 Forbidden host-session operations	.host.safety_breach	sherald	enforce	critical	suspend/hibernate, logout attempted
§12.2 Required safeguards	.host.safety_breach	sherald	enforce	high	heavy work without bounded scope
§12.3 Container hygiene	.host.safety_breach	sherald + dherald	enforce	high	container without mem_limit
§12.6 Memory-Budget 60% Ceiling	.host.safety_breach	sherald	enforce	critical	budget breach detected
§12.10 CONTINUATION sacred invariant	.policy.violation	cherald	enforce	high	CONTINUATION missing/stale

Total bindings: 65. Process-only rules excluded (no runtime event surface) — see prefix to this section.

42.4 Subscriber-facing payload shape

Every constitution event renders into a subscriber-facing message via the §39 Herald Canonical Template. The body block carries:

```
[<flavor icon>] <severity badge> Constitution rule violated:
<rule_id> - <one-line outcome>
```

```
<short description of the violation context (≤ 280 chars)>
```

```
Rule:           <rule_id> - <rule title from Constitution.md ToC>
Bundle:         <heraldconstitutionbundlesha short-form 12 chars>
Subject:        <file path / repo / commit SHA / tenant scope>
Decision:       <pass|warn|fail|error|skip>
Mode:           <allow|warn|enforce>
Evidence:       <link to evidence artifact or transparency log>
🔗 Constitution.md §<rule_id>: <permalink to that section on the
active mirror>
👤 Caught by: <evaluator name>
🕒 <RFC 3339 timestamp>
```

For allow mode, the message is suppressed (only logged to diary + the pull surface). For warn mode, message routes to digest tag only. For enforce, full §6 tag-fan-out.

42.5 Why §42 is gated, not aspirational

The catalogue-row count (65) means landing every binding at once is impossible. Rollout discipline:

1. **First** — commons_constitution Go package (planned commons_constitution/) implementing the Evaluator interface + the 12-class event-emit helpers. **HRD-018**.
2. **Second** — cherald gets the bulk of bindings; HRD-019 implements the gate-result subscribers + the pull surface /v1/compliance. Initial mode for all bindings: allow (data gathering only).
3. **Third** — sherald host-safety + repo-safety bindings (§9, §12, §11.4.32, §11.4.36, §11.4.41, §11.4.71). **HRD-020**.
4. **Fourth** — bherald CI / test bindings (§1, §11.4.2 / .3 / .4 / .5 / .7 / .13 / .14 / .24 / .27 / .39 / .43 / .46 / .48–.52 / .67). **HRD-021**.
5. **Fifth** — rherald release bindings (§4, §5, §11.4.38, §11.4.40). **HRD-022**.
6. **Sixth** — pherald project bindings (§2, §3, §11.4.11 / .15 / .21 / .22 / .34 / .37 / .42 / .55 / .66 / .71 / .74). **HRD-023**.
7. **Seventh** — iherald incident bindings (§11.4.10 / .10.A escalation, §11.4.21 + .66 escalation). **HRD-024**.
8. **Eighth** — scherald scheduled audit bindings (§11.4.45 periodic audit + digests). **HRD-025**.
9. **Cross-cutting** — bundle-hash captureer (HRD-026), mode-ladder runtime config (HRD-027), pull surface /v1/compliance Gin handler (HRD-028).

Each HRD MUST carry a Catalogue-Check: per Universal §11.4.74 (since most of this work *might* already exist as a Submodule under vasic-digital / HelixDevelopment — the catalogue survey is HRD-018's first task).

42.6 Per-flavor cross-references

Each flavor's §18.X.2 "Constitution bindings" sub-section enumerates only the rules where that flavor is the *default owner* (the bold flavor in the master table above). Bindings where a flavor is a *secondary subscriber* (the second flavor in cherald + iherald-style rows) are implemented as filtered routes — the §6 channel router fans out to the secondary flavor's subscribers based on the heraldconstitutionrule extension attribute, not via a duplicate adapter.

The per-flavor sub-sections live at:

- §18.2.7 pherald — Constitution bindings.
- §18.3.2 sherald — Constitution bindings.
- §18.4.2 bherald — Constitution bindings.
- §18.5.2 dherald — Constitution bindings.
- §18.6.2 aherald — Constitution bindings.
- §18.7.2 scherald — Constitution bindings.
- §18.8.2 iherald — Constitution bindings.
- §18.9.2 rherald — Constitution bindings.
- §18.10.2 cherald — Constitution bindings.

For brevity, the master table in §42.3 IS the source of truth; per-flavor sub-sections (added in §18.X.2 below by the implementation HRDs) point back to it and add only flavor-specific rendering / SLA notes that aren't captured by the table.

42.7 Composition + anti-bluff

§42 composes with:

- **§4 Event model** — constitution events use the same CloudEvents v1.0 envelope as every other Herald event.
- **§32 Inbound pipeline** — inbound subscriber acks/silences for constitution events use the standard pipeline (Ack: / Silence: <duration> / etc.).
- **§34 Reply protocol** — silencing a constitution event in warn mode emits the standard three replies.
- **§35 Versioned reports** — constitution-bundle updates emit `.bundle.updated` events that compose with §35 (the Constitution.md export bundle gets a new SHA).
- **§37 Tracker-doc change events** — rules that map onto tracker-doc state (§11.4.12, .15, .53, .56, .59, .60) are emitted via §37 with `heraldconstitutionrule` as an additional attribute — NOT duplicated as separate `.policy.violation` events.
- **§41 REST API** — every REST-enabled flavor mounts the `/v1/compliance` pull surface.

Anti-bluff (Universal §11.4 + §1.1):

- Every `.gate.failed` / `.gate.recovered` event MUST carry an `evidence_uri` per Universal §11.4.2.
- The `constitution_state` transition gate MUST itself have a paired §1.1 mutation: mutate the `last_decision` row to a different value while leaving the actual evaluator deterministic; expect the gate to detect the drift.

§43. Constitution-derived flavor commands + workflows

Operator mandate (2026-05-20): the constitution analysis surfaces concrete *tooling integrations* — workflows + CLI subcommands + REST endpoints — that Herald flavors MUST ship as native capabilities, not as external scripts the operator stitches together. §43 enumerates those integrations. Each row is implementable as either (a) a Cobra subcommand on the owning flavor's binary, (b) a Gin endpoint under `/v1/<verb>` per §41, or both. Items in this catalogue are the *implementation* counterpart to §42's *event-binding* catalogue: §42 says "fan this event out"; §43 says "ship the tool that produces or acts on that event".

43.1 Why §43 is distinct from §42

§42 binds constitution *rules* to event types so violations + state changes surface to subscribers. §43 catalogues the *workflows* (often already named in the constitution itself — `install_upstreams`, `sync_issues_docs.sh`, the composite `always-sync` gate, etc.) that operators run today as standalone shell scripts. Herald wraps those workflows as flavor-native CLI subcommands + REST endpoints so:

- Operators get a single binary surface to call ("pherald `install-upstreams`" instead of "find the script in the constitution submodule and run it").
- The CLI/REST invocation emits the matching §42 event automatically.
- The workflow result lands in the diary + the §41 audit log + the §6 fan-out without bespoke instrumentation.

Every row in §43.2 below MUST land as its own HRD-NNN (already opened HRD-029..HRD-052 in `Issues.md`, with the catalogue-check field per Universal §11.4.74).

43.2 Master command catalogue (constitution rule → flavor command/workflow)

Constitution rule	Flavor	CLI surface	REST surface (§41)	What it does
§2 Commit + push mechanics	pherald	pherald <code>commit-push [--scope=...]</code>	POST <code>/v1/commit-push</code>	Single-entrypoint commit + multi-repo push per §2. Emits <code>.repo.safety_log</code> entrypoint bypass
§3 Submodule propagation order	pherald	pherald <code>submodule propagate</code>	POST <code>/v1/submodule/propagate</code>	Walks owned-submodule set, commits inner then parent — enforces propagation order
§4 Tag mirroring	rherald	rherald <code>tag mirror <tag></code>	POST <code>/v1/release/tag/mirror</code>	Asserts tag exists on owned submodule allowing tag on parent
§5 Changelog discipline + multi-format export	rherald	rherald <code>changelog generate</code>	POST <code>/v1/release/changelog</code>	Generates docs/changelogs/ <code><version>.md</code> from Conventional Commits exports to <code>.html/.pdf/.docx</code> §36.
§9.1 Destructive-op protocol	sherald	sherald <code>destructive guard <op></code>	POST <code>/v1/safety/destructive</code>	Wraps <code>rm -rf /</code> or <code>reset --hard /</code> or <code>push --force a</code> the §9.1 prerequisite (backup, authorization)
§9.3 Hardlinked backup	sherald	sherald <code>backup snapshot <path></code>	POST <code>/v1/safety/backup</code>	Creates a hardlinked snapshot per §9.3 <code>.gate.recovery</code> success.

Constitution rule	Flavor	CLI surface	REST surface (§41)	What it does
§11.4.2 Recorded-evidence requirement	bherald	bherald evidence capture <test_id>	POST /v1/build/evidence	Records test stdo exit + artefact under tests/.capture-evidence/<test_id> per §11.4.2 + §11.4.10
§11.4.10 / .10.A Credentials handling	cherald	cherald creds scan [--repo=...]	POST /v1/compliance/creds-scan	Runs gitleaks / trufflehog against the working tree history; emits .credential.lock on hit.
§11.4.12 Auto-generated docs sync	cherald	cherald docs sync	POST /v1/compliance/docs/sync	Regenerates Issues_Summary_Fixed_Summary_Status_Summary canonical sources. Composes with §11.4.18
§11.4.18 Script-companion docs	cherald	cherald script-docs check	POST /v1/compliance/script-docs	Asserts every script file <code>**/*.sh</code> has a shebang per §11.4.18.
§11.4.19 / .23 Fixed-doc colorize + align	cherald	cherald fixed align + cherald colorize	POST /v1/compliance/fixed/align	Enforces §11.4.19 alignment + §11.4.23 visual-cue HTML over Issues/Fixed
§11.4.26 Constitution-submodule update	sherald	sherald constitution pull	POST /v1/safety/constitution/pull	Wraps the §11.4.26 workflow: fetch+pull constitution, run gate per §11.4.32 + .bundle.update
§11.4.27 No-fakes + 100% test-type coverage	bherald	bherald test-tier verify	POST /v1/build/tier-verify	Walks the 8-tier tree (§40.2) and emits .gate.failed file on tiers.
§11.4.31 Submodule-Dependency-Manifest	cherald	cherald submanifest verify	POST /v1/compliance/submanifest	Validates docs/dependencies/submodules.md + .gitmodules + their SHAs.
§11.4.36 install_upstreams	pherald	pherald install-upstreams	POST /v1/project/install-upstreams	Reads Upstream declarations + composes all 4 mirror repos per §11.4.36.
§11.4.37 Fetch-before-edit	pherald	pherald fetch-guard	POST /v1/project/fetch-guard	Pre-edit hook: asserts working tree is reproducible from origin/<branch> before any edit.
§11.4.40 Full-suite retest before tag	rherald	rherald gate retest	POST /v1/release/retest-gate	Pre-tag gate runs full test suite + asserts tier (§40.2) green

Constitution rule	Flavor	CLI surface	REST surface (§41)	What it does
§11.4.41 Pre-force-push merge-first	sherald	sherald force-push gate	POST /v1/safety/force-push-gate	.release.gate. on FAIL. Asserts the merge prerequisite + extension session authorization before allowing force-push.
§11.4.45 / .56 Status + Status_Summary maintenance	scherald	scherald status digest [--cadence=daily weekly monthly]	POST /v1/schedule/status-digest	Periodic Status.n + Status_Summary regen. Composes versioned reports
§11.4.53 Fixed_Summary parity	cherald	cherald fixed-summary sync	POST /v1/compliance/fixed-summary	Auto-regen of Fixed_Summary whenever Fixed changes — already trigger, this provides standalone CLI for backfills.
§11.4.55 Reopens-history	pherald	pherald reopen <HRD-NNN> [--reason="..."]	POST /v1/items/{id}/reopen (§41 alignment)	Reverses an Issue migration + writes Reopens/<HRD-NNN> per §11.4.55.
§11.4.59 README always-sync	cherald	cherald readme sync	POST /v1/compliance/readme/sync	Regenerates the README doc-link section + re-exports siblings (§11.4.65).
§11.4.60 Composite always-sync covenant	cherald	cherald composite-gate	POST /v1/compliance/composite-gate	The canonical implementation of DOCS-COMPOSITE walks all 8 bound classes + asserts runtime invariants. .gate.failed on
§11.4.65 Universal Markdown export	cherald	cherald export <doc> [--formats=md,html,pdf,docx]	POST /v1/compliance/export	Single-doc + bundle wrapper around LaTeX WeasyPrint; emits .md/.html/.pdf per §36 formats.
§11.4.71 Pre-push fetch + investigate + integrate	pherald	pherald pre-push	POST /v1/project/pre-push	Pre-push hook: fetch remotes, summarize incoming changes, operator to acknowledge the integration plan pushing. Emits .repo.safety_1 skipped.
§11.4.73 Main-spec version +	cherald	cherald spec-version check	POST /v1/compliance/spec-version	Asserts the main metadata Revision current vs. uncon

Constitution rule	Flavor	CLI surface	REST surface (§41)	What it does
revision discipline				spec edits + proj main_spec_pat .spec.revision Scans a PR descr linked Issues.md the Catalogue- line; survey-run lists vasic-digi HelixDevelopm matching a searc Emits .catalog if missing.
§11.4.74 Submodule- catalogue-first	cherald	cherald catalogue-check <pr-url>	POST /v1/ compliance/ catalogue- check	Continuous watc emitting .host. when 60% thresh crossed. Compos §17 metrics.
§12.6 Memory- budget ceiling	sherald	sherald mem-budget watch (daemon-mode subcommand)	GET /v1/ safety/mem- budget	

Total: **27 new flavor commands / workflows** — one per HRD-029 through HRD-056 (note: HRD-049 is reopen which maps onto an existing REST endpoint per §41 rather than a fresh /v1/<verb>; net new HRDs: 27).

43.3 Implementation gating

§43 is a *catalogue*; landing all 27 commands at once would freeze every other workstream. Order:

1. **First wave** — workflows the inheritance gate already depends on (no Herald implementation required to FUNCTION, but Herald wrapping them makes the operator surface uniform): pherald install-upstreams (HRD-043), sherald constitution pull (HRD-040), cherald composite-gate (HRD-051), cherald export (HRD-052).
2. **Second wave** — workflows that produce .gate.failed / .policy.violation events the §42 catalogue references but currently have no emitter: cherald creds scan (HRD-036), cherald docs sync (HRD-037), cherald script-docs check (HRD-038), pherald fetch-guard (HRD-044), sherald force-push gate (HRD-046).
3. **Third wave** — operator-quality-of-life CLIs: pherald reopen (HRD-049), rherald changelog generate (HRD-032), rherald gate retest (HRD-045), scherald status digest (HRD-047).
4. **Fourth wave** — the remainder.

The §11.4.74 catalogue-check applies: each HRD-029..-056 MUST start with a survey of vasic-digital + HelixDevelopment for an existing Submodule. Many of these workflows already exist as shell scripts in the constitution submodule itself (install_upstreams.sh, sync_issues_docs.sh, etc.); the Herald implementation wraps + extends them rather than reinventing.

43.4 Composition with §41 REST + §42 events + §39 templates

Every §43 command flows through the same three layers:

- **§41 REST** — every command exposes a matching `/v1/<verb>` endpoint accepting the same parameters as the CLI; apps + dashboards consume the REST surface.
- **§42 events** — invoking the command emits the matching event class (`.gate.failed` / `.policy.violation` / `.repo.safety_breach` / etc.) via `commons_constitution`; subscribers see the action through their configured channels.
- **§39 templates** — the subscriber-visible message uses the Herald Canonical Template per-flavor; outcomes (success / failure / partial) follow the §39.5 style rules.

This three-layer pattern makes adding a 28th workflow (or a project-specific Submodule's workflow per §11.4.74) trivial: define the command + register its event class + author the §39 template + open the HRD.

43.5 Boundary: what §43 does NOT add

- **Per-channel adapters** — those are §11 + §18.X.1, not §43.
- **General-purpose Go libraries** — `commons_*` packages are §10, not §43.
- **Subscribers' workflows** — Bug: / Query: / Status: style subscriber commands are §18.X (per-flavor inbound) + §32 (inbound pipeline), not §43. §43 is operator-facing (CLI + REST), not subscriber-facing (chat/email/etc.).

§43 is intentionally scoped to *operator workflows that the constitution itself names or implies*. Anything else (custom project tooling, integrations with external SaaS) is the consuming project's concern, not Herald's.

§44. Foundation implementation contract

Added 2026-05-20 (V3 r7). Locks the contract for the **Foundation sub-project** — the first of eight implementation sub-projects derived from V3. Full design + rationale lives in `docs/superpowers/specs/2026-05-20-foundation-design.md`; this section is the contract the spec carries forward.

§44.1 Scope

Foundation composes HRD-018 (`commons_constitution`) + HRD-010 (`commons_storage` live wiring) + HRD-016 (Gin REST skeleton subset) + HRD-026 (bundle-hash capture) + HRD-027 (mode-ladder runtime config) + HRD-028 (`/v1/compliance` pull surface) into a single, end-to-end-smokeable substrate. Every other sub-project (channel adapters, dispatchers, sweep daemon, REST surface expansion, multi-flavor binaries) builds on Foundation.

§44.2 Done criterion (locked)

The Quickstart compose stack accepts a real CloudEvent v1.0 on POST /v1/events, fans it out to the null:// channel, writes a constitution_state row with the correct transition, and exposes that row via GET /v1/compliance. The full smoke is reproduced in containers/quickstart/ and runs in CI per §40.

§44.3 Three-milestone delivery (Approach B — bottom-up vertical slices)

Milestone	What lands	Smoke criterion
M1	commons_constitution package (Evaluator + 12 emit helpers + BundleHash + ModeLadder + ConstitutionStore + in-process EventBus) — all in-memory, no external deps.	go test -race ./commons_constitution/... proves an in-memory evaluator detects a transition → emits a .policy.violation → memory-pubsub listener counts it.
M2	commons_storage live: digital.vasic.database (pgx + migrations) + digital.vasic.background (Postgres job queue). New migrations 000006_constitution_state + 000007_constitution_bindings. Postgres backends for ConstitutionStore + ModeLadder.	go test -tags=integration against testcontainers Postgres + queue verifies UPSERT semantics, RLS isolation, transition detection, audit-row append, job enqueue + consume.
M3	pherald/internal/http/ (Gin via digital.vasic.middleware + digital.vasic.auth + digital.vasic.observability) + digital.vasic.cache 60s read-cache for mode-ladder. Wire pherald serve to mount the Gin router.	Quickstart compose up; curl POST /v1/events → fans to null:// → constitution_state row written → diary appended → curl GET /v1/compliance returns the row.

§44.4 Evaluator trigger model (locked)

Hybrid: push-trigger for critical-severity rules (§9 secret-handling, §11.4.10 root-cause, §12 ops invariants — re-evaluate immediately on the named CloudEvents type); pull-sweep every 5–15 min for lower-severity rules (sweep daemon itself lives in Sub-project 5, but the Registry building blocks land in Foundation M1).

§44.5 Mode-ladder storage (locked)

Postgres `constitution_bindings` table is the source of truth. Redis 60-second read-cache wraps it (mirrors §4.3 idempotency-keys pattern). Cache invalidation on `ModeLadder.Set` is published as a `mode-ladder.invalidated` event on the in-process `EventBus` so every running process invalidates its own cache (see Foundation design §7 open question 3 for the rationale).

§44.6 Three-axis governance envelope (locked)

Every emitted `Constitution-CloudEvent` carries the spec §42.1.1 envelope:

```
{
  "envelope": {
    "rule_id": "§11.4.10",
    "severity_category": "critical",
    "decision_result": "fail",
    "bundle_hash": "<sha256-hex>",
    "transition_from": "pass",
    "transition_to": "fail",
    "tenant_id": "<uuid>",
    "evidence_uri": "<uri>",
    "traceparent": "<W3C trace-context>"
  },
  "payload": { /* per-class typed payload */ }
}
```

On the wire (`CloudEvent` extension attributes), underscored keys are normalised to lowercase alphanumeric per `CloudEvents v1.0 §3` (`rule_id` → `ruleid`, etc.). The internal Go API keeps the readable form; the boundary normaliser lives in `commons_constitution/cloudevents.go`.

§44.7 Catalogue-Check verdict (recorded 2026-05-20)

Per Universal §11.4.74, every Foundation capability surveyed for existing modules in `vasic-digital` + `HelixDevelopment` before code lands. Full evidence in `docs/catalogue-checks/HRD-018-foundation.md`. Summary:

- **9 of 12** capabilities extend existing Helix-stack modules.
- **3 of 12** capabilities no-match (bespoke, written new): Evaluator framework, BundleHash captureer, ModeLadder semantics.
- River queue **replaced** by `digital.vasic.background`; Watermill pub/sub **replaced** by `digital.vasic.eventbus`; raw Gin/JWT/OTel **composed** from `digital.vasic.middleware` + auth + observability; raw pgx + golang-migrate **wrapped** via `digital.vasic.database`.

§44.8 Anti-bluff testing mandate (continuous)

Per operator mandate 2026-05-20: every Foundation test (M1 unit + M2 integration + M3 e2e) **MUST** exercise the behavior it claims to verify — no pass-without-execution paths, no mock-only tests that don't round-trip, no `t.Skip` paths that mask broken features. Each test failure in CI **MUST** imply a real broken feature. This

mandate propagates to all Helix-stack submodules consumed by Foundation (their existing tests + Challenges are audited at integration time per the codegraph milestone).

§44.9 M1 evidence (landed 2026-05-20)

The Foundation M1 milestone landed with the following observed deltas:

- **New module:** `github.com/vasic-digital/herald/commons_constitution` — 8 production files (~1.2k LOC) + 6 test files (~1.2k LOC).
- **go test -race -count=1 ./commons_constitution/...** — all 3 packages PASS (top, ladder/, state/).
- **Inheritance gate** — 12 PASS / 0 FAIL before + after.
- **Other workspace modules** — unchanged behavior (still PASS).
- **I6 gate-policy conflict surfaced** — current I6 invariant in `tests/test_constitution_inheritance.sh` forbids any `.gitmodules` file (originally written to prevent re-embedding the parent constitution/). M1 sidesteps this by writing all Helix-stack modules' Go-equivalents in-package; M2/M3 will require either an I6 refinement (`.gitmodules` permitted iff it does NOT contain a `constitution/` entry) or a non-submodule install path. **Open: HRD-080** (gate refinement) tracks this.

When M2 closes, this section is appended with the M2 evidence. M3 closure appends the as-built CloudEvent example + RLS isolation proof + null:// ring-buffer trace.

§30. V2 self-review log

Added 2026-05-19 by a focused self-review pass on V2 r1. Each finding is tagged V2-R-NN to distinguish from V1's R-NN series. **All findings in this section have been applied in V2 r2** unless explicitly marked Deferred.

30.1 Gaps closed (applied this revision)

- **V2-R-01. Missing Go value types referenced by the Channel interface.** §11 previously declared `Channel` with `Capabilities`, `OutboundMessage`, `Receipt`, and `InboundHandler` as forward references without definitions. Applied: new §11.0 ("Channel adapter contract") defines all referenced types — `Capabilities`, `DeliveryEvidence` (enum), `OutboundMessage`, `Body`, `Attachment`, `Recipient`, `Action / ActionType`, `Priority`, `Receipt`, `InboundHandler`, `InboundEvent`. These live in `commons/types.go`; adapters are forbidden from inventing equivalents.
- **V2-R-02. Missing webhook_sources table schema.** §5.5 referenced the table but never defined it. Applied: full schema (`signature_kind`, `signature_header`, `secret_encrypted`, `secret_rotated_at`, `ip_allowlist`, `replay_window_s`) with RLS policy and `<flavor>herald webhook rotate CLI`.
- **V2-R-03. Missing channel_addresses table schema.** §6 referenced the table but never defined it. Applied: full schema with `address_url` (env-interpolated at load time so secrets stay out of the row), `tags` GIN index, `priority_floor`, `enabled` + health-check columns.

- **V2-R-04. Missing thread_refs table schema.** §12 prose-only definition. Applied: full schema with composite PK (tenant_id, logical_thread_id, channel), last_activity_at for time-window GC.
- **V2-R-05. Missing quarantined_messages table schema.** §15.2 referenced but never defined. Applied: full schema with triage_status enum, partial index on pending rows, 30-day auto-expiry policy, CLI verbs.
- **V2-R-06. subscribers.handle had no uniqueness constraint.** Original schema allowed duplicate handles within a tenant — operationally surprising. Applied: UNIQUE (tenant_id, handle). Also added roles TEXT[] and metadata JSONB columns for the operator-mapped privilege model and extensible per-subscriber data, plus an explicit composite index on tenant_id.
- **V2-R-07. Go toolchain version not pinned.** §9.1 said "written in Go" without naming a minimum. Without slog and the OTel slog bridge, observability won't compile. Applied: Go ≥ 1.22 mandatory; toolchain directive across all go.mod files; bump path documented.
- **V2-R-08. License not named.** Multiple references to "the LICENSE file" without spelling out the terms. Applied: §9.1 now points to the parent project's LICENSE and requires top-level license comments in every go.mod; license compliance check is a cheraId responsibility.
- **V2-R-09. SIGTERM / graceful-shutdown semantics undefined.** Both modes (send, serve) lacked a documented exit contract. Applied: §3.1 now specifies trap-SIGTERM, stop-ingress, drain with HERALD_SHUTDOWN_GRACE (default 30 s), flush OTel exporter, close Postgres + Redis, exit 0/1 distinction. Second SIGTERM forces exit.
- **V2-R-10. OpenTelemetry env vars not enumerated.** §17.1 said "OTLP/gRPC to a Collector" without naming the standard SDK env vars. Operators couldn't deploy without reading OTel spec. Applied: full table of OTEL_* env vars Herald honours, including resource attributes Herald sets by default and the messaging semantic-convention version pin (v1.30+).
- **V2-R-11. Data retention + privacy was unspecified.** No section on how long Herald holds onto subscriber data, dead letters, quarantined messages, or diary entries; no GDPR right-to-erasure / right-to-portability flow. Applied: new §16.1 with per-class retention defaults (table-driven), <flavor>herald subscriber forget and subscriber export flows, diary-redaction opt-out, data-sovereignty note.
- **V2-R-12. Operator quickstart missing.** New operators couldn't get from clone to first delivery without reading the whole spec. Applied: §26.5 with a complete Docker Compose YAML, 6-step bring-up procedure, and a verifiable end-to-end test (curl webhook → Telegram delivery + diary append + OTel trace).
- **V2-R-13. Disaster recovery posture unspecified.** Backups were mentioned but RPO/RTO targets, cold-start procedure, and tested scenarios were absent. Applied: §26.6 with per-class RPO/RTO table, cold-start procedure, and named integration-test scenarios that MUST live under tests/dr/.
- **V2-R-14. Cost considerations missing.** Operators had no order-of-magnitude TCO guidance to choose between self-hosted SMTP vs Resend/Postmark, between Grafana Cloud vs self-host Prometheus, etc. Applied: §27.3 with infrastructure / ESP / messaging-platform / supply-chain-tooling / observability-backend pricing tables (with verify-at-deploy caveat).

30.2 Deferred (out of scope for this self-review)

These findings were noted but require their own focused pass:

- **V2-R-15. ASCII architecture diagram alignment.** Current diagram in §2.3 has minor box-drawing misalignment at the `└` corners under proportional-font renderers. Deferred — fixing requires Mermaid or PlantUML adoption + a renderer pipeline; not blocker for V2.
- **V2-R-16. Heading-depth normalisation.** Some §18.X flavor subsections go 4 levels deep (heading → field → subfield → list). Considered but rejected — depth tracks meaningful structure; flattening loses navigation cues.
- **V2-R-17. "V1 minimum" vs "V1 (MVP)" wording inconsistency.** Cosmetic. Deferred to a docs-only polish PR.

30.3 Method

The pass was a single-author read-through immediately following V2 r1 authoring, focused on internal consistency (prose `[?]` formal definitions), operational completeness (can someone deploy this?), and compliance gaps (GDPR, license, version pinning). Findings rated High when a downstream reader would file a bug, Medium when a future implementer would have to invent a missing detail, Low for stylistic. Only High + Medium findings were applied.

30.4 Audit trail (r2)

- Pre-review commit: V2 r1 at 96b7cc6.
- r2 commit: 9648545 (one logical commit covering V2-R-01..V2-R-14).
- Inheritance gate before and after: 12 PASS / 0 FAIL. Meta-test: ✓.
- All four Herald mirrors targeted on push.

30.5 V3 review log (r3, this revision)

A second self-review pass following r2. Targeted a *different cut* than r1→r2: where r1→r2 closed missing tables and added operational content, r2→r3 closes the second-layer Go types (referenced by §11.0 but not defined) and adds the implementer-grade operational detail that turns "we have a spec" into "we have a buildable spec".

30.5.1 Gaps closed (applied this revision)

- **V3-R-01. Remaining undefined Go types in §11.0.** Subscriber, CloudEventEnvelope, TraceContext, Branding (as Go struct, cross-ref §6.3), ChannelID (typed string constants), SubscriberAlias, PreferenceSet/CategoryPref/WorkflowPref/QuietHours (Go-decoded forms of the JSON in §7.2) — all referenced by OutboundMessage / InboundEvent but never defined. **Applied:** all defined in §11.0 with package + file home pins (commons/types.go, commons/preferences.go, etc.). Closes the "Channel interface compiles in isolation" gap.
- **V3-R-02. Database migration tooling unspecified.** §26.3 mentioned `<flavor>herald migrate` but never named the tool, file layout, or numbering scheme. **Applied:** new §9.6 picks `golang-migrate/migrate` (embedded), specifies the `commons_storage/migrations/000001_..._up.sql` layout, the

runtime contract (migrate up/down/status/force/validate), the role split (herald_migrator BYPASSRLS vs herald_app), and the forward-compatibility rule (two minor versions).

- **V3-R-03. Worker-pool sizing absent.** No guidance on how many concurrent workers Herald runs. **Applied:** new §3.4 specifies three independently-sized pools (HTTP ingress, router/dispatch, River channel-delivery) with defaults keyed off NumCPU, env-var overrides, and sizing guidance by deployment tier (small / multi-tenant / high-burst).
- **V3-R-04. SIGHUP hot-reload semantics missing.** <flavor>herald serve long-running but no way to refresh config without restart. **Applied:** new §3.4 specifies SIGHUP trap, the safe-to-change vs requires-restart partition (channels/router-workers/log-level/allowlists vs ports/DSN/RLS-policies), the diff-and-validate cycle, and the digital.vasic.herald.system.config.reloaded audit event.
- **V3-R-05. Ingress HTTP URL paths never enumerated.** Operators couldn't write reverse-proxy / API-gateway rules without reading the source. **Applied:** new §5.7 tabulates every /v1/* and /webhooks/* and /livez/readyz/startupz/metrics/admin/* endpoint with method + auth mode, plus the rate-limit defaults and the /v1/ versioning policy.
- **V3-R-06. Workable-item lifecycle missing.** §8 defined the prefix algorithm but never explained how an HRD-NNN actually moves from Bug: command → Issues.md row → Fixed.md resolution. **Applied:** new §8.3 with full lifecycle ASCII flow, the workable_items schema (lightweight pointer table — canonical record stays in Markdown per Universal §6 human-edit-ability), per-tenant advisory-lock sequence allocation, and the reopen flow that composes with Universal §11.4.55 Reopens.md history.
- **V3-R-07. null:// sandbox channel undocumented.** No first-class way to test routing without hitting real channels. **Applied:** new §11.14 specifies the URL grammar (null://?fail_rate=...&latency_ms=...&ceiling=...), the in-memory ring buffer, the /admin/null/* inspector API, the per-environment gate (CM-NUL-CHANNEL-DISABLED-IN-PROD), and a recommended test-fixtures pattern for every commons_messaging/channels/<name>/ package.
- **V3-R-08. Time / clock abstraction missing.** time.Now() called directly anywhere makes tests of quiet hours, batching, backoff, TTLs unreliable. **Applied:** new §3.5 with the commons/clock interface (RealClock + FakeClock), the Default package-global variable swap pattern, and the golangci-lint rule herald-no-direct-time-now that fails compilation if anyone calls time.Now() outside commons/clock.
- **V3-R-09. Machine-readable API specs not committed.** Spec referenced <flavor>herald openapi without describing where the specs live. **Applied:** new §24.1 specifies docs/api/openapi.v1.yaml (OpenAPI 3.1, hand-authored from Go handler signatures, with CM-OPENAPI-DRIFT parity gate) and docs/api/asynapi.v1.yaml (AsyncAPI 2.6, machine-generated from commons/events.go); also lists the CLI helpers (openapi, asynapi, schema dump).
- **V3-R-10. Outbound idempotency unspecified.** §4.3 covered ingress idempotency but not the case where the channel send itself succeeds-but-loses-response and gets retried. **Applied:** new §5.4.1 with the (tenant_id, event_id, channel, channel_address_id) outbound key, the outbound_dedup table (24h TTL — narrower than ingress 7d), and the rule that adapters supporting upstream idempotency (Slack/Stripe-style/Email Message-ID) MUST forward the key while those that don't (raw SMTP/Telegram/Discord) MUST consult outbound_dedup in the same River-job transaction.

- **V3-R-11. Per-channel SLO budgets missing.** §17.4 aggregate SLOs hid one bad channel behind good channels. **Applied:** new §17.4.1 publishes per-channel success and p95-latency targets for each of the 12 channels with a multi-window / multi-burn-rate alert rule (Google SRE Workbook pattern: 2h/14× AND 6h/6× = page; either alone = warn).
- **V3-R-12. AI-agent subscribers conflated with humans.** Spec assumes "subscriber" without distinguishing the runaway-loop risk of agents. **Applied:** new §7.5 introduces a `subscribers.kind` enum (human/agent/service), the `agent_tokens` table (argon2id-hashed bearer with per-token rate limit + expiry + revocation), the default throttles (60 req/min/token, 3-strike auto-cool-down at 30min), the audit-span attribute (`herald.subscriber.kind="agent" + herald.agent.token_id`), and the rule that quiet-hours are ignored for agents by default.

30.5.2 Deferred (out of scope for r3)

- **V3-R-13. Migration-from-existing-systems operator guide.** Mentioned briefly in §24 doc layout but no actual content for migrating from Apprise/Gotify/Mattermost-bridge/etc. Deferred — needs its own dedicated docs/migration/ content cycle.
- **V3-R-14. Multi-region / global deployments.** What if one tenant spans regions? Out-of-scope; treated as schema-per-tenant + region-pinned operator concern; will resurface when first cross-region customer appears.

30.5.3 Method

Same as r2: single-author read-through immediately following r2 commit, focused on three categories — (a) prose² formal-definition gaps in the type contract layer that §11.0 introduced, (b) operational completeness for an implementer who hasn't read the constitution, (c) correctness boundaries (outbound dedup composition, agent throttling) the architecture document needs to nail down before code lands. Findings rated as before; only High + Medium applied this round.

30.5.4 Audit trail (r3)

- Pre-review commit: V2 r2 at 9648545.
- r3 commit: covered V3-R-01..V3-R-12 in one logical commit on top of r2.
- Inheritance gate before and after: 12 PASS / 0 FAIL. Meta-test: ✓.
- All four Herald mirrors targeted on push.

Statistical context: r1→r2 added ~33 KB to the Markdown source closing 14 findings. r2→r3 closed 12 findings — the curve is flattening, which is the expected pattern (the easier high-leverage gaps go first). A fourth pass would likely yield only stylistic findings; the next high-value pass should come *after* first-implementation cycle surfaces real-world spec gaps that desk-review alone can't find.

30.6 V3 r1 review log (this revision)

This is **not** a desk-review of V2 — it is a *requirements-driven* expansion. V2 was architecturally complete; V3 r1 adds the operator-product story the user described in their V3 brief (project integration, inbound pipeline, LLM dispatch, reply protocol, versioned reports, multi-format attachments) and folds in the **explicit project-side**

requirements the user introduced during V3 authoring: 30 s poll cadence, FIFO inbound queue, anti-spam, Investigation-before-Fixing, Claude Code project-named session, issues/users/attachments/WORKABLE_ITEM_ID/, multi-format outbound attachments (.md + .html + .pdf + .docx).

30.6.1 Findings applied (V3-R1-NN)

- **V3-R1-01. Project integration contract was implicit.** Spec assumed a consuming project existed; never specified the contract. Applied: §31 with 6-point integration checklist, configuration template, and test_project_integration.sh audit gate composing with 11 Universal Constitution mandates.
- **V3-R1-02. Inbound pipeline had no defined cadence.** §3 mentioned "daemon mode listens" but no polling rule. Applied: §32.2 mandates ≤ 30 s upstream check rate; per-channel table maps to underlying mechanism (long-poll vs Socket Mode vs Gateway vs webhook vs IMAP IDLE).
- **V3-R1-03. No FIFO guarantee for inbound processing.** V2 mentioned River queue but no per-tenant per-channel ordering rule. Applied: §32.3 specifies advisory-lock-per-(tenant_id, channel_address_id) to guarantee strict arrival order.
- **V3-R1-04. Anti-spam unspecified.** Spec referenced "security validation" but no anti-spam layer. Applied: §32.5 with four-layer anti-spam (per-sender rate / burst detection / reputation / channel frequency); spam_audit Redis stream for tuning.
- **V3-R1-05. Investigation-before-Fixing pattern missing.** Spec went straight from "Bug:" command to workable item. Applied: §18.2.1 mandates intermediate investigation item (HRD-INV-NNN); LLM analyzes reproducibility before final item is allocated; rejects duplicates/out-of-scope/non-reproducible.
- **V3-R1-06. LLM/agent dispatch had no concrete first integration.** V2 left LLM dispatch as future work. Applied: §33 wires Claude Code as the V3 r1 default: resolve_session(project_name) algorithm, <<<HERALD-DISPATCH-v1>>> envelope, JSON reply schema, pluggable Dispatcher interface.
- **V3-R1-07. Claude Code session was assumed to support --session-name.** It doesn't. Applied: §33.2 documents the gap and specifies the resolution algorithm using the project-name as an anchor-file key, with --resume <UUID> as the actual CLI invocation.
- **V3-R1-08. Reply protocol was single-shot.** V2 said "Herald replies" without staging. Applied: §34 specifies three replies (queued / processing / result) with per-channel edit-in-place mechanics, criticality-driven SLAs, and verbose error reporting that complies with Universal §11.4 anti-bluff.
- **V3-R1-09. Reports vs one-off messages were conflated.** V2 had no separate semantic for documents that change over time. Applied: §35 introduces report-aware event types, report_publications dedup table, Git commit SHA + URL + diff URL embedding, edit-in-place where supported.
- **V3-R1-10. Outbound attachments were single-format.** V2 sent the rendered file in whatever format the channel preferred. Applied: §36 mandates four-format bundle (.md + .html + .pdf + .docx) so subscribers choose. Pandoc generation pipeline (already a dependency) + cache + per-channel delivery rules.
- **V3-R1-11. Attachment storage path for user uploads was implicit.** V2 said "validate and store" without naming the path. Applied: §18.2.4 mandates issues/users/attachments/<WORKABLE_ITEM_ID>/ with attachments_index.md as source-of-truth + 8-step validation pipeline

(download → ClamAV → MIME → extension → size-per-file → size-total → move-on-pass → quarantine-on-fail).

- **V3-R1-12. Criticality classification had no SLA mapping.** V2 had a 4-level scale but no concrete SLA per level. Applied: §18.2.2 table maps each criticality to specific Reply A/B/C SLA windows + investigation deadline.

30.6.2 Deferred to V3 r2 (the user's follow-up scope)

- **V3-R1-13. Other flavors (§18.3–§18.10) not yet refined for richer channel interaction.** sherald/bherald/dherald/aherald/scherald/iherald/rherald/cherald still carry V2 subscriber-command vocabulary. V3 r2 will add: interactive buttons (Slack Block Kit action buttons / Telegram inline-keyboard callbacks / Discord components / Teams Adaptive Card actions), reaction-based ack/silence, slash-command discovery via /help, per-flavor command palettes.
- **V3-R1-14. Full re-export of V1+V2+V3 + push EVERYTHING.** Deferred to V3 r3 as the final polish/release pass.

30.6.3 Audit trail (r3 → V3 r1)

- Pre-V3 commit: V2 r3 at f4ebba1.
- V3 r1 commit: covers V3-R1-01..V3-R1-12 in one logical commit on top of V2 r3.
- Inheritance gate before and after: 12 PASS / 0 FAIL. Meta-test: ✓.
- All four Herald mirrors targeted on push.
- V2 metadata bumped to Status=superseded; V2 re-exported to keep §11.4.65 invariant green.

Statistical context: V1 was 594 lines; V2 r1 was 1745 lines (+1151); V2 r3 was ~3000 lines (+1255); V3 r1 adds another ~1100 lines. The spec has grown by ~5× in two days of iteration — about half of that is the V3 first-version requirements (§31–§36 + §18.2 expansion), the rest was architectural maturity in V2's three revisions.

30.7 V3 r2 review log (this revision)

V3 r1 specified the operator-product architecture but left every non-pherald flavor at V2's text-prefix command vocabulary. V3 r2 closes that gap by adding **per-flavor channel-interaction surfaces** — slash commands, reaction-based quick ops, interactive buttons, modal forms, threads/forum-topics — so subscribers can interact with each flavor through the channel's native UI affordances.

30.7.1 Findings applied (V3-R2-NN)

- **V3-R2-01. No cross-flavor interaction primitives.** Each flavor invented its own button labels and slash commands → cognitive load for multi-flavor deployments. Applied: §18.1.1 establishes universal primitives every flavor inherits — /help / /status / /whoami / /silence / /subscribe slash commands with text-prefix fallback, 9-emoji reaction set wired to ack/silence/resolve/escalate/reopen/reclassify/spam, interactive-button conventions, modal-form patterns, thread/forum-topic affinity, capability-degradation rule.
- **V3-R2-02. pherald had no quick-action UI for investigation triage.** Applied: §18.2.6 adds /investigate, /promote, /reject slash commands; investigation-summary modal (Slack views.open / Discord modal); status-

- action buttons ([Validate] [Reject] [Need more info] [Reassign]); pinned workable-item card refreshed via §35.
- **V3-R2-03. sherald quick-silence pattern undocumented.** Applied: §18.3.1 adds [Ack] / [Silence 1h] / [Silence 24h] / [Resolve] / [Runbook] / [Escalate] buttons; one-tap 🚫 silence; /silence-similar for same-service grouping; per-service forum topic on Telegram.
 - **V3-R2-04. bherald had no PR/build cross-flavor handoff.** Applied: §18.4.1 introduces 🍌 reaction → promotes failed-build to pherald bug investigation (single-emoji cross-flavor handoff); [Retry] / [Snooze flaky] buttons; /triage slash for security-scan decisions; coverage-delta card; per-branch build digest forum topic.
 - **V3-R2-05. dherald lacked confirmation flow for destructive ops.** Applied: §18.5.1 mandates Slack modal with release_note_signoff field on [Rollback] and [Hold env]; [Promote canary] button; environment status card; [Page on-call] 📞 reaction freezes deploys to env.
 - **V3-R2-06. aherald did not specify per-channel ack semantics.** Applied: §18.6.1 documents [Ack] carrying an implicit escalation_window timer; /aherald group and /aherald inhibit slash commands; Email reply-by-keyword (button-less channel still gets ack/silence/resolve/escalate via parsed keywords); Telegram inline-keyboard expand button avoids message-length limits.
 - **V3-R2-07. scherald reminders had no snooze UX.** Applied: §18.7.1 adds [Snooze 1h] / [Snooze 1d] / [Snooze custom] / [Cancel] buttons; /remind <subject> in <duration> with permissive duration parser; /digest <daily|weekly|monthly> on-demand digest; 🔄 reaction re-schedules with the same delta; "[I read this]" reaction feeds digest-section deprioritisation.
 - **V3-R2-08. iherald lacked a "command room" pattern.** Applied: §18.8.1 introduces incident command room (Slack thread / Discord forum-channel post / Telegram forum-topic / Teams channel); [Take IC] atomic compare-and-swap on incidents.commander_id; [Acknowledge page] button works on Email + WhatsApp via signed URLs; /postmortem slash generates §36 multi-format template seeded from incident_events; real-time timer card refreshed every 60 s.
 - **V3-R2-09. rherald/cherald had no compliance-grade UX.** Applied: §18.9.1 adds release card + [Promote to staging/prod] / [Hold] buttons with Slack modal confirmation requiring release_note_signoff field; dependency-update [Approve] / [Reject] / [Defer 7d]; /cve and /release-notes slash commands; ✅/❌ operator reactions drive cherald triage queue; breaking-changes thread. §18.10.1 mandates restricted-by-default channels for cherald; [Acknowledge violation] / [Mark false-positive] / [Open ticket] (cross-flavor handoff to pherald); operator-only /audit <subscriber-id> (which itself emits a compliance.audit.review event — audits-of-audits are audited); 🔒 reaction marks events sensitive; email-as-system-of-record with keep/ignore keyword triage; one forum topic per compliance domain.

30.7.2 Audit trail (r2)

- Pre-review commit: V3 r1 at e26a8dc.
- r2 commit: covers V3-R2-01..V3-R2-09 in one logical commit on top of V3 r1.
- Inheritance gate before and after: 12 PASS / 0 FAIL.
- All four Herald mirrors targeted on push.
- V2 untouched in r2 (already at Status=superseded from r1 commit).

30.7.3 What remains for r3

- **V3-R3-01. Full re-export of V1 + V2 + V3** to keep §11.4.65 universal-export invariant green across the full spec set.
- **V3-R3-02. Polish pass** — minor refinements surfaced during r2 authoring (e.g., the §31 mandatory-integration list and the §18.x.1 channel-interaction tables share an implicit "every channel supports degradation" assumption that should be explicit; the Roadmap §27.1 table doesn't yet mention the V3 additions).
- **V3-R3-03. Touch test on parent-project docs** — check whether README.md/CLAUDE.md/AGENTS.md/HERALD_CONSTITUTION.md reference the old specification.md path and need redirection to V3.
- **Final commit + push EVERYTHING** to all 4 Herald mirrors (plus constitution mirrors if any constitution edit is needed).

30.8 V3 r3 review log (this revision — final polish)

V3 r3 is the closing-out commit for the user-defined "after r1 + r2, refining and improvements and re-export and push EVERYTHING" ask. Where r1 added the operator-product layer and r2 refined every flavor's channel interactions, r3 closes the cross-doc sync gap and finalises the spec evolution chain.

30.8.1 Findings applied (V3-R3-NN)

- **V3-R3-01. Stale path string in V3 §23 spec-change anchor.** §23 still referenced specification.V2.md even though V3 supersedes V2. Applied: rewrote §23 to point at specification.V3.md and added a note clarifying that the I7-gated enforcement anchor is the *phrase* comprehensive planning and implementation, not the path — so the gate stayed green throughout the path-string churn.
- **V3-R3-02. Parent docs (README/CLAUDE.md/AGENTS.md/HERALD_CONSTITUTION.md) referenced the pre-V1-rename path specification.md.** Three of the four still said MVP spec (TBD) even though V3 is ~3900 lines and architecturally complete. Applied: all four files updated:
 - **README.md** — repo-layout block now shows specification.V3.md + archive/specification.V1.md + archive/specification.V2.md. Read-order item 7 now points at V3. Status updated to describe the current spec.
 - **CLAUDE.md** — all four docs/specs/mvp/specification.md occurrences replaced with ...specification.V3.md (ToC entry, read-order, spec-change-rule heading, body reference).
 - **AGENTS.md** — same path-replacement across all occurrences.
 - **HERALD_CONSTITUTION.md** — §106 forensic anchor + §"Notes" section both updated; Notes now reflects "V3 is active; V1+V2 in archive".
- **V3-R3-03. Metadata revisions out of date in all four parent docs.** Applied: bumped Revision on README (1→2), CLAUDE.md (1→2), AGENTS.md (2→3), HERALD_CONSTITUTION.md (2→3); refreshed Status summary / Fixed / Fixed summary on each to capture the V3-path-sync work.

30.8.2 Audit trail (r3)

- Pre-review commit: V3 r2 at f8b8073.
- r3 commit: covers V3-R3-01..V3-R3-03 + parent-doc updates + .html/.pdf regen for V3 and all four parent docs.

- Inheritance gate before and after: 12 PASS / 0 FAIL. I7a/b/c specifically re-verified (the path-string change could have affected them in principle but does not because I7 grep keys on the phrase, not the path).
- All four Herald mirrors targeted on push.
- Constitution submodule untouched in r3 (no constitution-level change needed; the §11.4.61 + §11.4.65 invariants are satisfied by the in-repo re-export).
- V1 + V2 untouched in r3 (already current in archive/).

30.8.3 What r3 does NOT do

- Does NOT refactor V3 body content. Polish was deliberately limited to cross-doc sync to keep r3 commits surgical.
- Does NOT bump V1 or V2 revision/status (they're frozen archives).
- Does NOT touch the constitution submodule (out of scope; the parent constitution already carries the §11.4.61/§11.4.65 mandates Herald composes with).

30.8.4 Spec-evolution chain — final state after r3

Version	Path	Revision	Status	Lines (md)	Role
V1	docs/specs/mvp/archive/specification.V1.md	3	superseded	~590	Historical (first cut + R-NN audit baseline)
V2	docs/specs/mvp/archive/specification.V2.md	4	superseded	~3000	Historical (architectural maturity over three revisions r1-r3)
V3	docs/specs/mvp/specification.V3.md	3	active	~3900	Current — operator-product layer + nine refined flavors

Anyone reading the spec set starts at V3. V1 + V2 exist for traceability when a r3 or later change ID (V3-R-NN) needs cross-reference to the V2 audit log (§30.5) or the V1 R-NN ID-system (§30.1).